TRUST PROGRAM

docs/business/TRUST_PROGRAM.md

Security, privacy, accessibility and compliance

Semester Company OS · 2026-10-05 · Source: uploads/what else on the bussnius and opprations site also.pdf.

> Semester must operate with the same coherence, evidence, reliability and trust it promises to institutions.

Requires qualified professional review before use.

Field	Value
Mission	Make trust evidence-based: controls designed, implemented, tested and shown to buyers.
Owner	Founder + fractional security lead
Inputs	Asset/data inventory, policies, vendor list, incidents, questionnaires
System of record	/ops trust & compliance (controls, evidence, HECVAT, data requests)
KPIs	Controls with evidence; Questionnaire turnaround; Access reviews on time; Open high vulnerabilities
Reports	Quarterly trust report; HECVAT response
Meeting cadence	Quarterly access review and tabletop; annual policy review
Risk controls	Vendor security obligations in writing, need-to-know access, MFA, encryption, vendor-breach plan (FTC vendor guidance)
Approval thresholds	Any new subprocessor → privacy review + 30-day notice
Required documents	Security policies, Security readiness, Incident response, BCP/DR, Vendor risk, Claims register
Required integrations	Evidence links to GitHub, Supabase, Vercel
Current status	docs/secure/, docs/operate/, ui_kits/compliance/
Gaps	HECVAT submitted, insurance bound, ACR, vendor reviews documented
Priority	P0
Next action	Bind insurance; submit HECVAT Full; complete vendor reviews for Supabase, Vercel, AI provider

Workflows

- Inventory → risk assessment → control design → implementation → evidence → testing → monitoring → intake → remediation → verification → control review → customer evidence
- Vendor intake → purpose → data classification → security/privacy review → contract terms → access scope → onboarding → periodic review → incident escalation → renewal → offboarding

docs/business/trust/SECURITY_PRIVACY_ACCESSIBILITY_COMPLIANCE.md

Security, privacy, accessibility and compliance

Semester business operations · 2026-10-05 · Source: uploads/Show the finance and accounting operations section.pdf.
Accounting, tax, legal, insurance, privacy, security, accessibility and compliance content needs qualified professional review before use.

> Every customer promise connects to a financial owner, delivery owner, support process, security/privacy control, product capability and evidence trail.

Continuous operational systems, not a launch checklist.

Security program

Governance, asset and data inventory, classification, threat modeling, identity and access, MFA, secrets, secure SDLC, dependency and vulnerability management, logging and monitoring, incident response, backup/restore, DR, BCP, vendor risk, access reviews, pen testing, awareness, evidence register, Trust Center, HECVAT, questionnaires, reporting.

Controls by domain

Domain	Required controls
Identity	MFA, least privilege, joiner/mover/leaver, service-account ownership
Authorization	RLS, tenant isolation, capability checks, server-side scope
Secrets	Server-only credentials, rotation, secret scanning, no browser exposure
Application	Code review, testing, SAST, dependency scanning, release gates
Infrastructure	Environment separation, logging, monitoring, backups, recovery
Data	Classification, minimization, encryption, retention, deletion, export
AI	Provider controls, policy, classification, audit, evaluation, spend limits
Vendors	Security review, contract terms, subprocessors, monitoring, offboarding
Incident	Severity, command roles, communications, postmortem, corrective actions
Compliance	HECVAT, evidence, control mapping, review calendar, claims governance

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Privacy operations

Data inventory and map, classification, purpose limitation, consent, retention, deletion, legal holds, subject/export/erasure/correction requests, subprocessors, privacy impact assessments, privacy incidents, policy review, reporting.

Control record

Control → owner → policy → implementation → evidence → test → reviewer → last review → next review → customer claim → procurement response → exception/remediation.

Have: docs/secure/, docs/operate/, docs/legal/ (DPA, privacy, subprocessors), docs/build/ (test plans). **Gaps (P0):** insurance, HECVAT, ACR, vendor reviews, evidence register entries.

`docs/platform/ENTERPRISE_TRUST_PROGRAM.md`

Enterprise trust and procurement readiness

Semester platform maturity program · 2026-10-05 · Source: uploads/what else is needed to become the apple google and.pdf. Status is design-stage: nothing is "done" until repo code, tests and release evidence exist.

Principle: Semester must become the system people prefer to use every day, the system institutions trust to operate, and the system partners prefer to build on.

Standard

- Trust Center, HECVAT readiness, security and privacy overviews, accessibility program, responsible AI documentation, architecture and data-flow diagrams, subprocessor list, DPA process, SLA/support policy.
- Incident response, business continuity, disaster recovery, pen-test roadmap, evidence register, questionnaire library, vendor risk program, compliance roadmap.
- Answer for CIO, security, privacy, accessibility, registrar and procurement: can we trust, operate, migrate to, get our data out of, control, support and hold it accountable?

Capability record

Field	Value
Current evidence	`docs/secure/`, `docs/legal/`, `ui_kits/company-site/ (Trust)`, `ui_kits/compliance/`
Implementation state	Drafted: 10 policies, readiness plan, MSA/DPA/order form, Trust Center page. Insurance, HECVAT, ACR not complete.
Product owner	Founder
Technical owner	Security & compliance (fractional)
Risk owner	Counsel
Success metrics	HECVAT accepted; DPA signed; Insurance bound; ACR delivered; Questionnaire turnaround (days)
Launch gate	All six pilot blockers closed with evidence
Next action	Bind cyber + E&O insurance and submit HECVAT Full
Security / privacy / accessibility	RLS + tenant_id on every row; no student records to AI; WCAG 2.2 AA
Replacement authority gate	Institution approval with reconciliation evidence before Semester becomes authoritative for any domain

Execute

See `handoff/execute/` streams and `13-platform-maturity.md`.

Global reliability and operations

Semester platform maturity program · 2026-10-05 · Source: uploads/what else is needed to become the apple google and.pdf. Status is design-stage: nothing is "done" until repo code, tests and release evidence exist.

Principle: Semester must become the system people prefer to use every day, the system institutions trust to operate, and the system partners prefer to build on.

Standard

- Service catalog, critical journey map, SLIs and SLOs, error-budget policy (feature work slows when the budget is spent), release policy, incident command, status communications.
- Disaster recovery, backup/restore drills, load and capacity testing, dependency map, observability, tenant health, integration health, operations inbox, on-call matrix, RCA and corrective actions, release cohorts and kill switches.

Capability record

Field	Value
Current evidence	`docs/operate/`, `ui_kits/ops/`, `ui_kits/architecture/ (lag simulator)`
Implementation state	Drafted: SLOs, error-budget policy, 10 alerts, 8 runbooks. No monitoring live.
Product owner	Engineering
Technical owner	Founder (on-call)
Risk owner	Founder
Success metrics	SLO attainment; Error budget remaining; Restore drill time; Incidents with postmortem in 5 days
Launch gate	Restore drill timed; alerts firing in staging
Next action	Wire error tracking, uptime checks and the SIS-lag alert in staging
Security / privacy / accessibility	RLS + tenant_id on every row; no student records to AI; WCAG 2.2 AA
Replacement authority gate	Institution approval with reconciliation evidence before Semester becomes authoritative for any domain

Execute

See `handoff/execute/` streams and `13-platform-maturity.md`.

SEMESTER

Security policy set

Version 0.1 draft · October 2026 · Owner: founder (acting security lead). Reviewed every year and after any incident. These policies map to the HECVAT and SOC 2 control areas; we hold neither attestation today.

Scope: Semester production systems (Vercel hosting, Supabase Postgres and auth, the AI gateway), company laptops and accounts, and every person with access. Student data belongs to the institution and is handled only as its DPA allows.

1. Access control

HECVAT: Authentication, Authorization · SOC 2: CC6

- Least privilege by role. Company roles (sales, finance, marketing, investors) get no access to student data.
- Production database access is limited to named engineers, granted through just-in-time requests that are logged.
- MFA is required on every company account. Customer staff sign in through institution SAML SSO.
- Access is reviewed every quarter, and removed within 24 hours when someone leaves.
- Row-level security on every table holding student data, tested in CI.

2. Encryption and keys

SOC 2: CC6.1, CC6.7

- TLS 1.2 or higher in transit, and AES-256 at rest (provider managed).
- Secrets live in the platform secret store, never in the repo. They rotate every year, and immediately if exposed.
- Backups are encrypted with the same controls.

3. AI and student data

- The AI gateway strips and blocks student-record fields before any model call. The block list is tested in CI and red-teamed before each release.
- Model providers are under no-training, zero- or limited-retention terms, and are listed as subprocessors.
- Students are told when content is AI-assisted. A person confirms any consequential action.

4. Vendor management

- Every subprocessor gets a security review before use: their SOC 2 or equivalent, a DPA, and the data location.
- The subprocessor list is published, and institutions get 30 days' notice before a new one is added.
- Vendors are reviewed every year.

5. Incident response

- Severities: **S1** student data possibly exposed; **S2** pilot down or wrong data shown; **S3** degraded; **S4** minor.
- For S1 and S2: an incident lead is named within 15 minutes, and evidence is preserved.
- The institution is notified within the DPA window (target: within 24 hours of confirming an S1). Customers hear from us before the public does.
- A blameless review within 5 business days, with every action item tracked to closure.

6. Business continuity and disaster recovery

- Targets: RPO 24 hours (daily backups plus point-in-time recovery where available), RTO 8 hours.
- A restore drill every quarter, timed and recorded.
- The founder is a single point of failure. Credentials and runbooks are in a sealed emergency kit with a named backup contact.

7. Data retention and deletion

- The institution sets retention. By default, data is deleted within 30 days of contract end, with written confirmation.
- Logs are kept for 1 year. Audit logs are kept as long as the contract requires.
- Student data requests (view, correct, delete) are routed through the institution.

8. Secure development

- Every change goes through a pull request with review. CI runs tests, RLS tests, dependency checks and secret scanning.
- Staging mirrors production configuration with synthetic data. Real student data is never used in development.
- Critical vulnerabilities are patched within 7 days, and high ones within 30.
- A penetration test before the pilot goes broad, then every year.

9. Acceptable use and devices

- Company devices: full-disk encryption, automatic updates, screen lock, and the ability to wipe them remotely.
- No student data on personal devices, in email attachments or in chat tools.
- Phishing and security training when someone joins, then every year.

10. Logging and monitoring

- Auth events, admin actions, data access and AI gateway blocks are logged with the actor's role.
- Alerts for sign-in failure spikes, error rate, sync lag and unusual data export.

Readiness

Status today: policies drafted; HECVAT Full in progress; SOC 2 not started (a Type I is planned after the pilot); no pen test yet; insurance not yet bound. Track progress in the IT & security console (ui_kits/ops → IT & security).

SEMESTER

Security readiness tracker

HECVAT Full draft answers, SOC 2 readiness, pen-test scope and insurance. October 2026. Status key: ✓ **Done** · … **In progress** · ○ **Not started**. Never mark anything done without evidence.

1. HECVAT Full: draft answers by section

Section	Draft position	Evidence	Status
Company overview	LLC, solo founder, US based, pre-revenue, first pilot	Formation docs	…
Documentation	Security policy set v0.1; annual review	Security Policies.html	…
IT accessibility	Designed to WCAG 2.2 AA; VPAT/ACR in progress	ACR, test log	…
Application security	PR review, CI tests, RLS tests, dependency and secret scanning	CI config, run links	…
Authentication	SAML SSO for institution users; MFA on all company accounts	SSO test log	…
Authorization	Role-based access plus Postgres RLS; company roles have no access to student data	RLS test suite	…
Data	Encrypted in transit and at rest; US hosting; no student records sent to AI	Provider docs, gateway tests	…
Data center	Inherited from Vercel and Supabase (their SOC 2 reports)	Vendor reports	○
Change management	Every change via PR; staging before production	Repo settings	…
Incident response	Severities, 24 h notice target, blameless review	IR plan, tabletop	…
Business continuity / DR	RPO 24 h, RTO 8 h, quarterly restore drill	Drill record	○
Policies and training	Security training when someone joins and every year	Completion record	○
Third parties	Subprocessor list with 30-day notice	Subprocessor page	…
Vulnerability management	Critical in 7 days, high in 30; annual pen test	Scan reports, pen test	○

2. SOC 2 readiness (Type I planned after the pilot)

Area	What's needed	Status
CC1 Control environment	Org chart, code of conduct, background checks for hires	○
CC2 Communication	Published security page, internal policy acknowledgment	…
CC3 Risk assessment	Annual risk register (start from the business risk register)	…
CC5 Control activities	Policies mapped to controls	…
CC6 Logical access	MFA, quarterly access reviews, offboarding checklist	…

Area	What's needed	Status
CC7 Operations	Monitoring, alerting, incident tickets	○
CC8 Change management	Branch protection, required review	…
CC9 Vendor risk	Vendor reviews on file	○
A1 Availability	Backups and a tested restore	○
C1 Confidentiality	Data classification, retention and deletion	…

Compliance automation tools and auditors cost money. Budget for them after the pilot, outside the $5k–$20k setup range unless a customer requires it sooner.

3. Pen-test scope (before the pilot goes broad)

In scope	Out of scope
Web app (student, staff, console), auth and SSO flows, Supabase RLS and APIs, AI gateway prompt-injection and data-leak tests, file uploads, marketplace and messaging abuse	Vendor infrastructure (Vercel and Supabase platforms), denial of service, social engineering of institution staff, any production student data (test in a staging environment with synthetic data)

Deliverables: a report with severities, a retest after fixes, and an attestation letter that can be shared with institutions.

4. Insurance checklist

Policy	Why	Status
Cyber liability (first and third party)	Required by Vanderbilt; covers breach response and notification	○
Technology E&O	Required by Vanderbilt; covers service failure claims	○
General liability	Common in vendor contracts	○
Certificate of insurance	Names the institution as certificate holder (and as additional insured if the contract requires)	○

Coverage limits must match the pilot contract. Confirm them with the contract and a licensed broker; this document doesn't set amounts.

SEMESTER

Platform security review · migrations 010–040

Reviewer: design-stage review, October 2026. Scope: handoff/semester-platform. Status: findings written as migration 050 and tests; **not yet run**. Needs review by a qualified security engineer before production.

Result: 11 findings, 1 critical and 3 high. All closed in `050_security_hardening.sql` and proven by `tests/security.test.ts`; each test must fail before 050 and pass after.

Findings

ID	Severity	Finding	Fix in 050
F2	Critical	ops.staff had no RLS. A tenant user could insert themselves as `ceo` and pass every ops policy.	RLS on; self-read only; inserts revoked; staff created by service role from the company IdP
F5	High	profiles_self_update allowed changing institution_id: a student could move into another tenant and read its data.	Trigger freezes id, institution_id and role; SSO provisioning owns them
F1	High	core.institutions had no RLS: every tenant's feature flags readable by any signed-in user.	RLS on; own institution only
F4	High	profiles_same_campus exposed every profile column campus-wide, ignoring per-field visibility.	Self + scoped staff read; everyone else uses core.directory (findable only, visible fields only)
F6	Medium	audit.log executable by clients: anyone could write audit rows.	Execute revoked from clients; called by server command functions
F7	Medium	Audit table not explicitly append-only.	Update/delete/truncate revoked
F9	Medium	Group membership (including sensitive groups) visible campus-wide.	Members, self, and moderators of the same institution only (definer function avoids policy recursion)
F8	Medium	Bidder identities visible to the whole campus.	Own bids only; campus sees counts and top bid via view
F10	Medium	RSVP policy didn't check the event's institution.	Insert requires an event in the caller's institution
F3	Low	Helper functions ran as invoker inside policies (recursion and search_path risk).	Security definer + empty search_path
F11	Low	Anonymous role not explicitly denied.	All privileges revoked from anon, including defaults

Still to review

- **Addressed in 060:** posts, listings, offers and reports now write only through audited `api.*` command functions with validation, rate limits and the integrity filter; direct inserts revoked (tests/commands.test.ts).

- ops.my_role() must never return a role for a tenant user; add a test once tenant and company identities share an auth project.
- **Addressed in 060/080:** listing-photos, student-files (owner only), course-materials (campus read, faculty/TA write) and evidence (service role only) bucket policies.
- Rate limits on AI and auth endpoints live in middleware, not the database.
- **Addressed:** security CI job (gitleaks secret scan, npm audit high, service-role key guard, no record fields in analytics, RLS/command/red-team tests) and security headers middleware (CSP, HSTS, frame-ancestors none, no-store on API).
- **Addressed in 080:** approved-sources-only AI context; delegations with expiry ≤ 1 year, audited grant/revoke.

AI gateway (added)

gate() trusted scope labels only, so a student could paste a record into the prompt. Added a content scan (student-ID pattern per tenant, SSN, DOB, GPA, grades, transcript/aid/accommodation/disciplinary terms, card numbers) that blocks before any provider call, a usage log that never stores prompts, and a 20-case red-team suite.

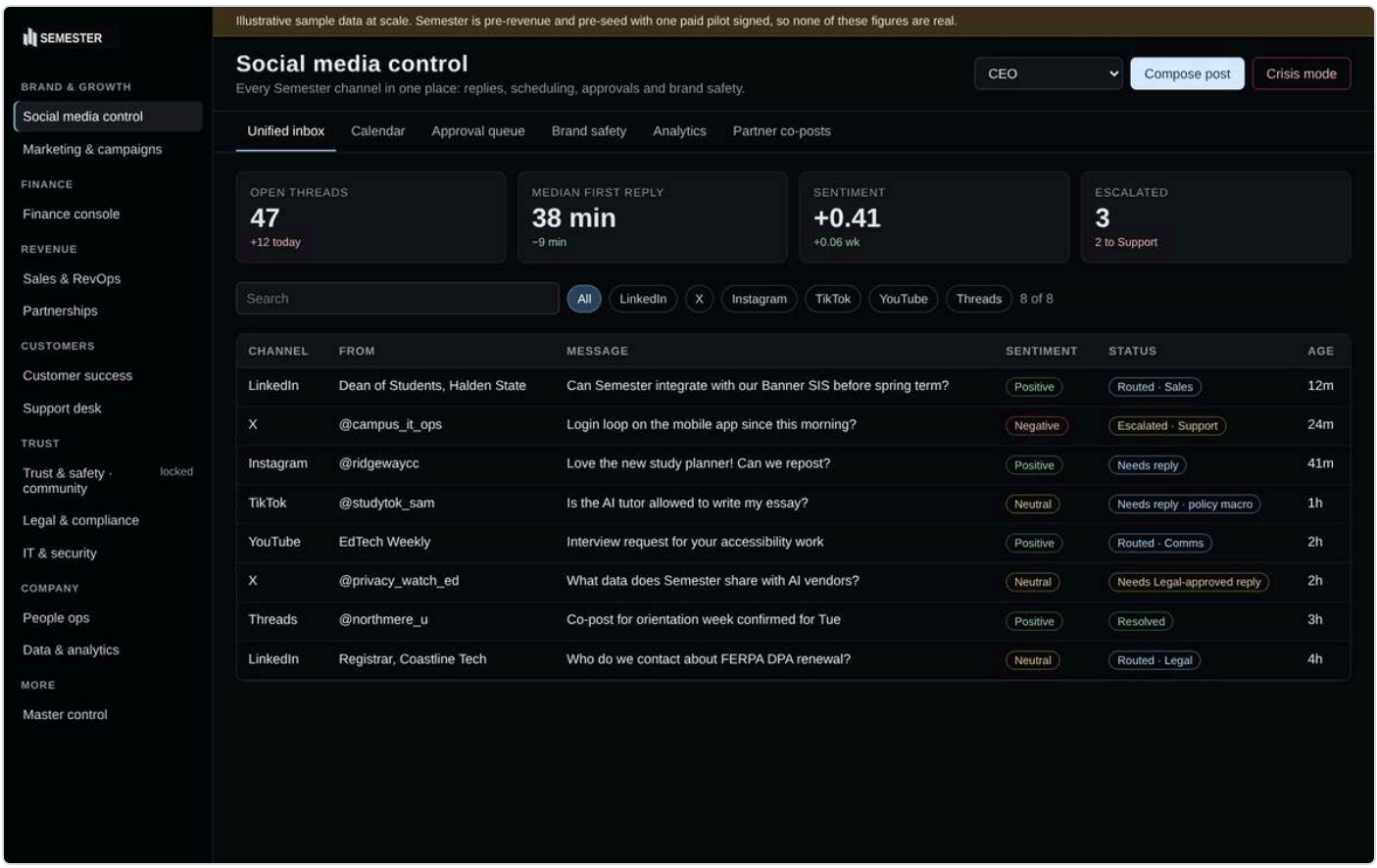
Gate

Migration 050 and its tests are a launch gate alongside the RLS suite in the launch runbook. No real student data until both pass in staging.

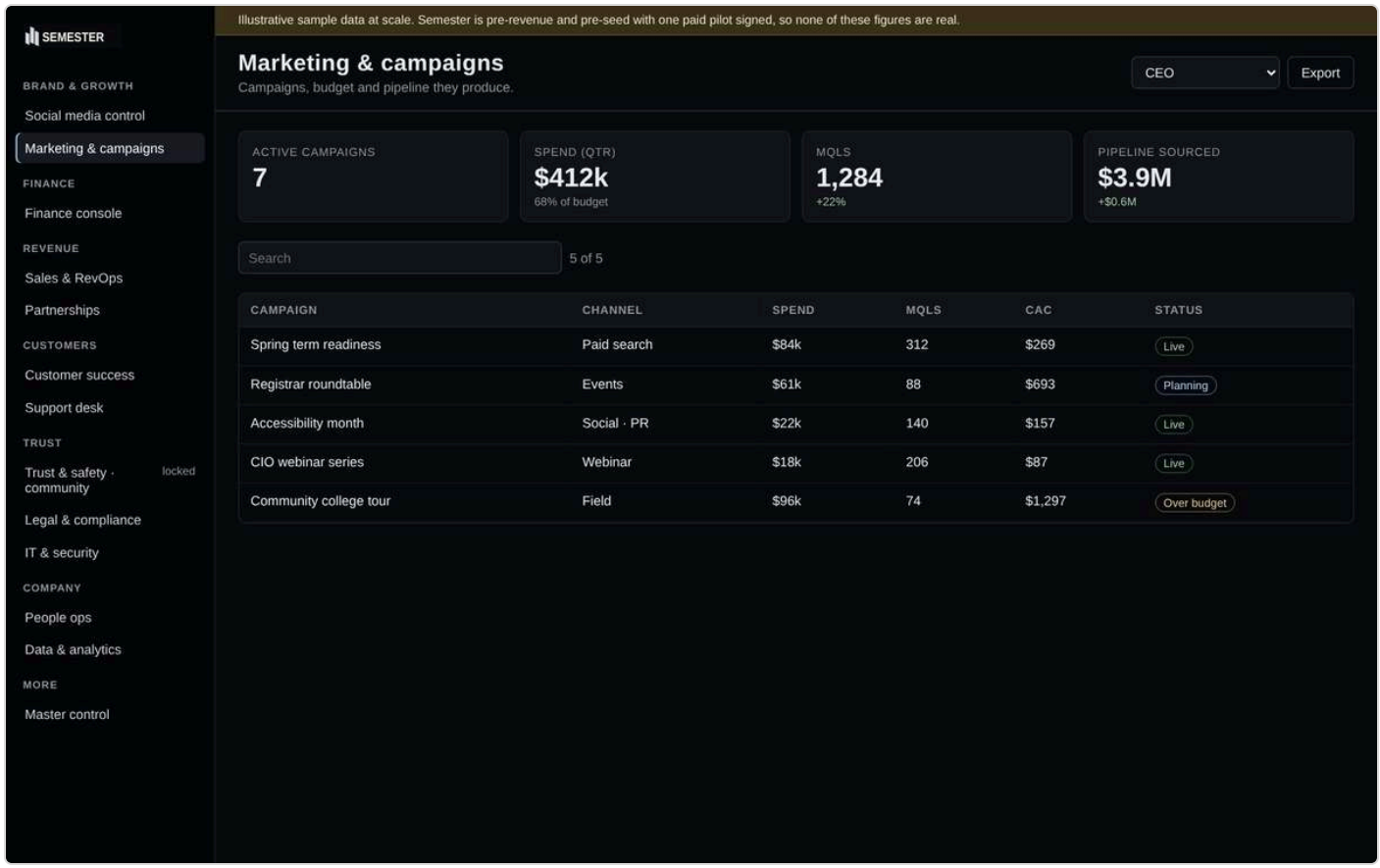
Operations and compliance consoles

The operations consoles and the compliance workspace. **47 screens.**

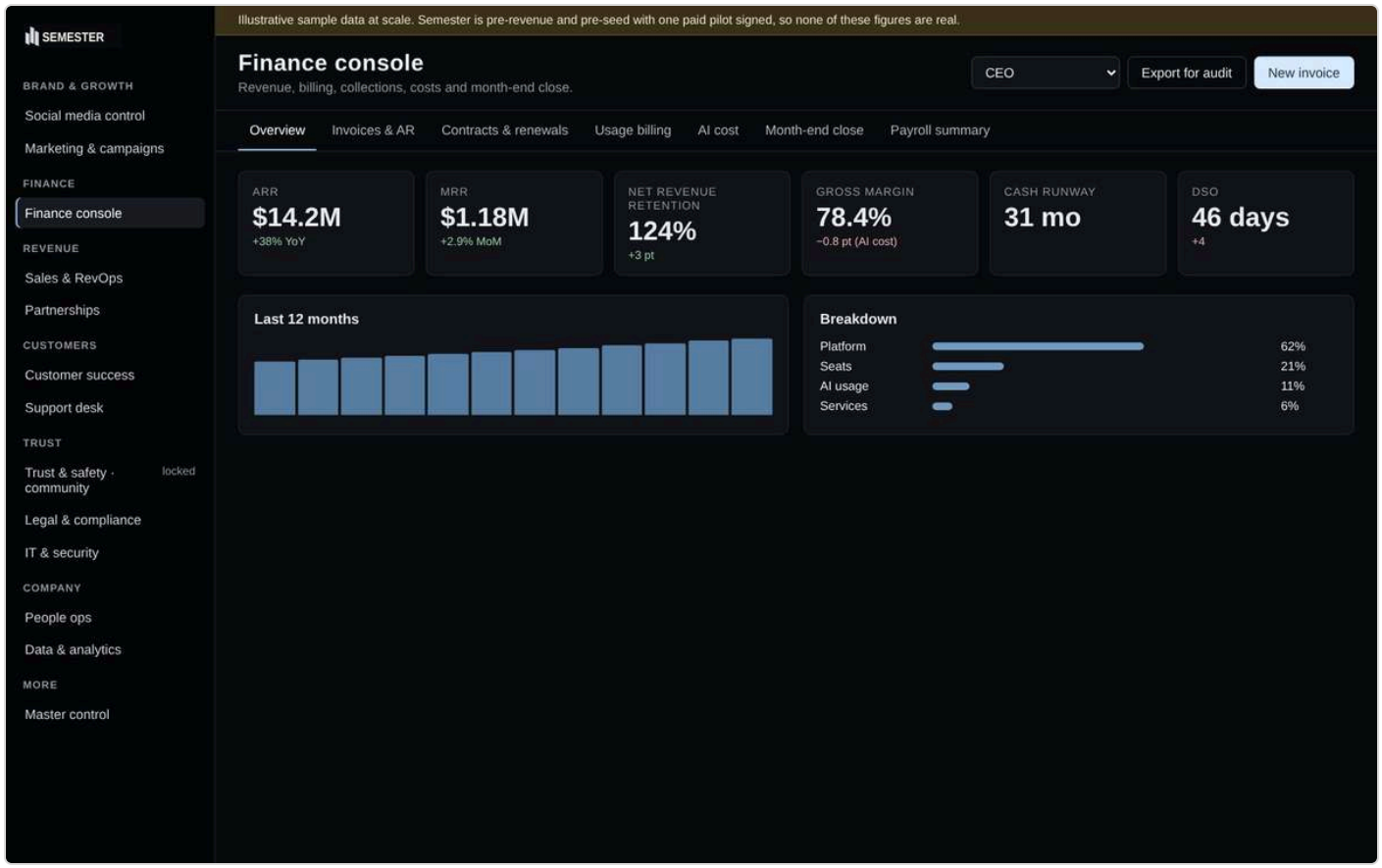
ops



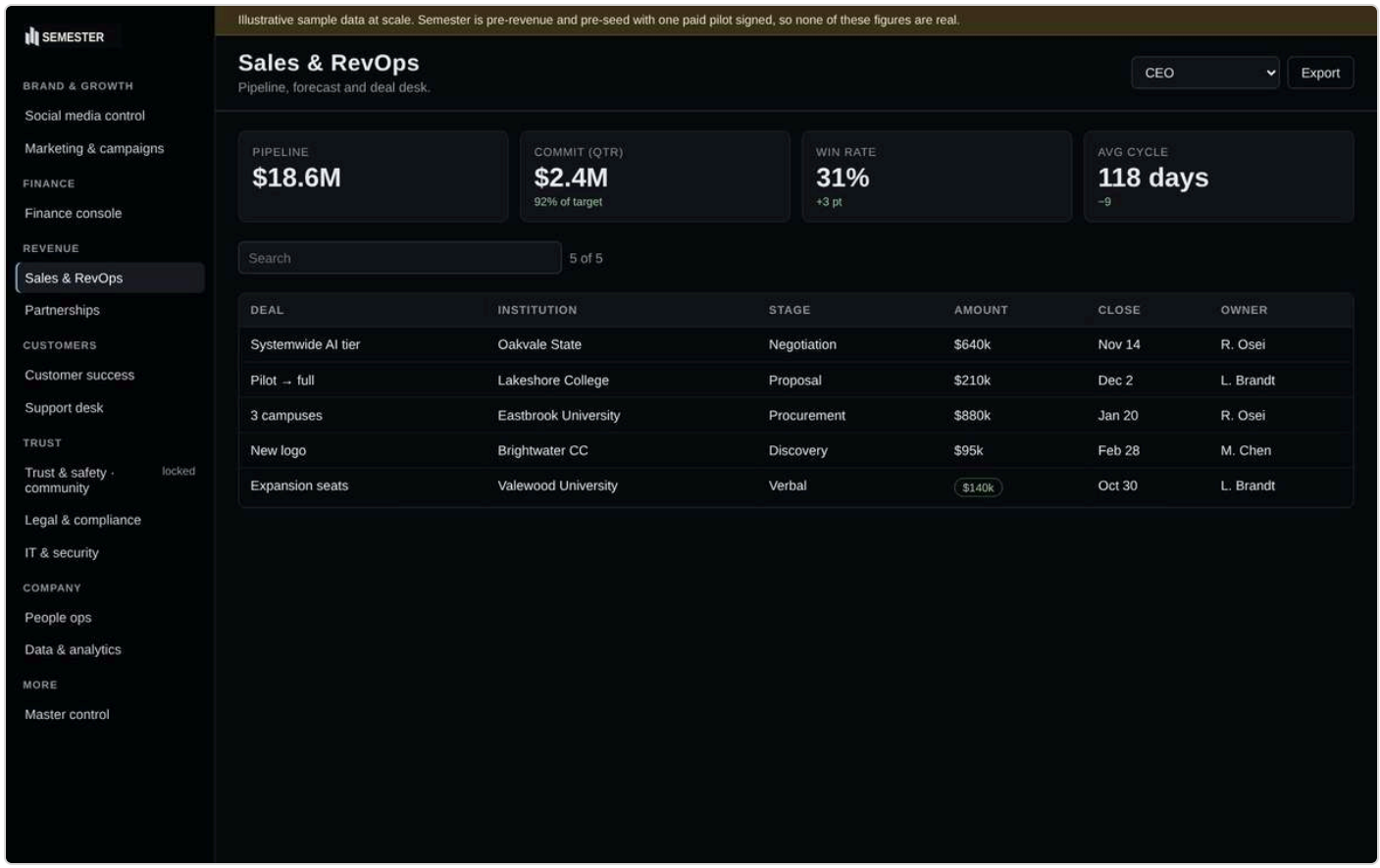
Opening view



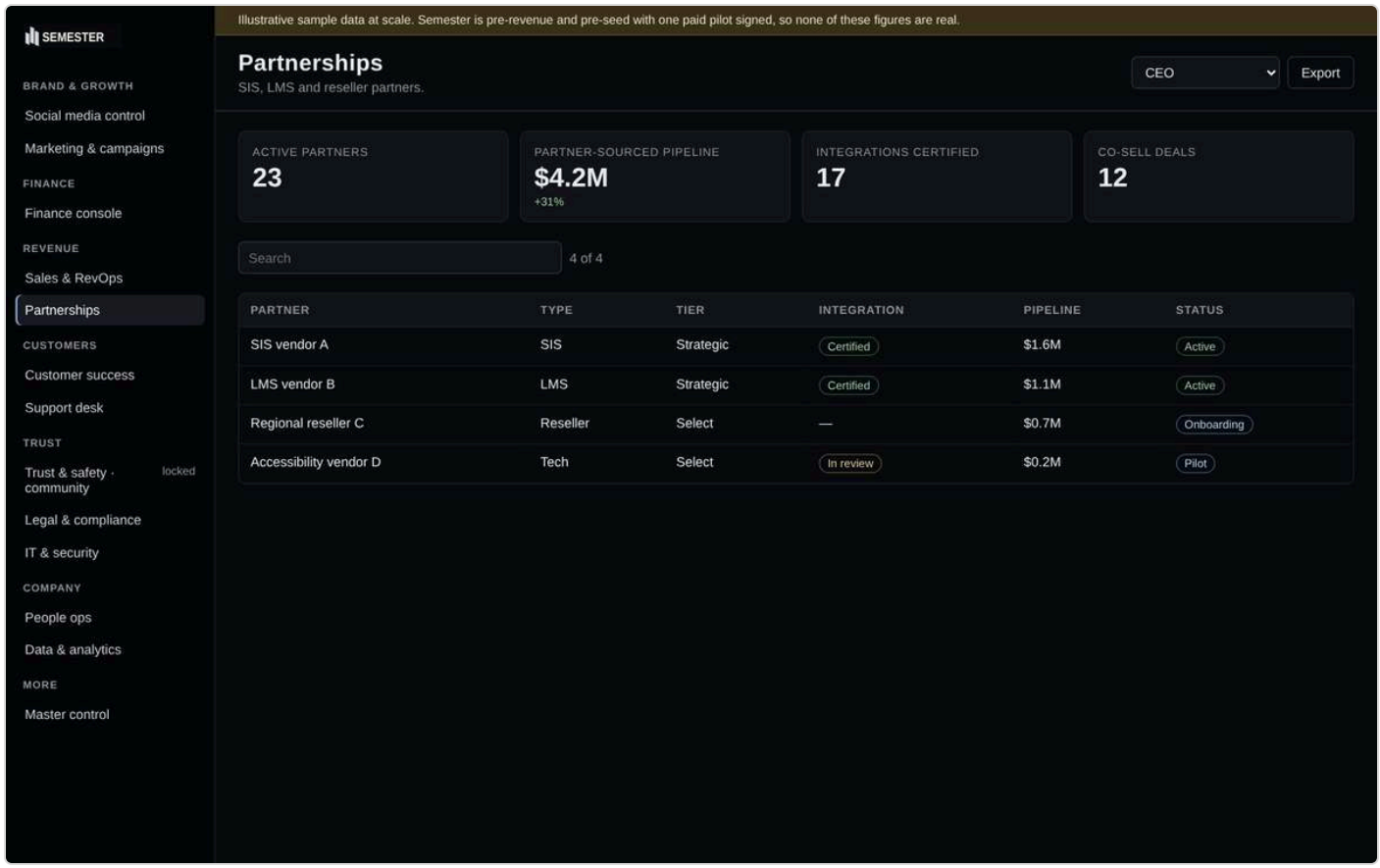
Marketing & campaigns



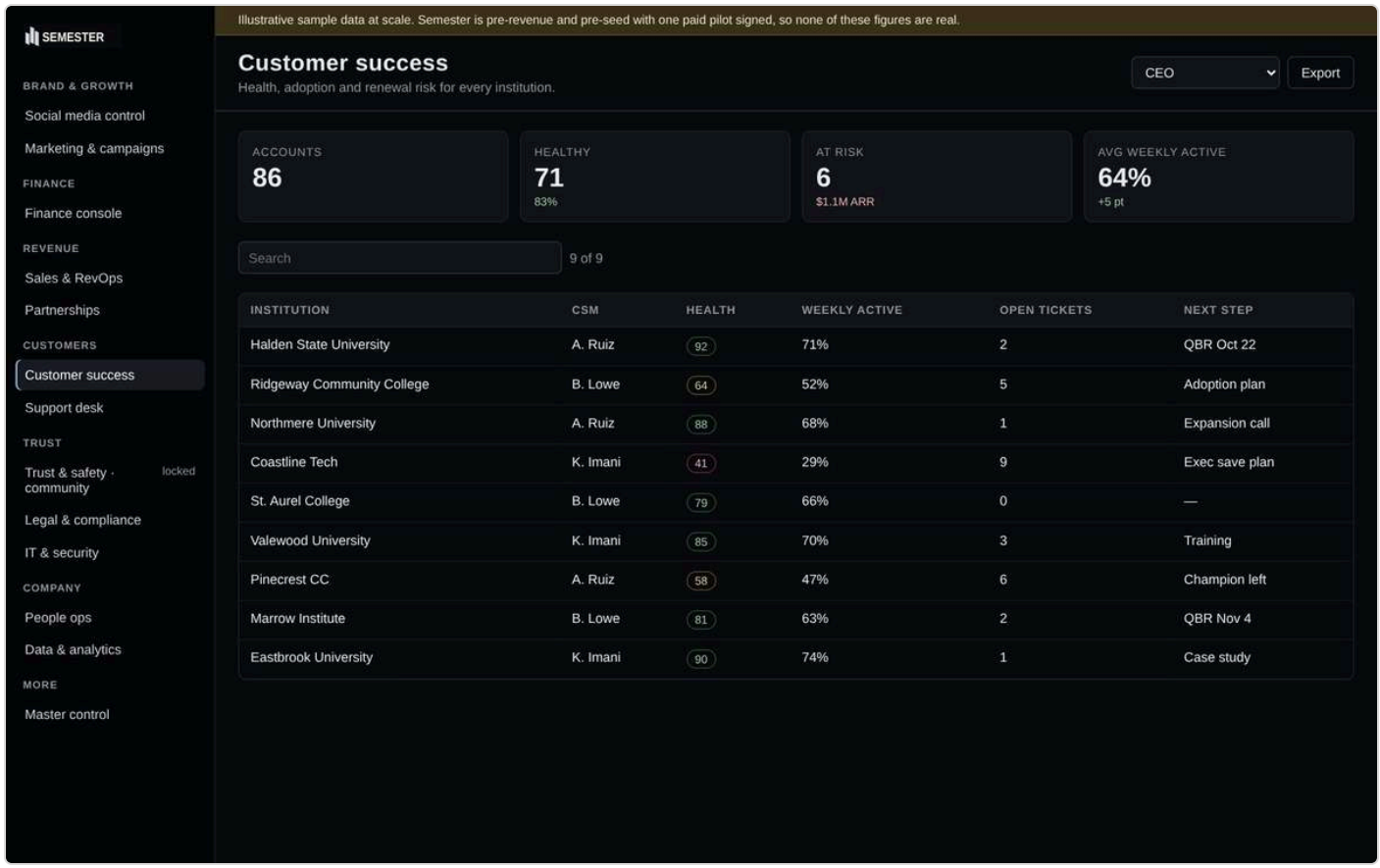
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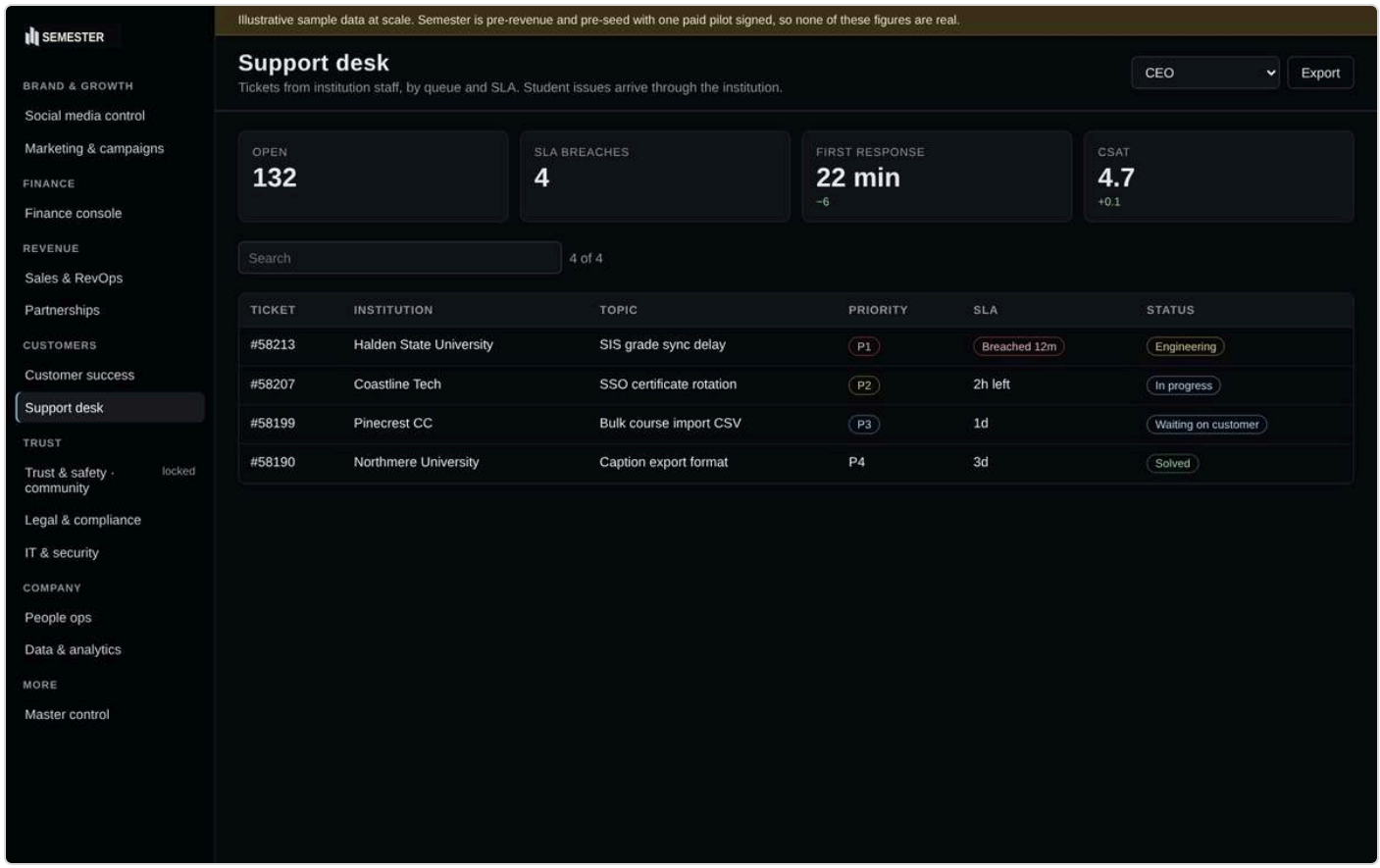
Sales & RevOps



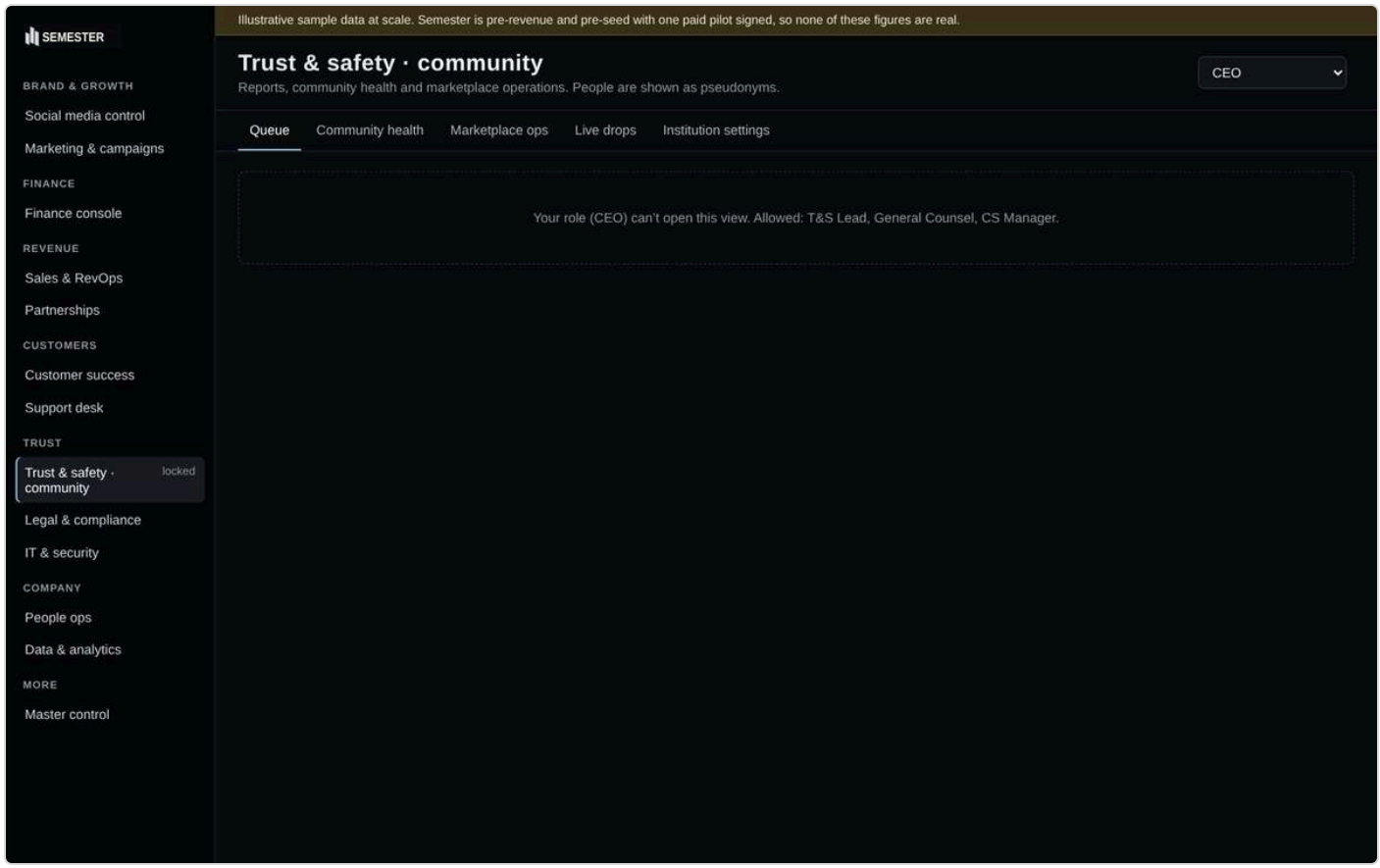
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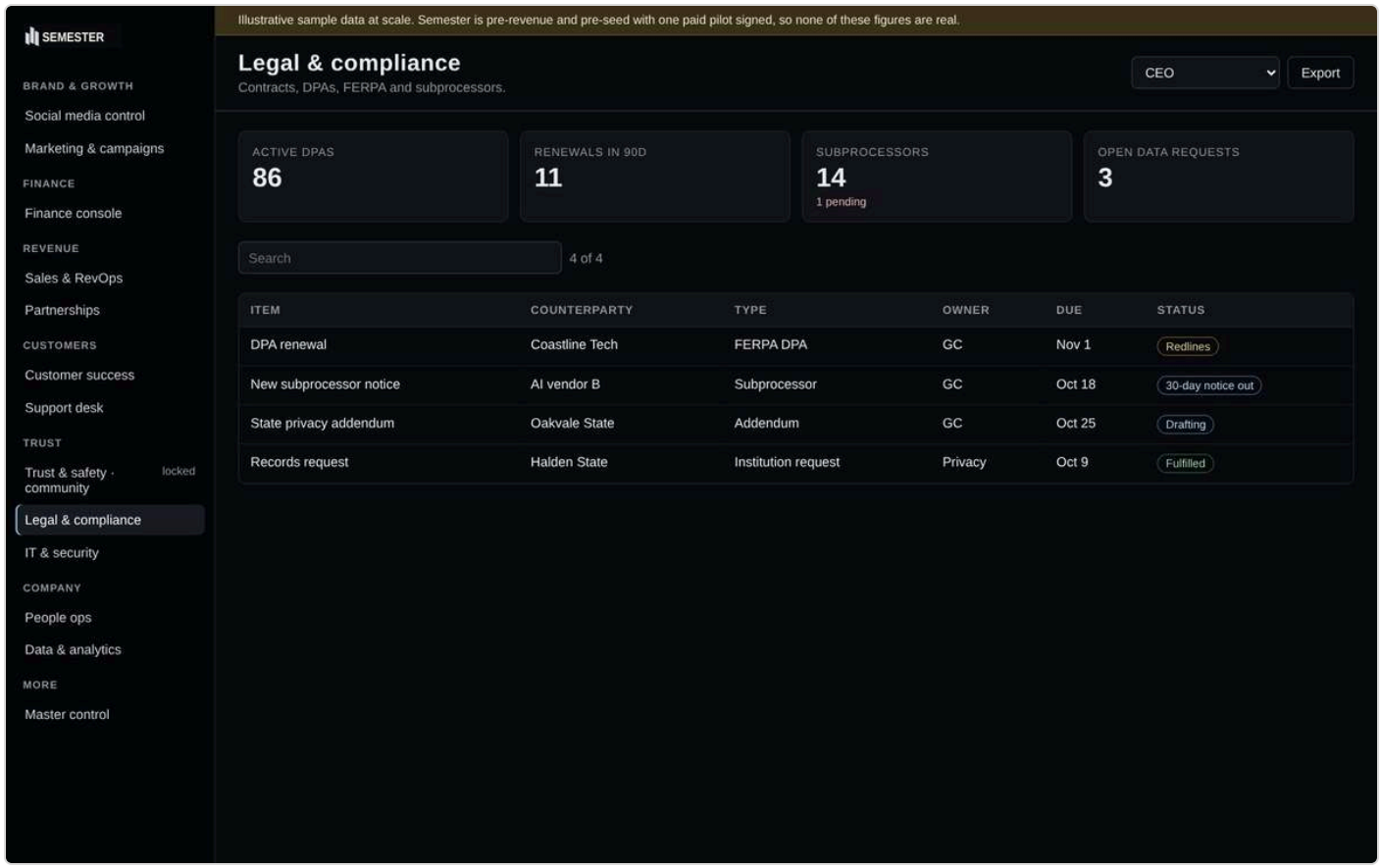
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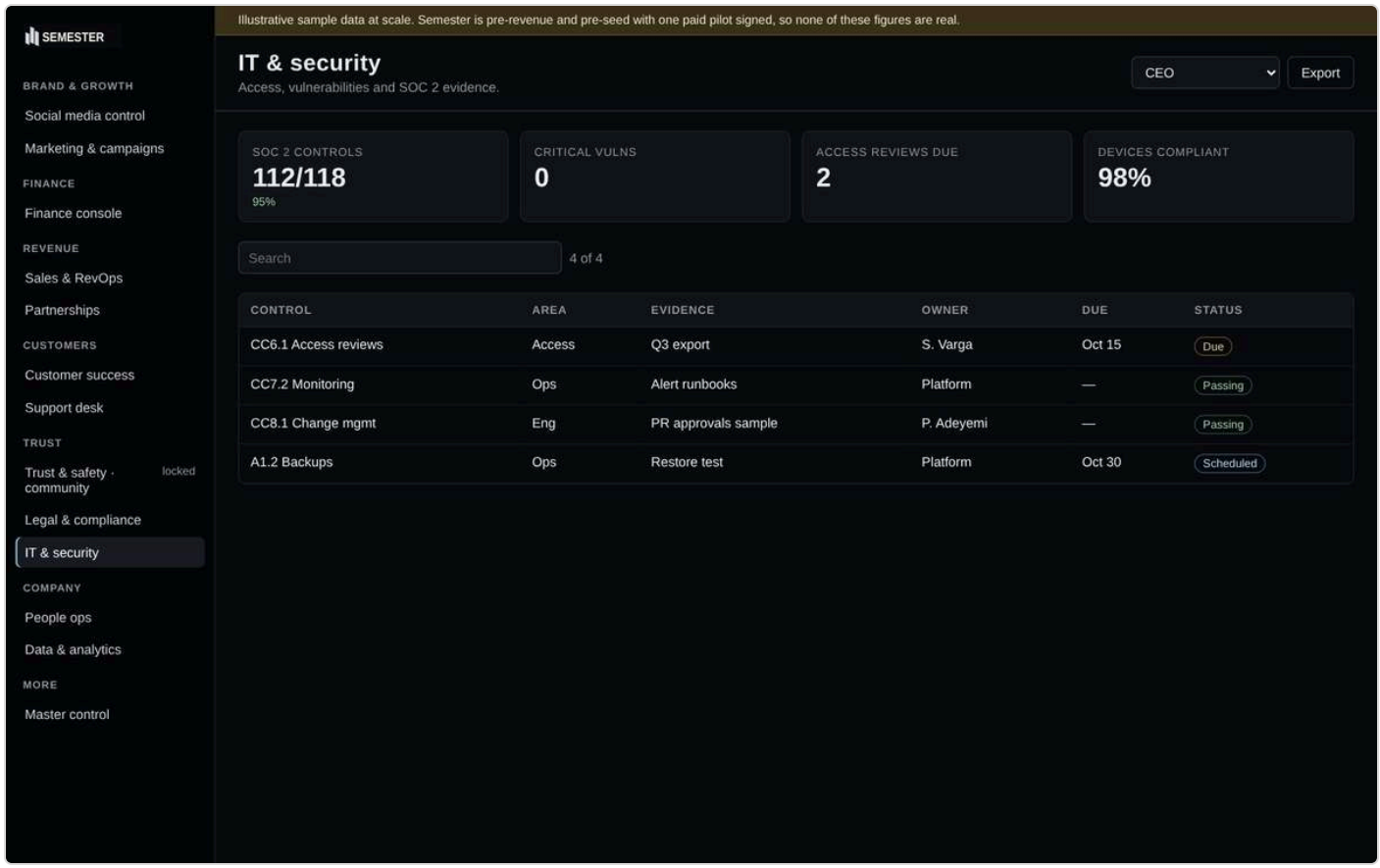
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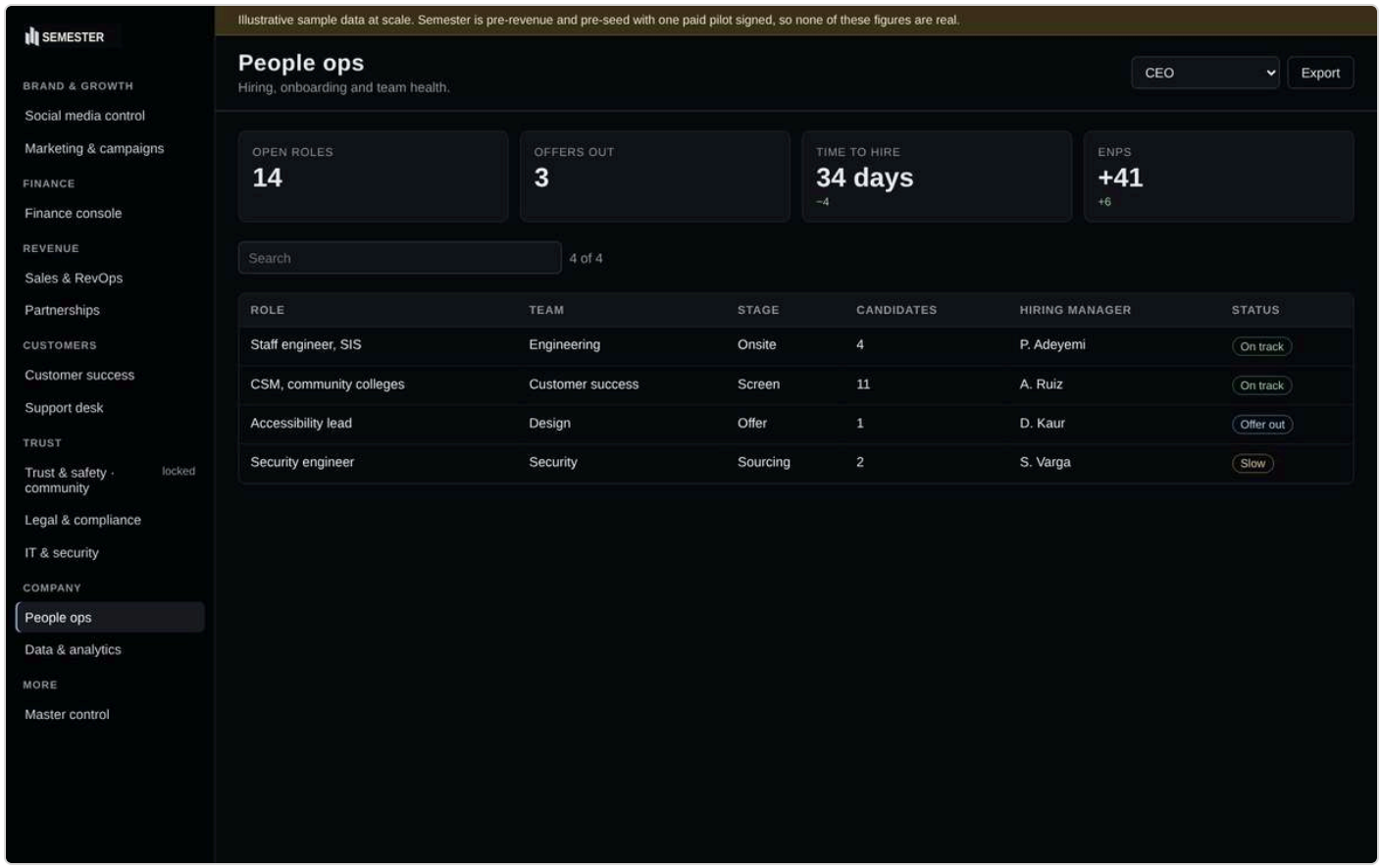
Trust & safety · community



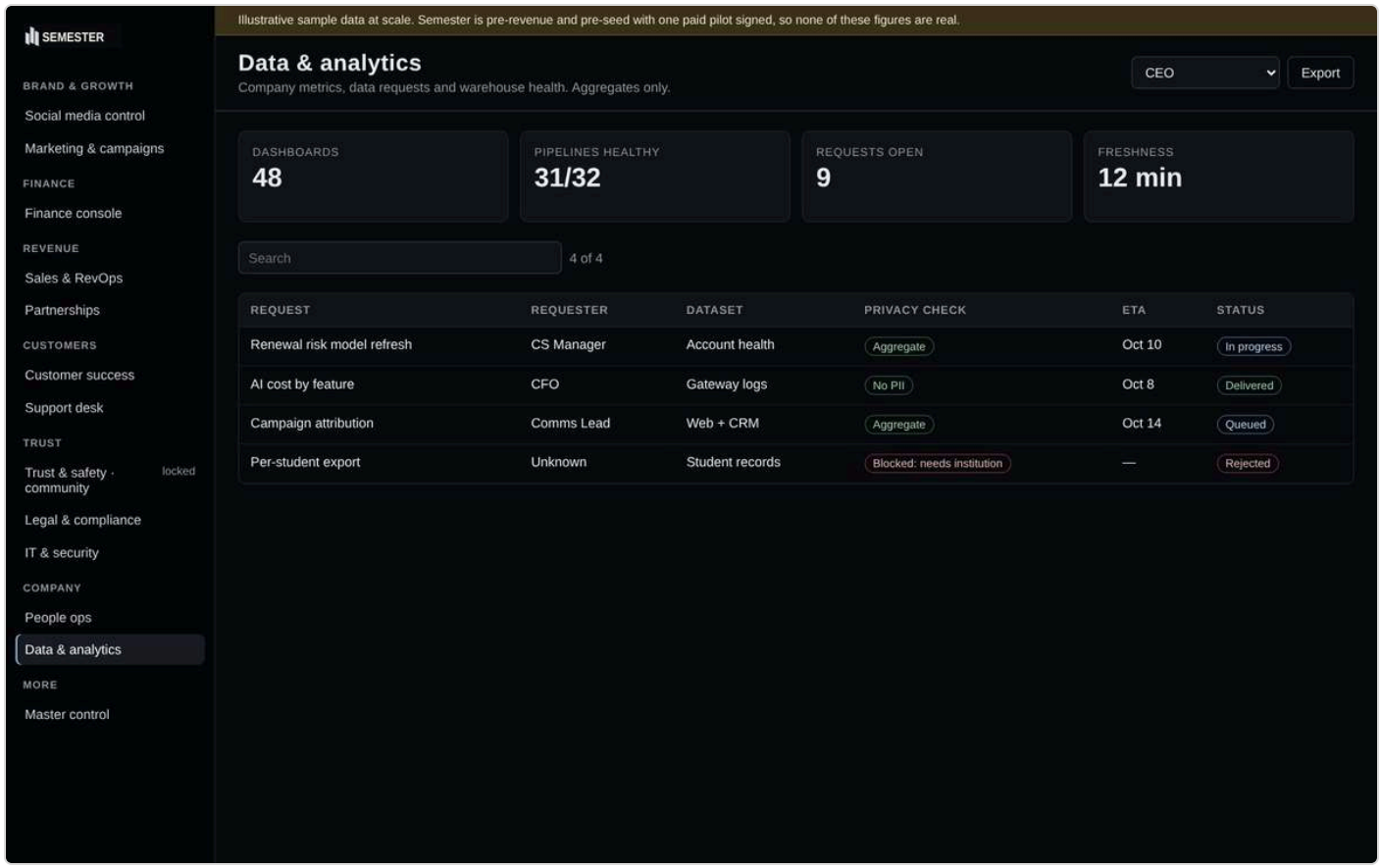
Legal & compliance


SEMESTER
BRAND & GROWTH
Social media control
Marketing & campaigns
FINANCE
Finance console
REVENUE
Sales & RevOps
Partnerships
CUSTOMERS
Customer success
Support desk
TRUST
Trust & safety · community
locked
Legal & compliance
IT & security
COMPANY
People ops
Data & analytics
MORE
Master control
Illustrative sample data at scale. Semester is pre-revenue and pre-seed with one paid pilot signed, so none of these figures are real.
IT & security
Access, vulnerabilities and SOC 2 evidence.
CEO
Export
SOC 2 CONTROLS
112/118
95%
CRITICAL VULNS
0
ACCESS REVIEWS DUE
2
DEVICES COMPLIANT
98%
Search
4 of 4
CONTROL
AREA
EVIDENCE
OWNER
DUE
STATUS
CC6.1 Access reviews
Access
Q3 export
S. Varga
Oct 15
Due
CC7.2 Monitoring
Ops
Alert runbooks
Platform
—
Passing
CC8.1 Change mgmt
Eng
PR approvals sample
P. Adeyemi
—
Passing
A1.2 Backups
Ops
Restore test
Platform
Oct 30
Scheduled

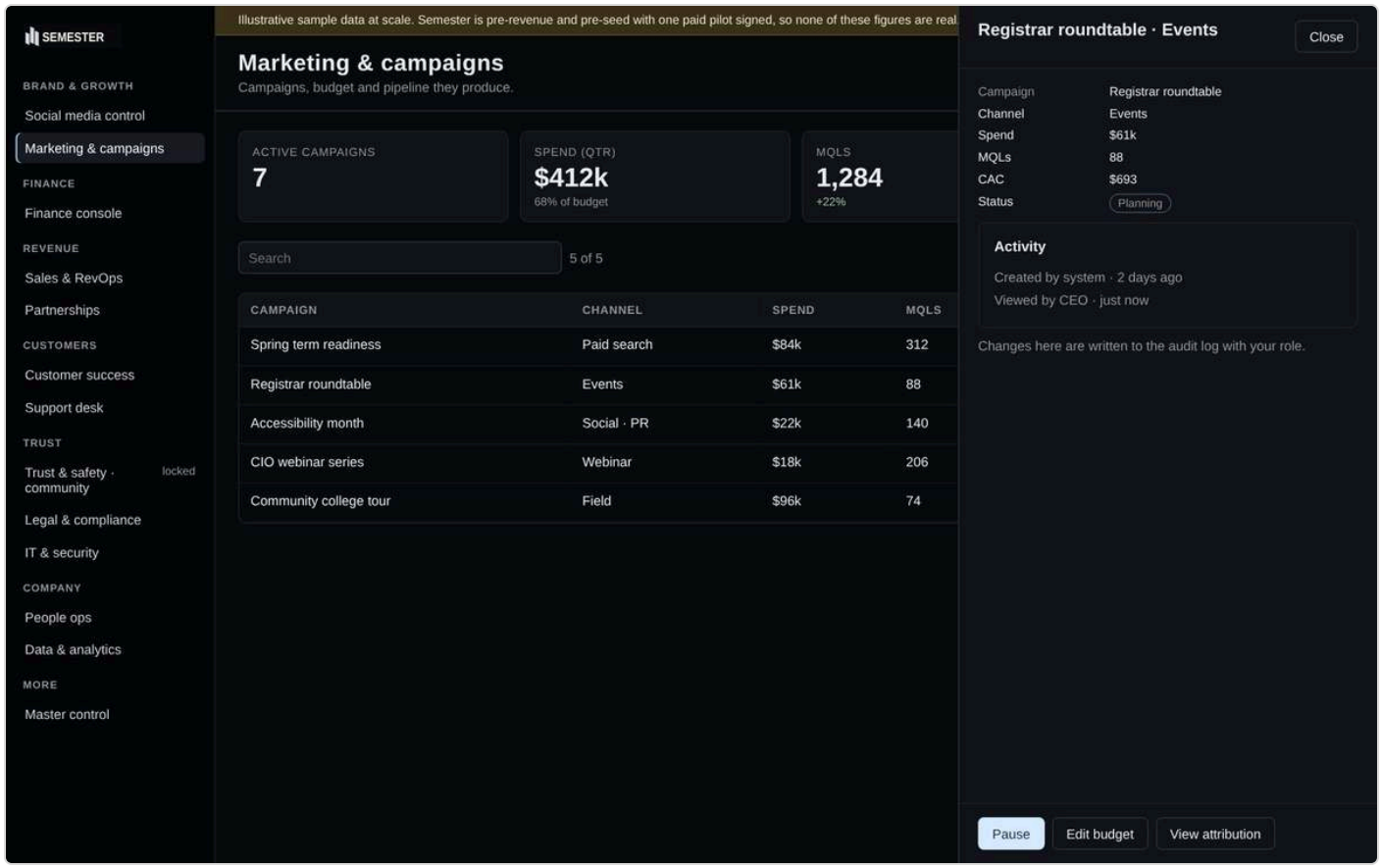
IT & security


SEMESTER
BRAND & GROWTH
Social media control
Marketing & campaigns
FINANCE
Finance console
REVENUE
Sales & RevOps
Partnerships
CUSTOMERS
Customer success
Support desk
TRUST
Trust & safety · community
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People ops
Data & analytics
MORE
Master control
Illustrative sample data at scale. Semester is pre-revenue and pre-seed with one paid pilot signed, so none of these figures are real.
People ops
Hiring, onboarding and team health.
CEO
Export
OPEN ROLES
14
OFFERS OUT
3
TIME TO HIRE
34 days
−4
ENPS
+41
+6
Search
4 of 4
ROLE
TEAM
STAGE
CANDIDATES
HIRING MANAGER
STATUS
Staff engineer, SIS
Engineering
Onsite
4
P. Adeyemi
On track
CSM, community colleges
Customer success
Screen
11
A. Ruiz
On track
Accessibility lead
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1
D. Kaur
Offer out
Security engineer
Security
Sourcing
2
S. Varga
Slow

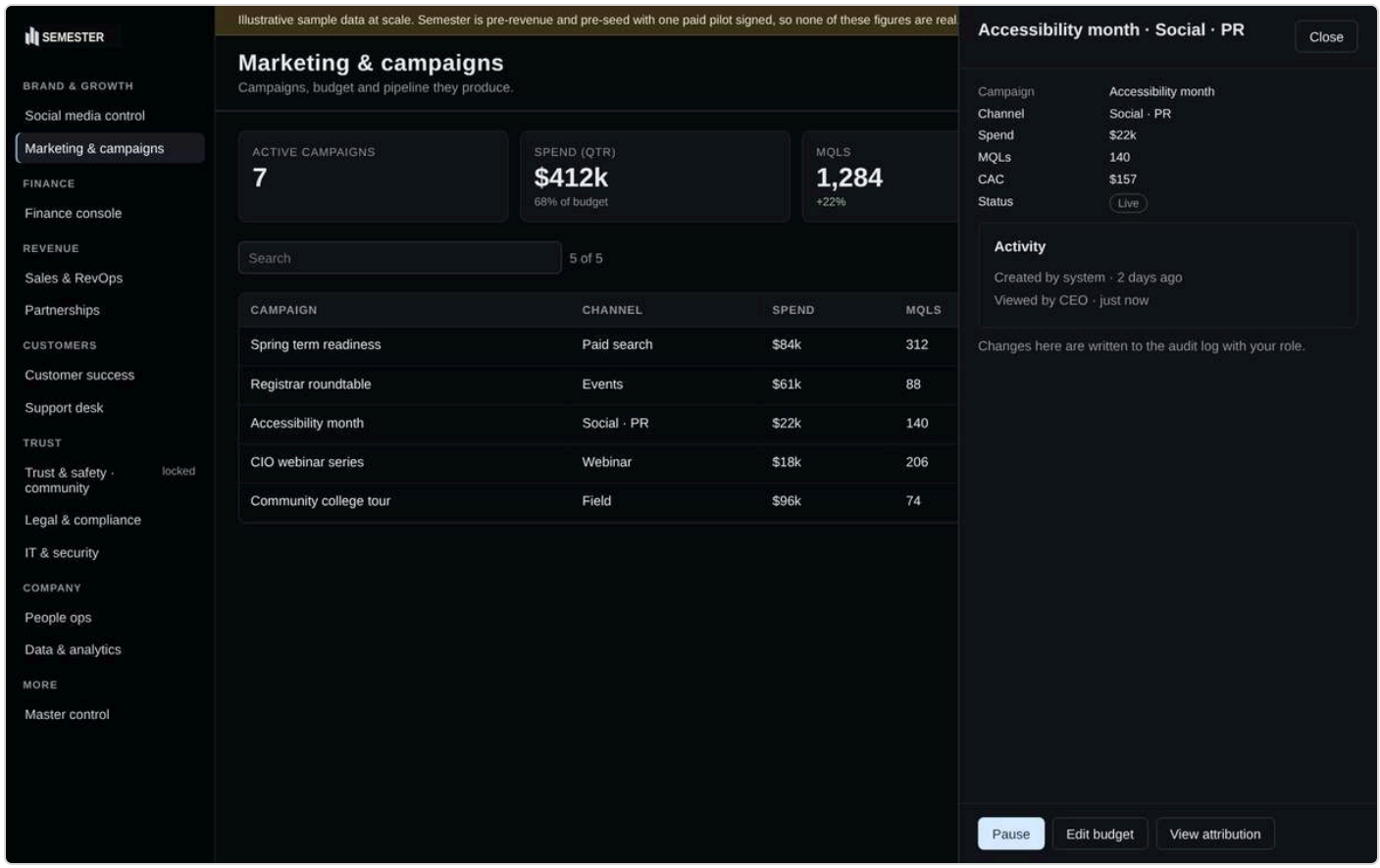
People ops



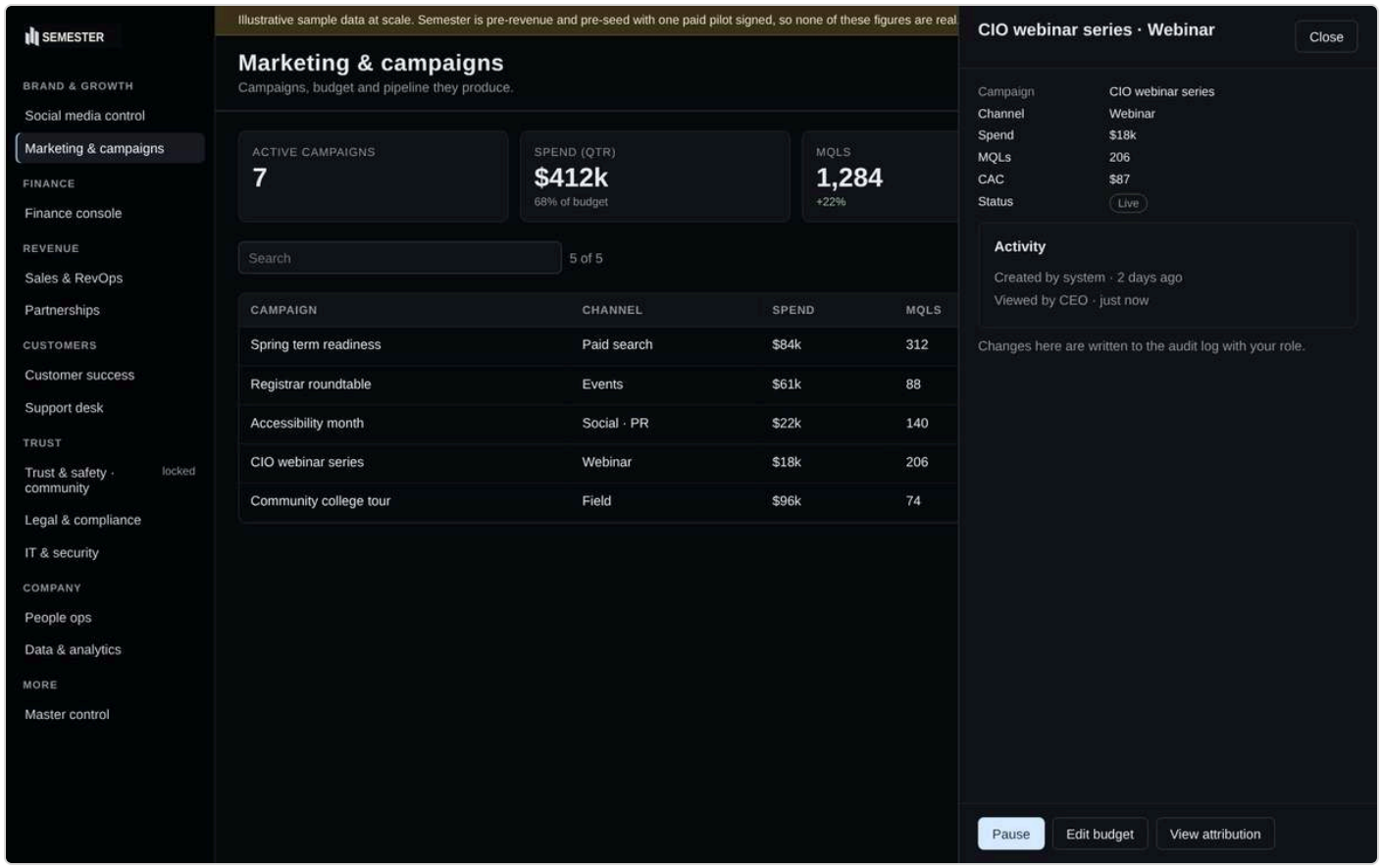
Data & analytics



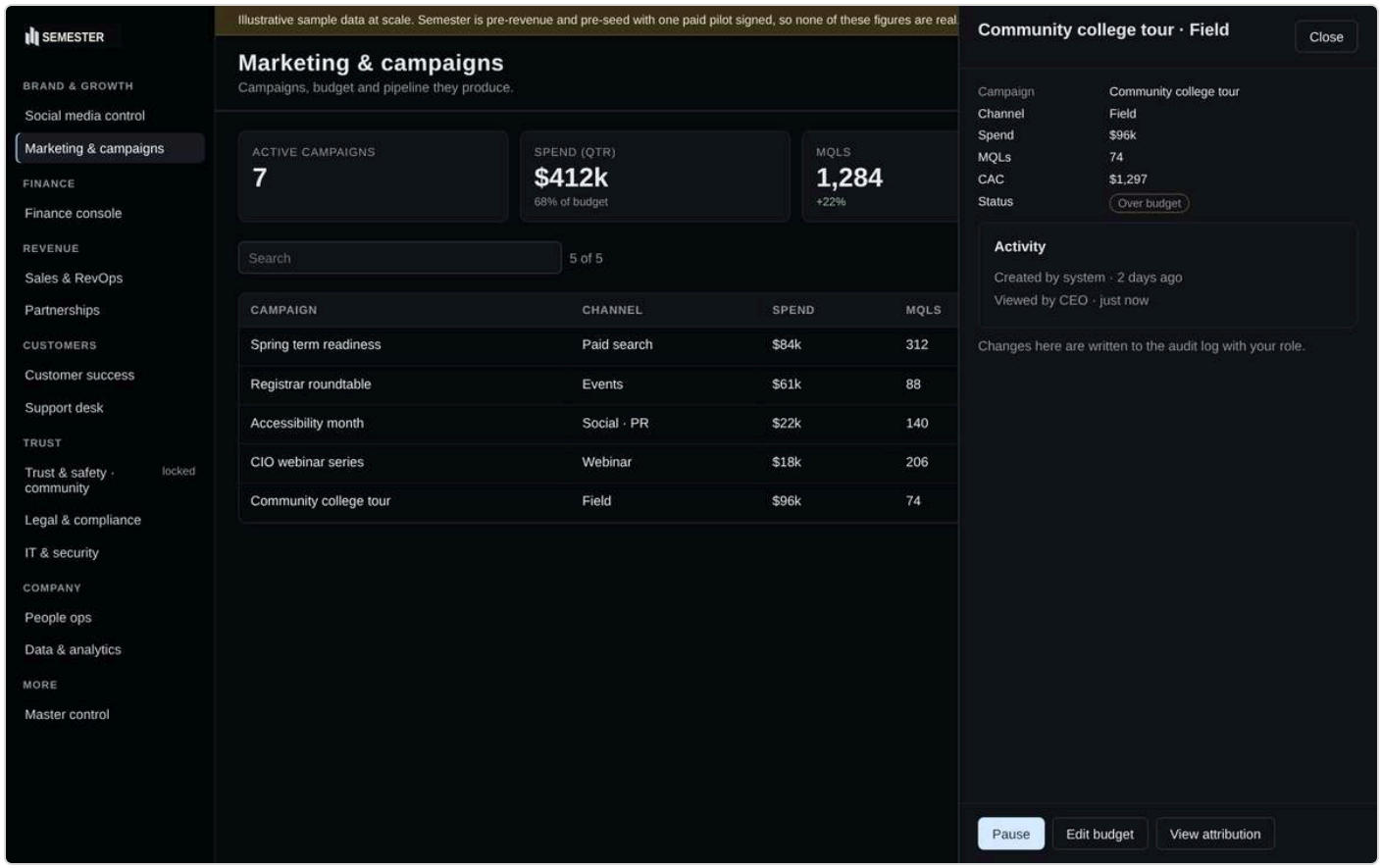
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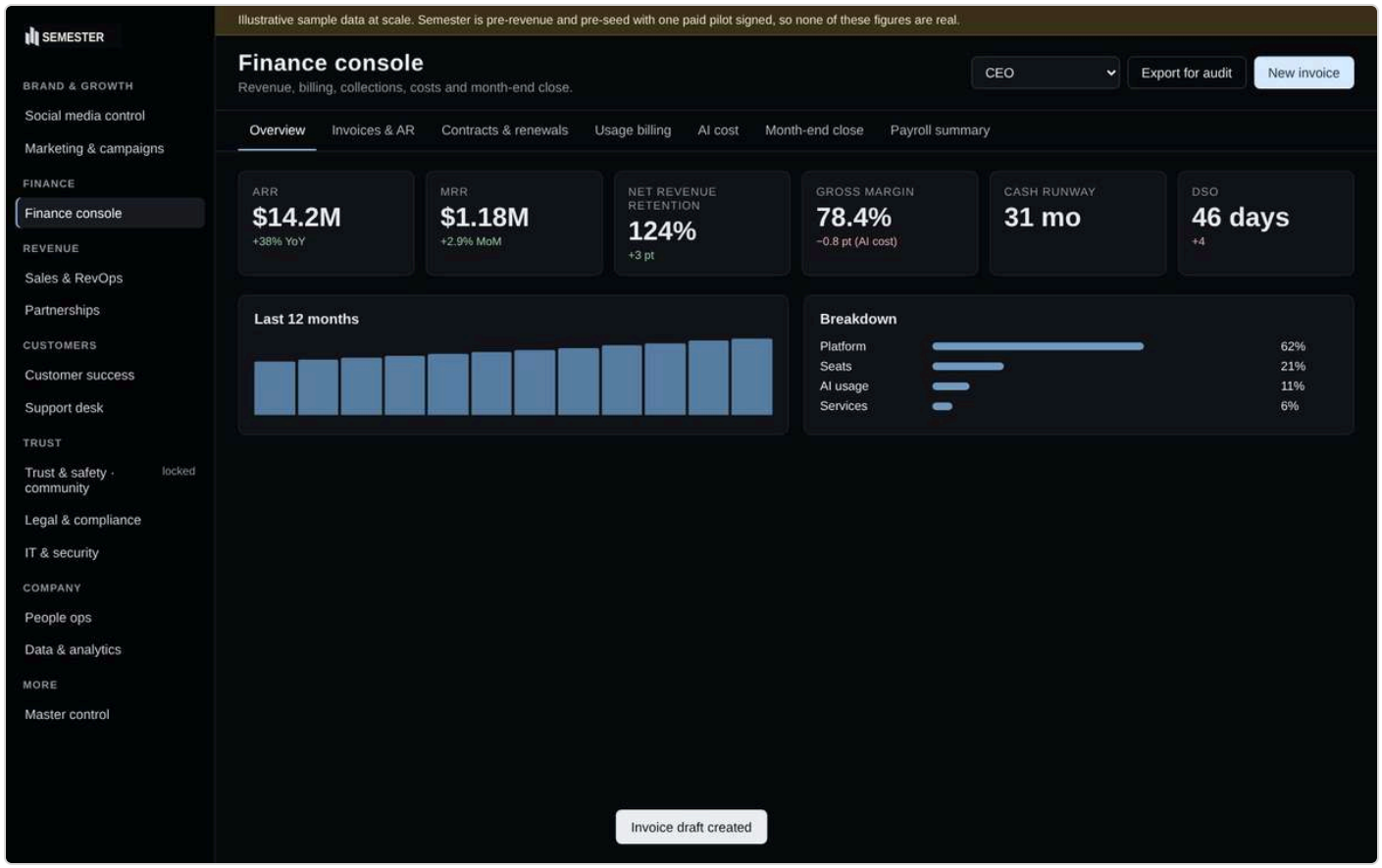
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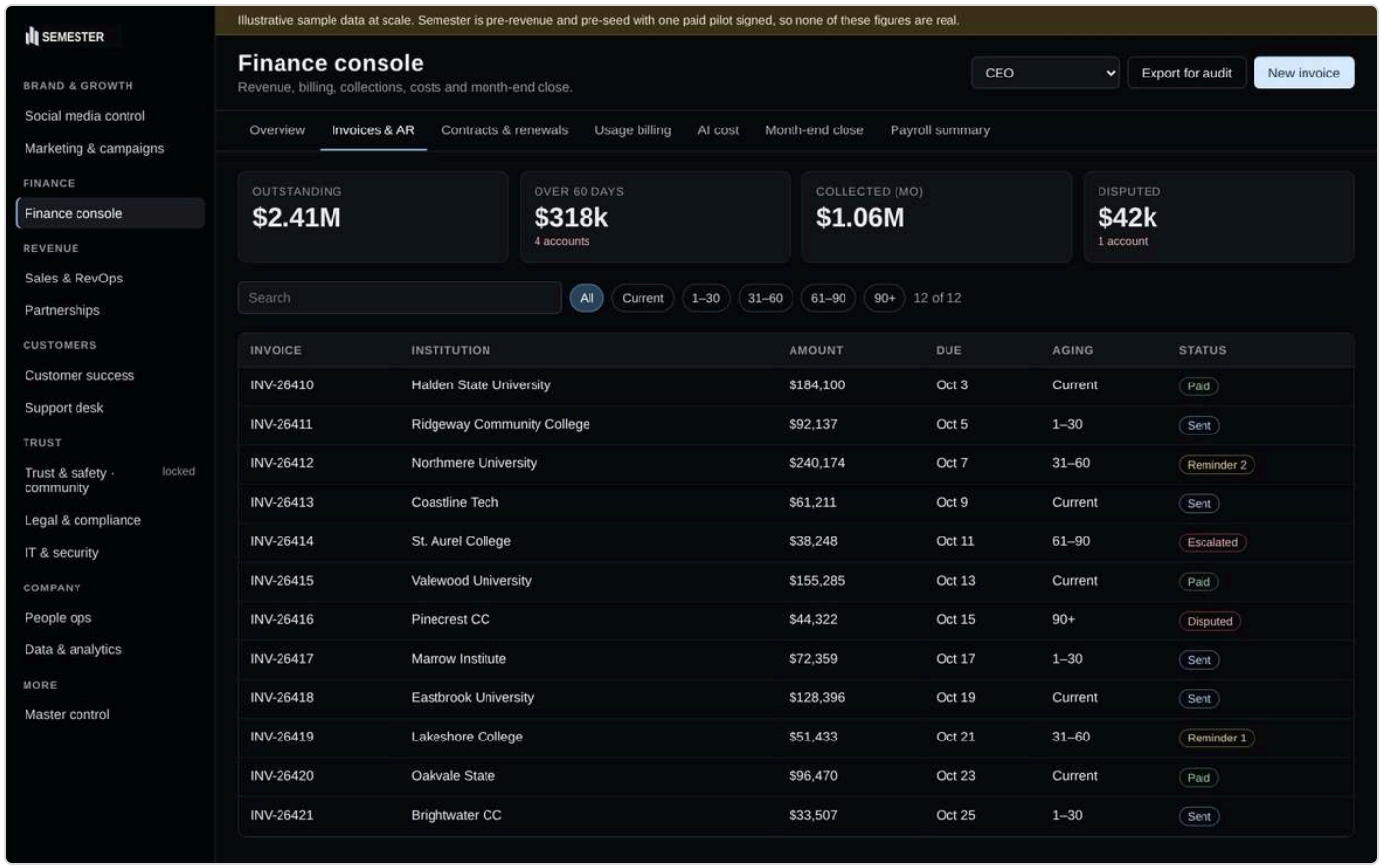
Marketing & campaigns › CIO webinar series Webinar $18k 206 $87 Live



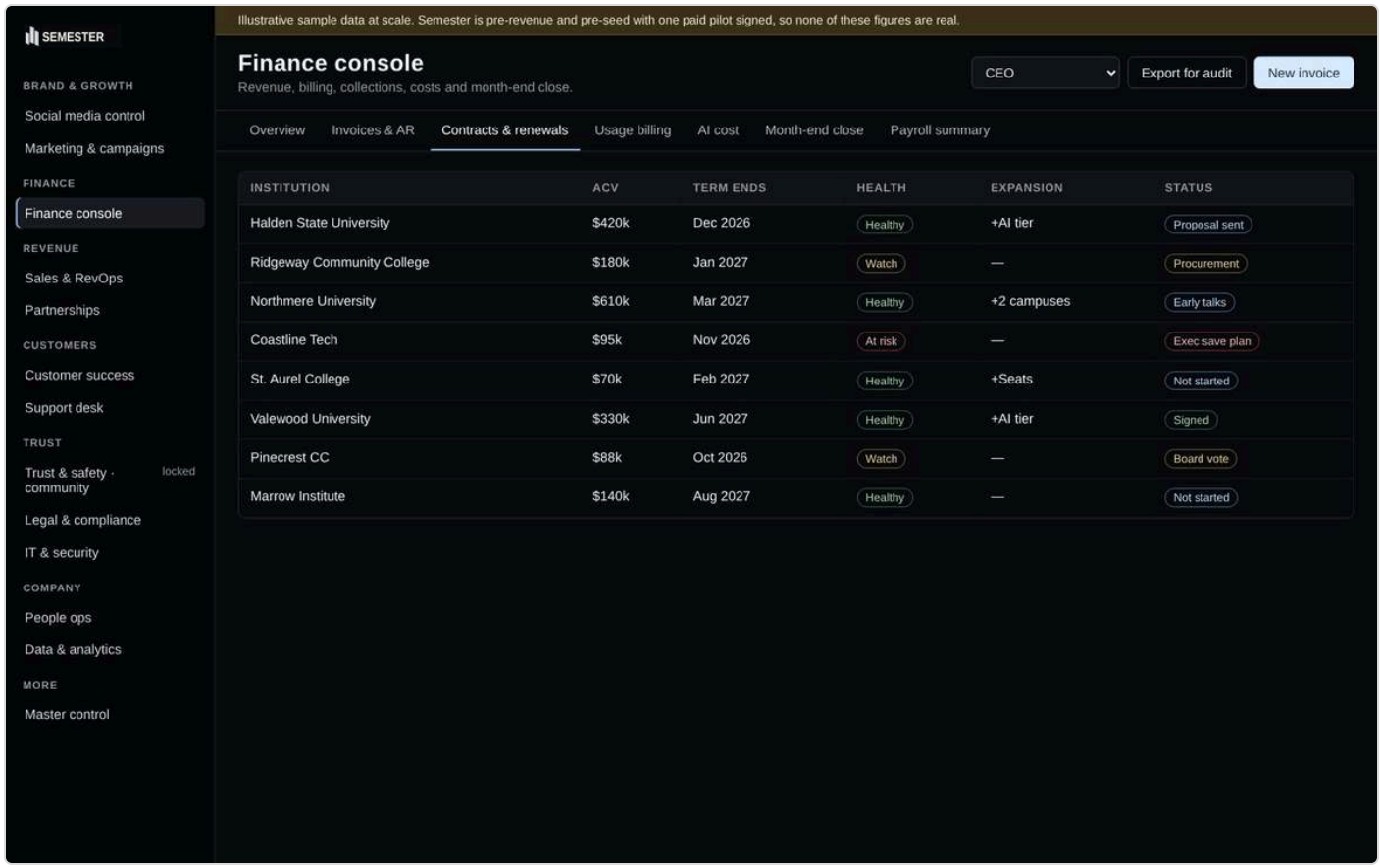
Marketing & campaigns › Community college tour Field $96k 74 $1,297 Over budget



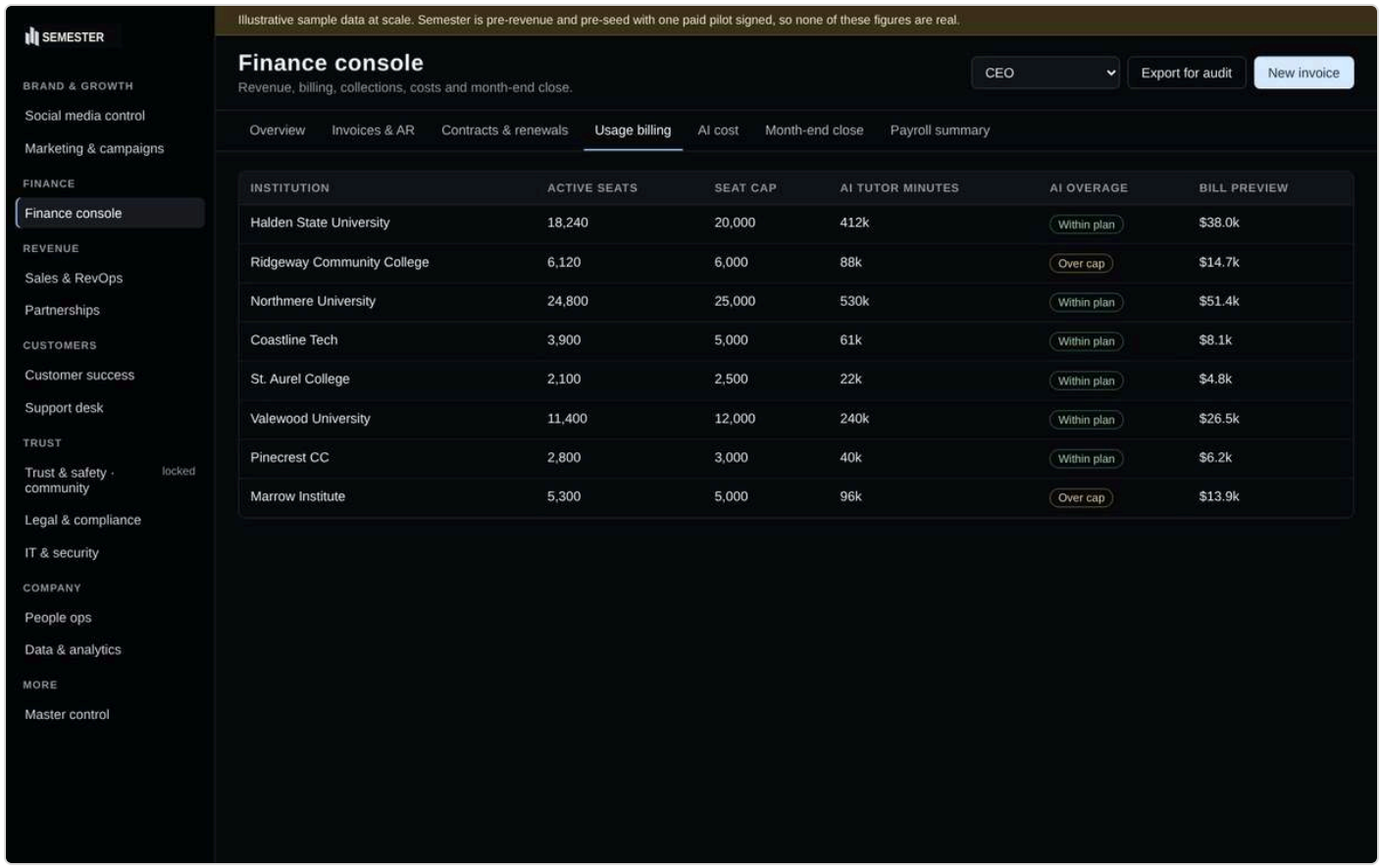
Finance console › New invoice



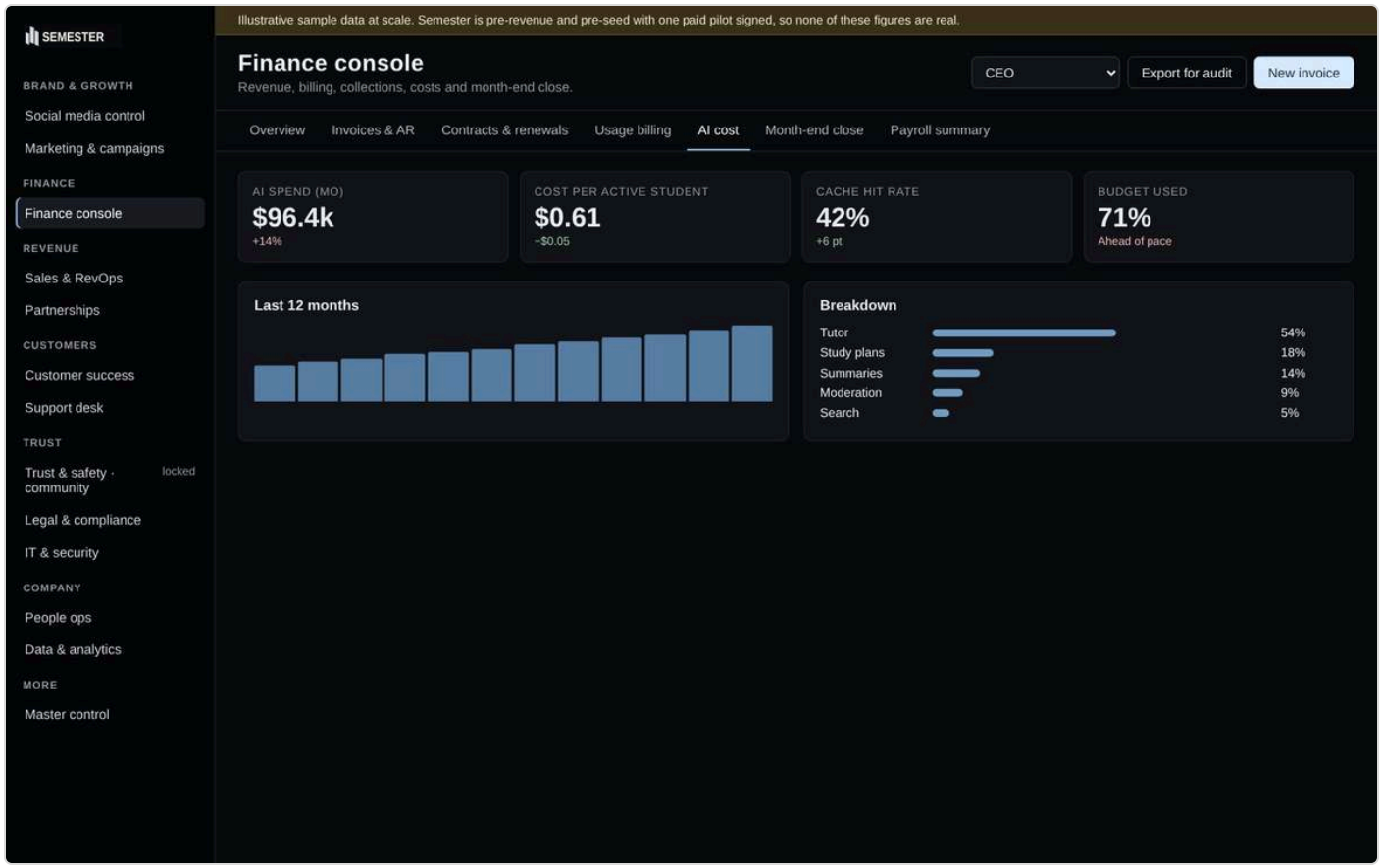
Finance console › Invoices & AR



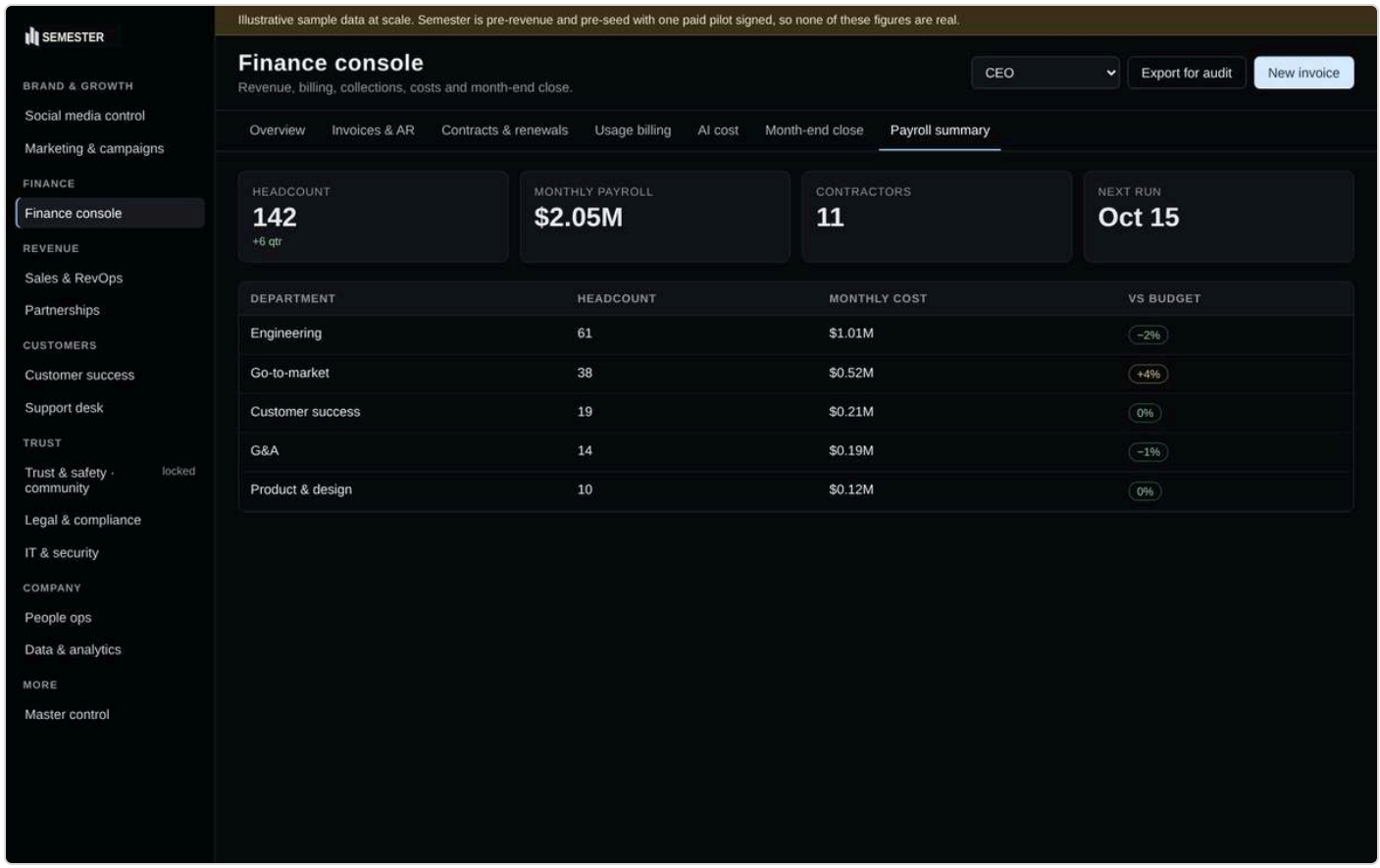
Finance console › Contracts & renewals



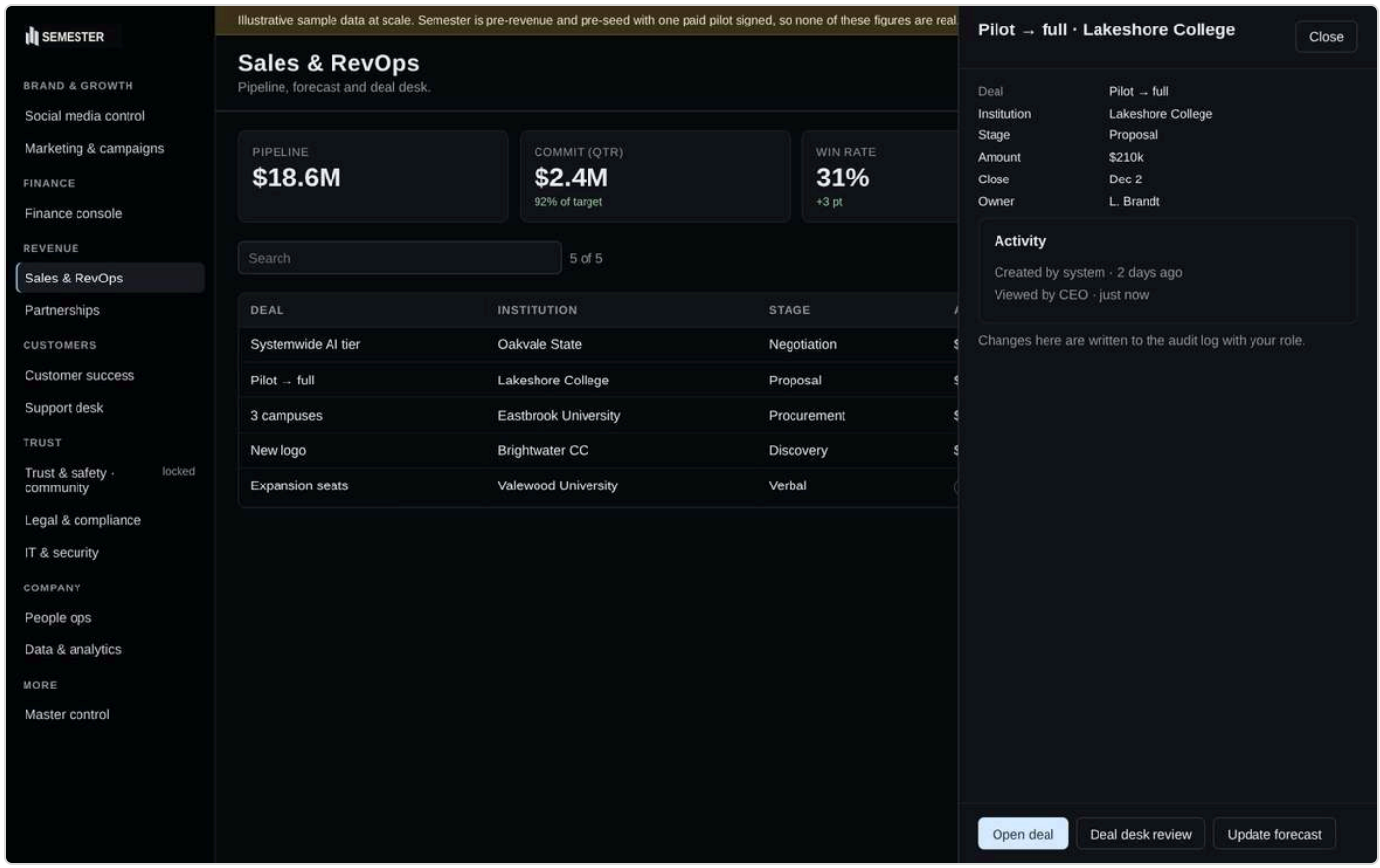
Finance console › Usage billing



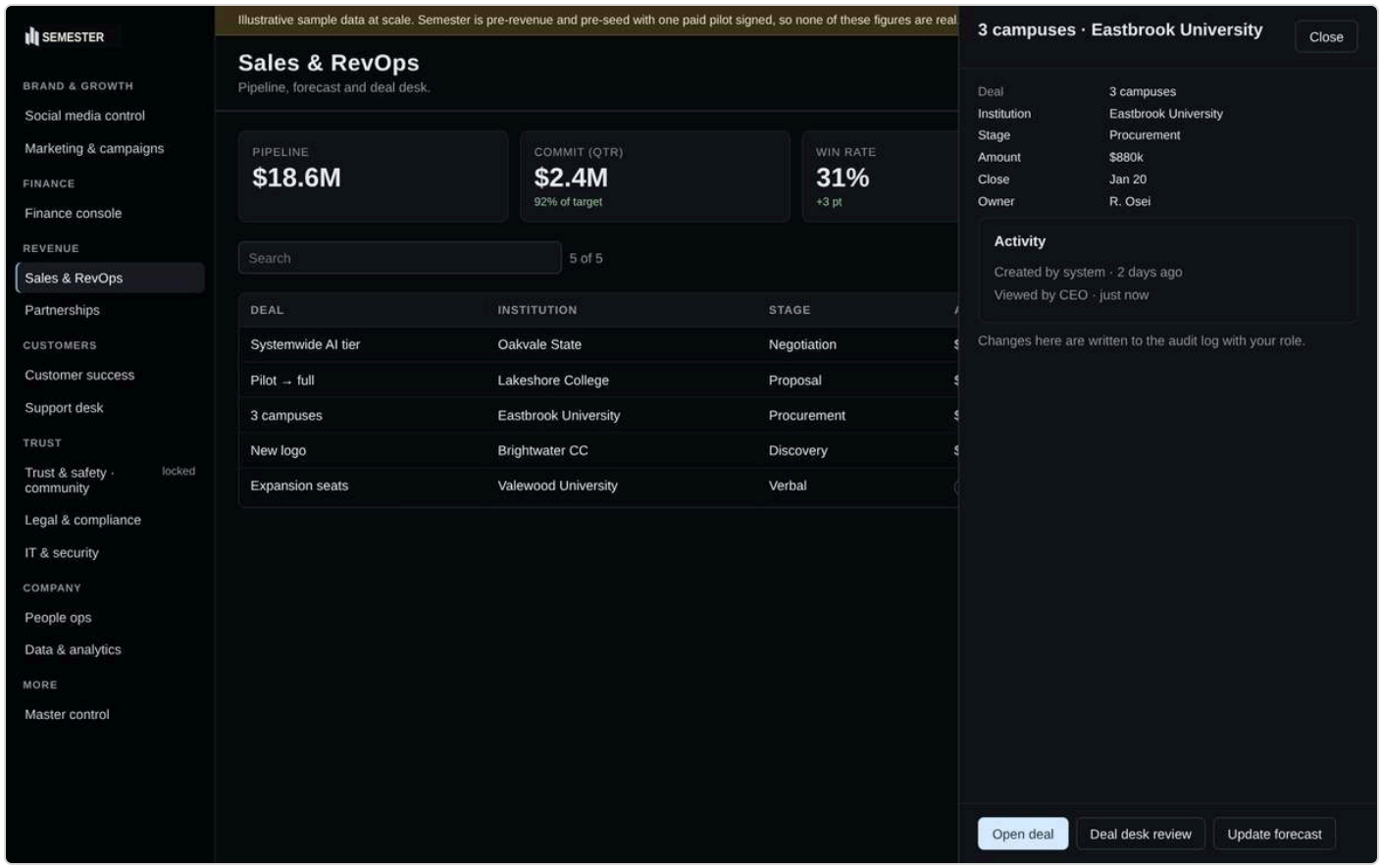
Finance console › AI cost



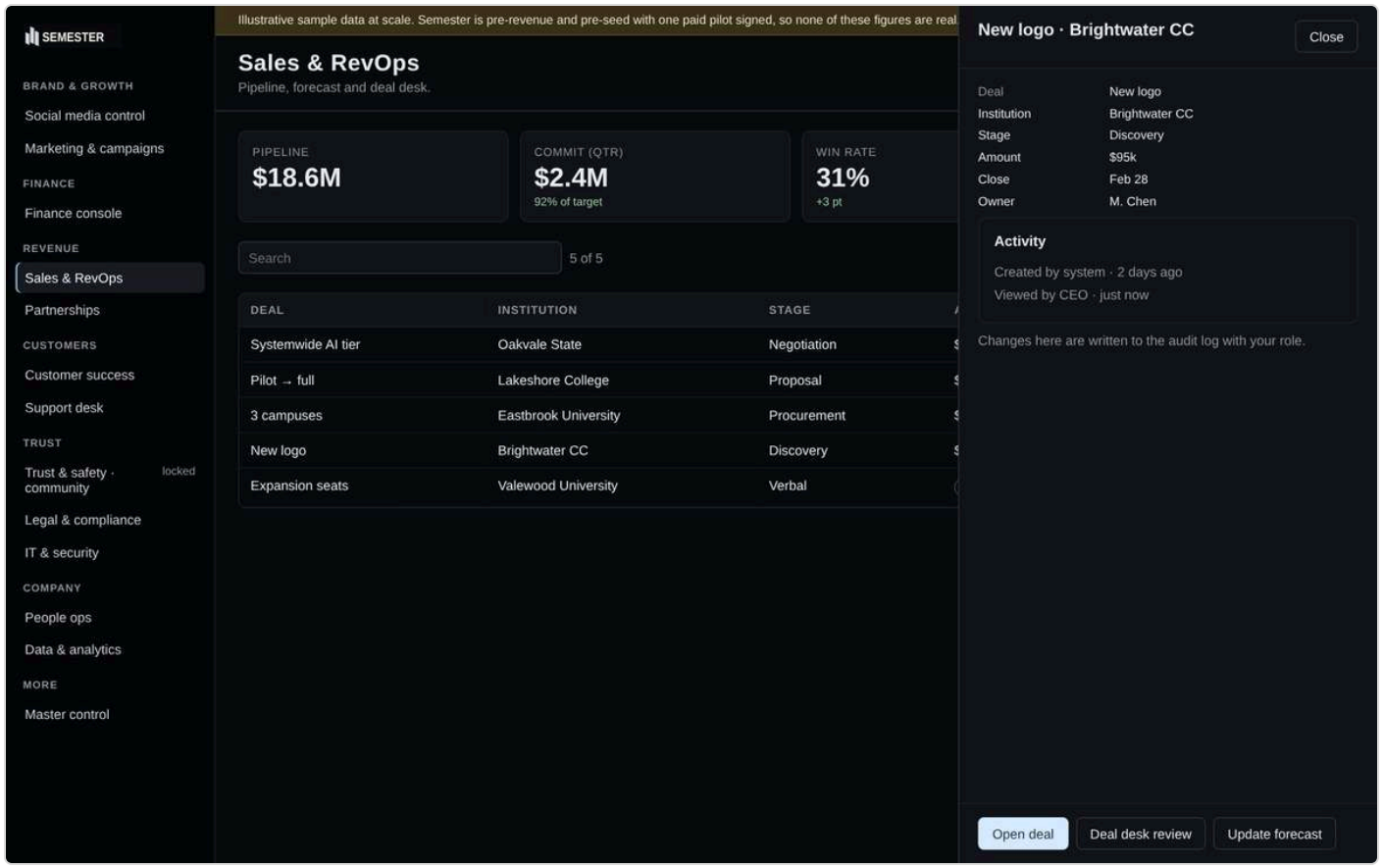
Finance console › Payroll summary



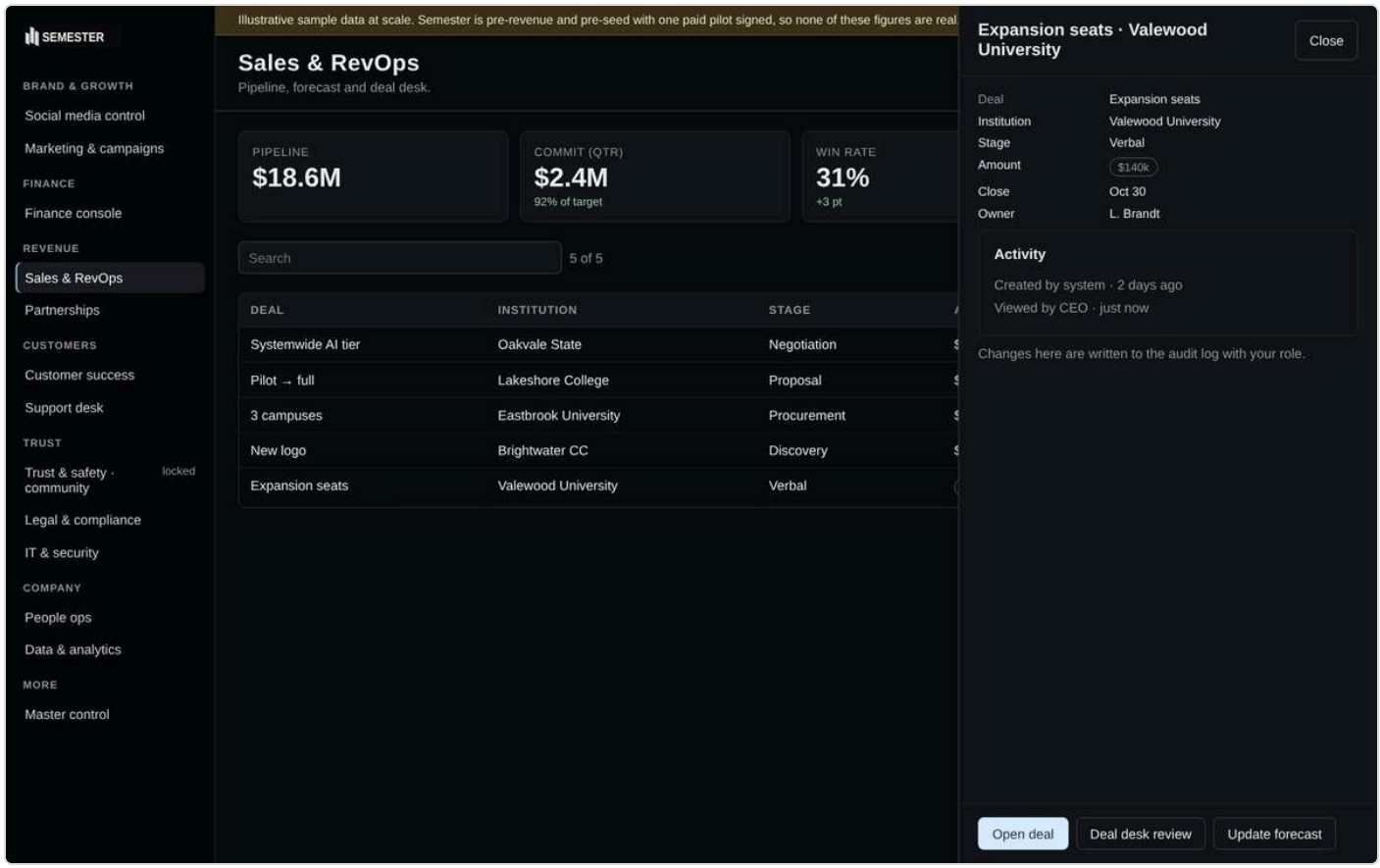
Sales & RevOps › Pilot → full Lakeshore College Proposal $210k Dec 2 L. Brandt



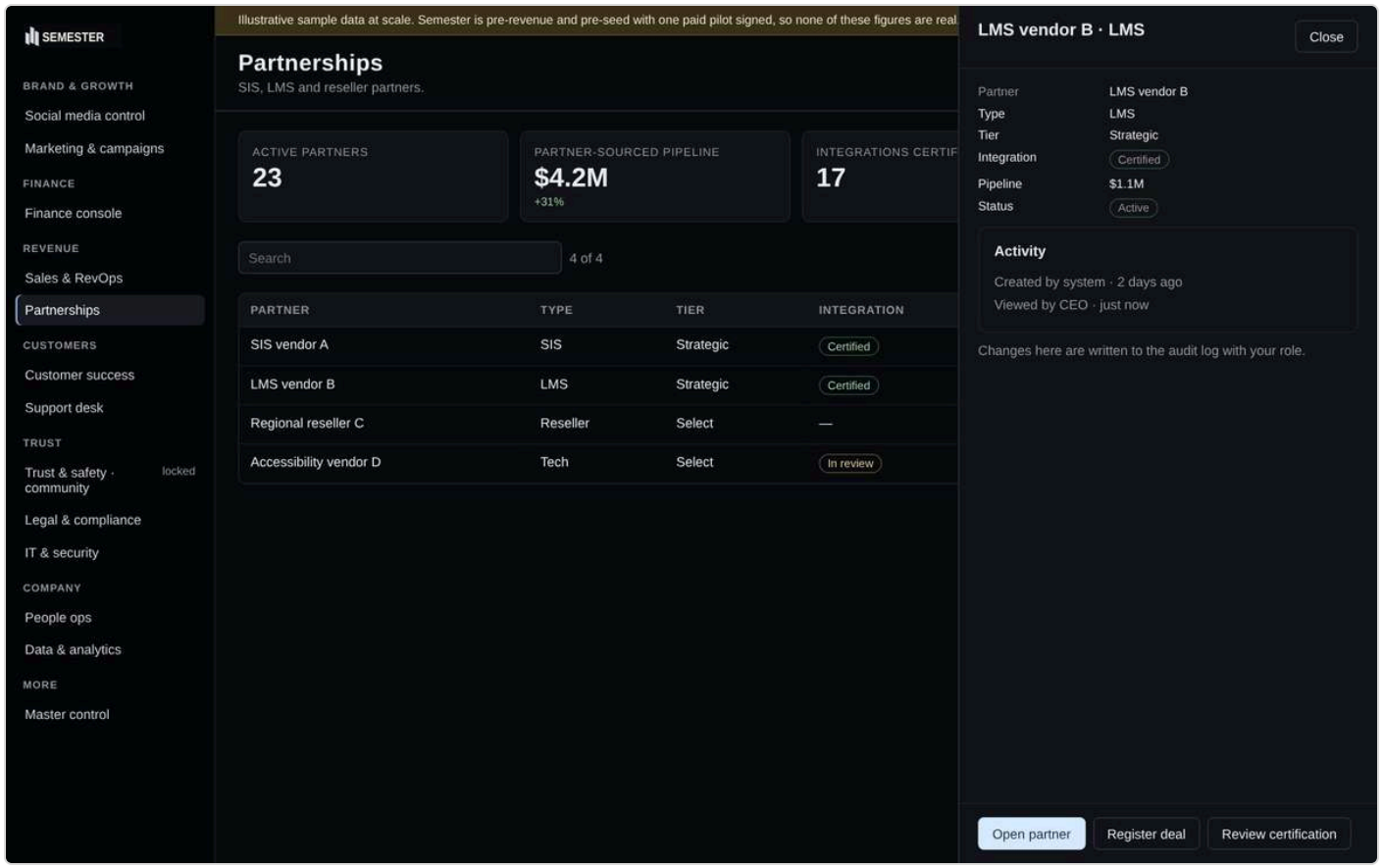
Sales & RevOps › 3 campuses Eastbrook University Procurement $880k Jan 20 R. Osei



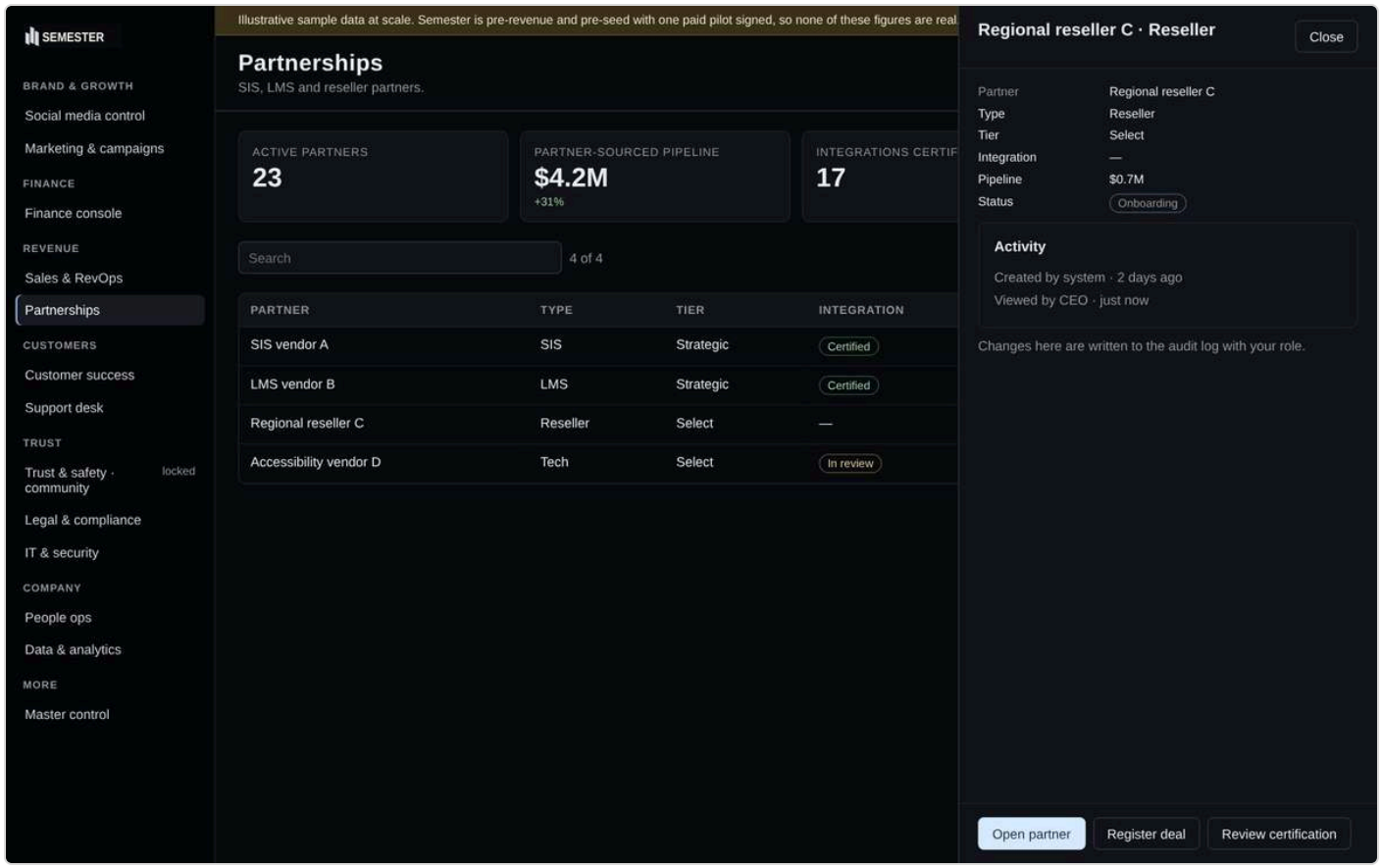
Sales & RevOps › New logo Brightwater CC Discovery $95k Feb 28 M. Chen



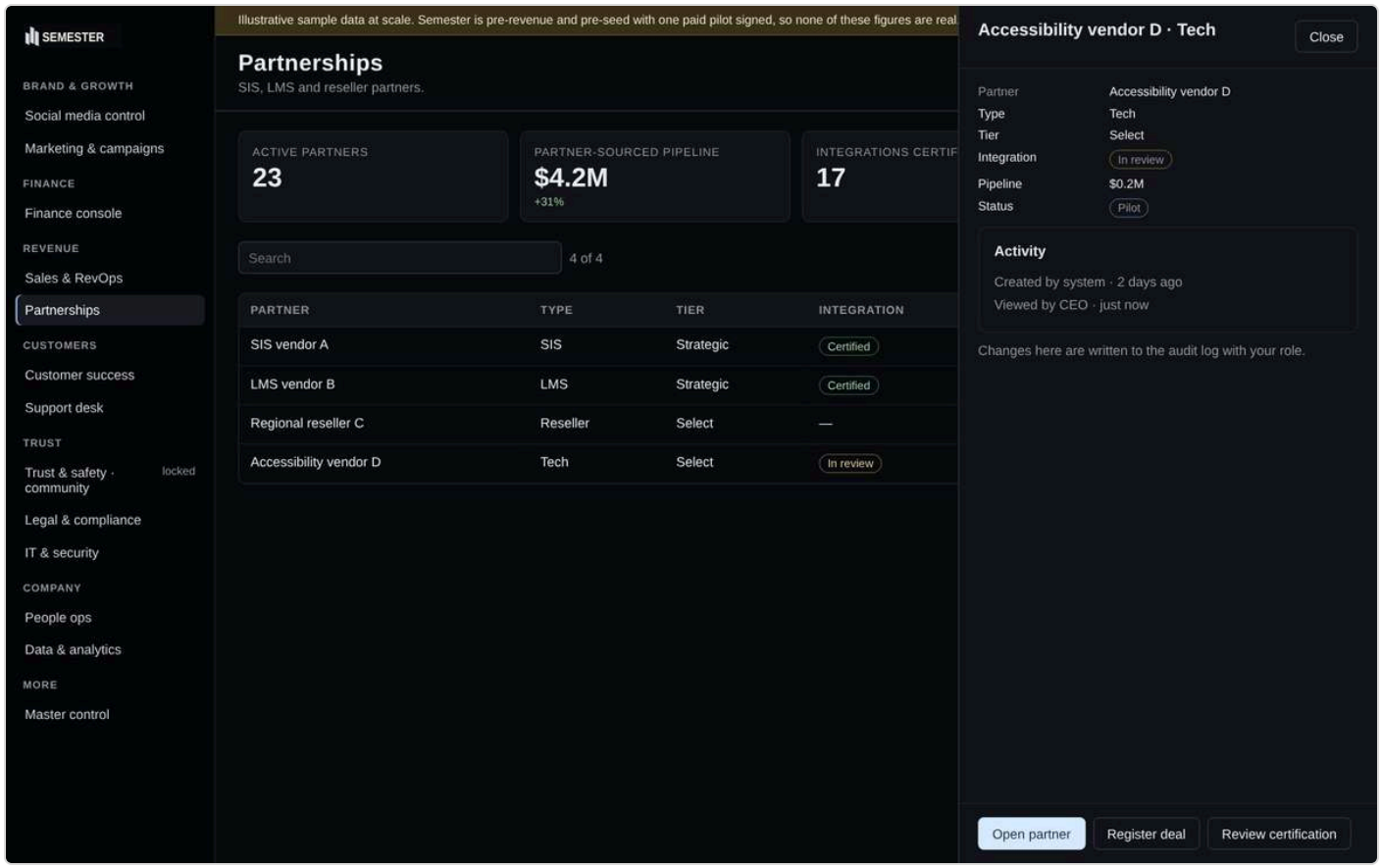
Sales & RevOps › Expansion seats Valewood University Verbal $140k Oct 30 L. Brandt



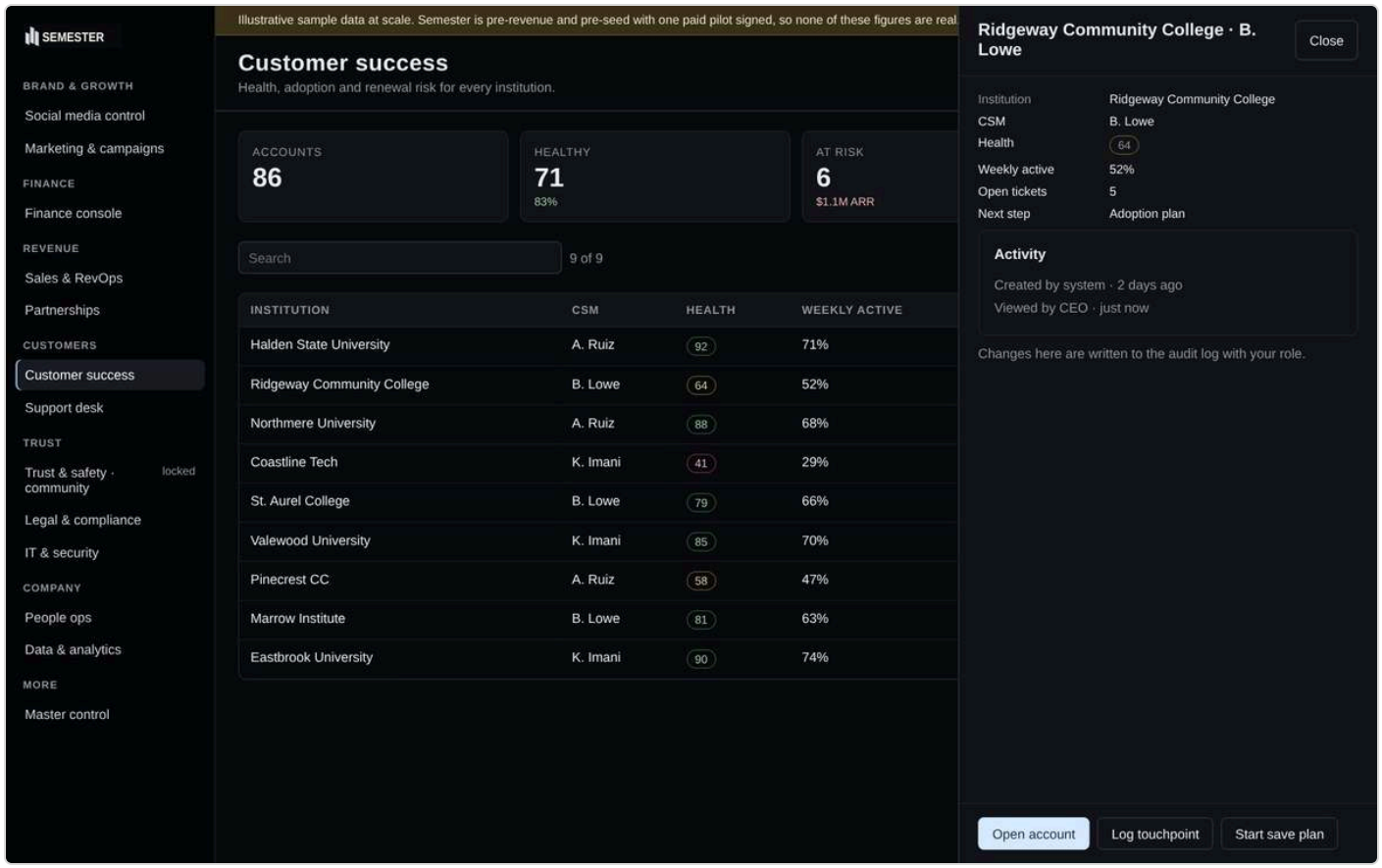
Partnerships › LMS vendor B LMS Strategic Certified $1.1M Active



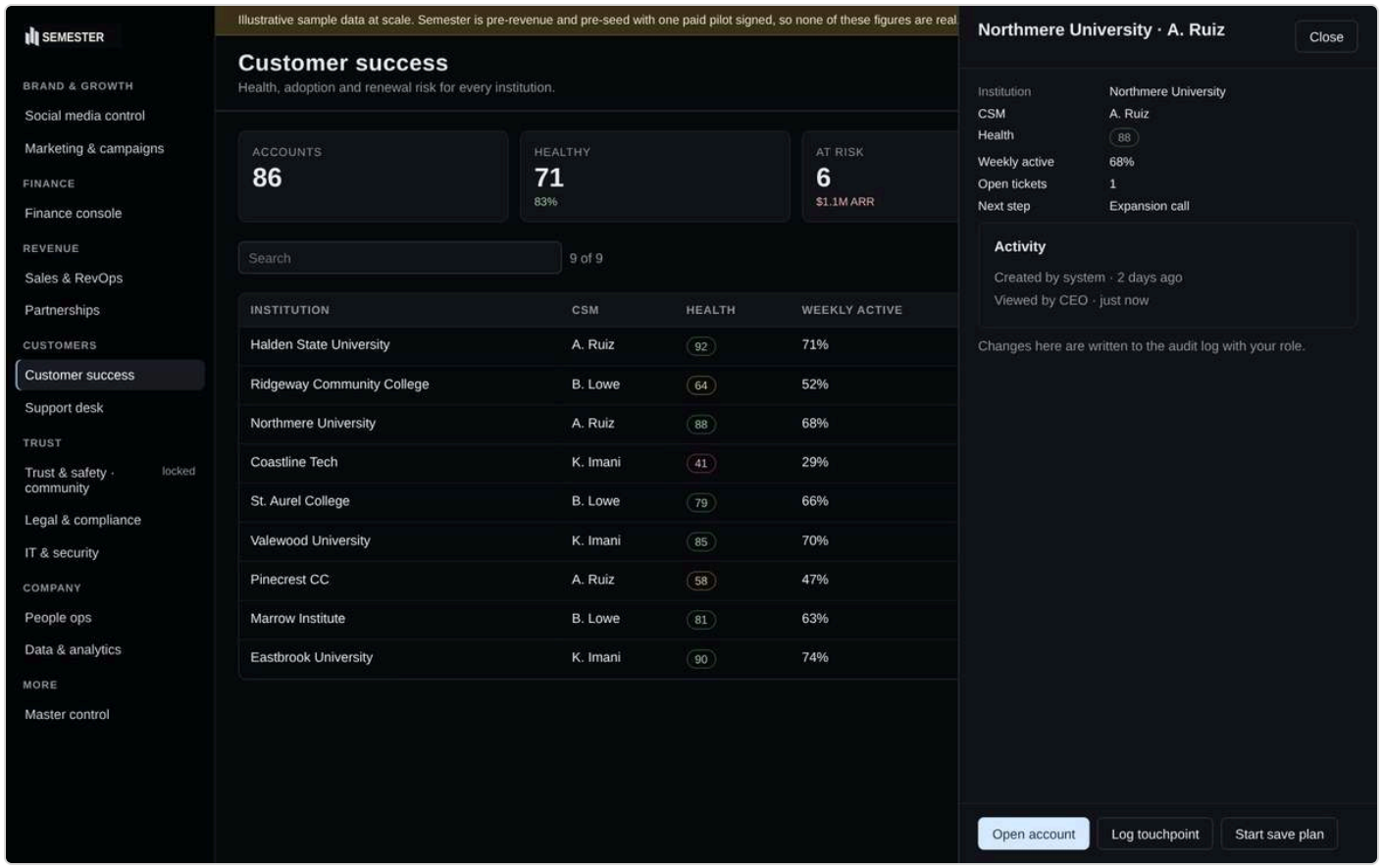
Partnerships › Regional reseller C Reseller Select — $0.7M Onboarding



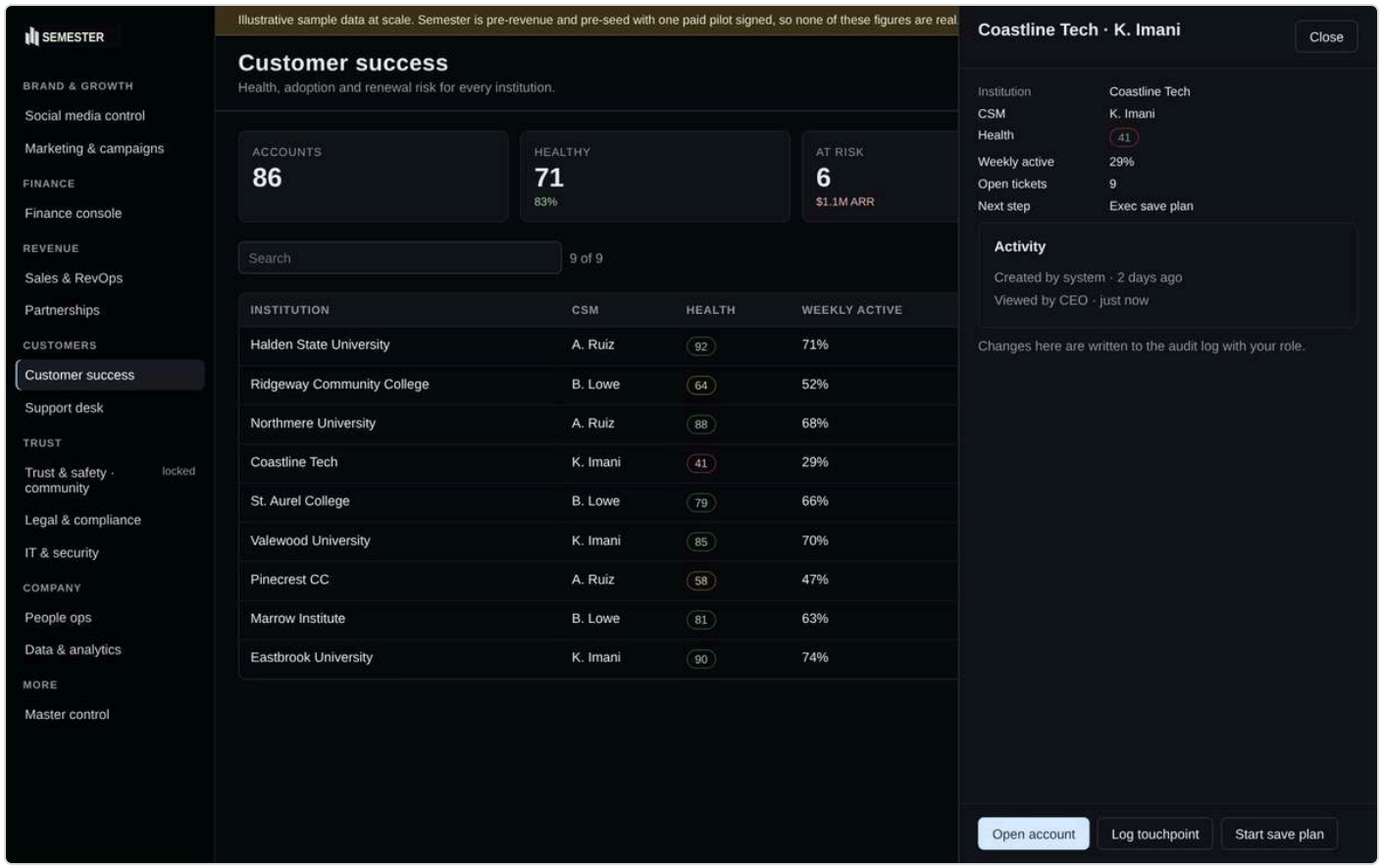
Partnerships › Accessibility vendor D Tech Select In review $0.2M Pilot



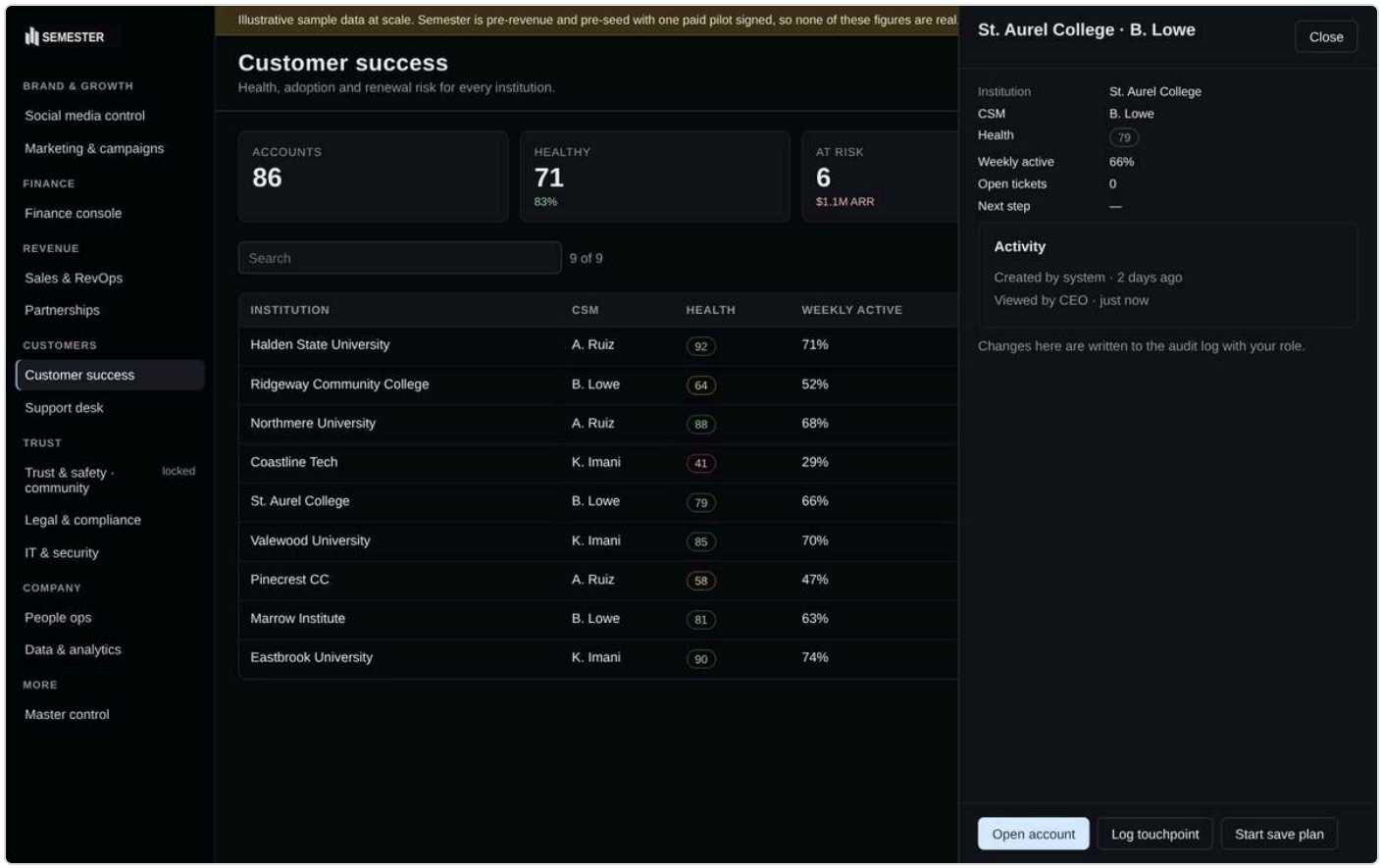
Customer success › Ridgeway Community College B. Lowe 64 52% 5 Adoption plan



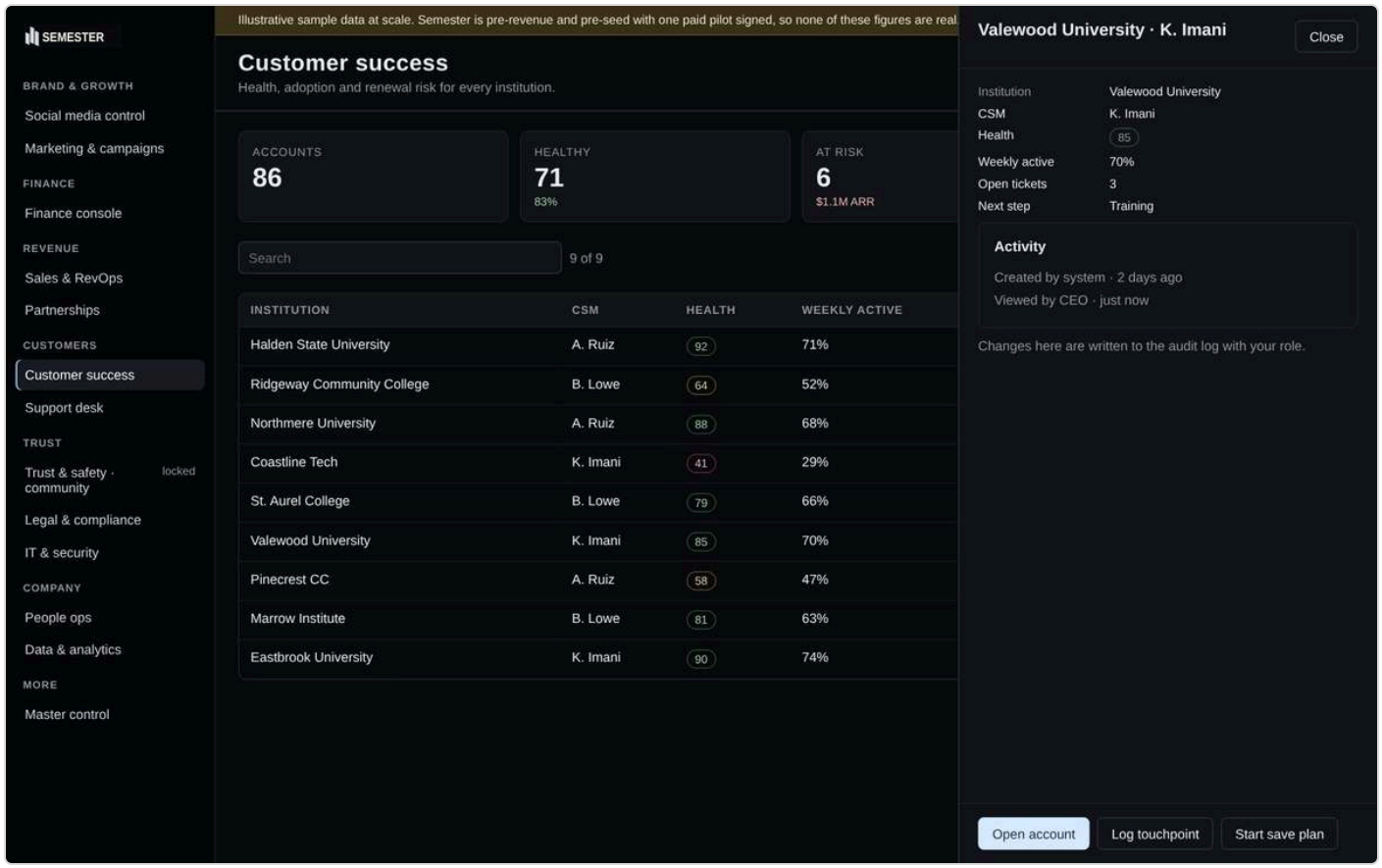
Customer success › Northmere University A. Ruiz 88 68% 1 Expansion call



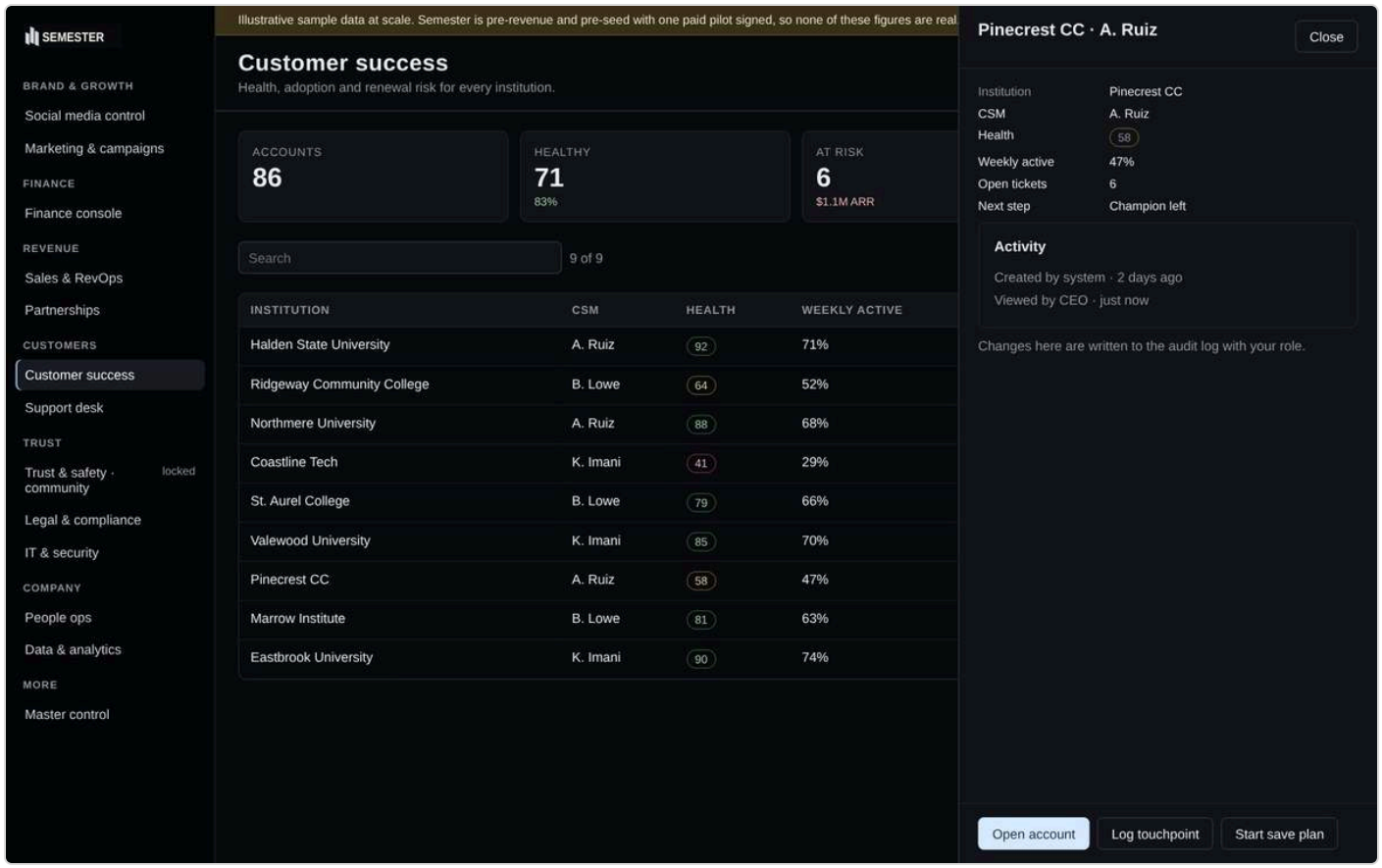
Customer success › Coastline Tech K. Imani 41 29% 9 Exec save plan



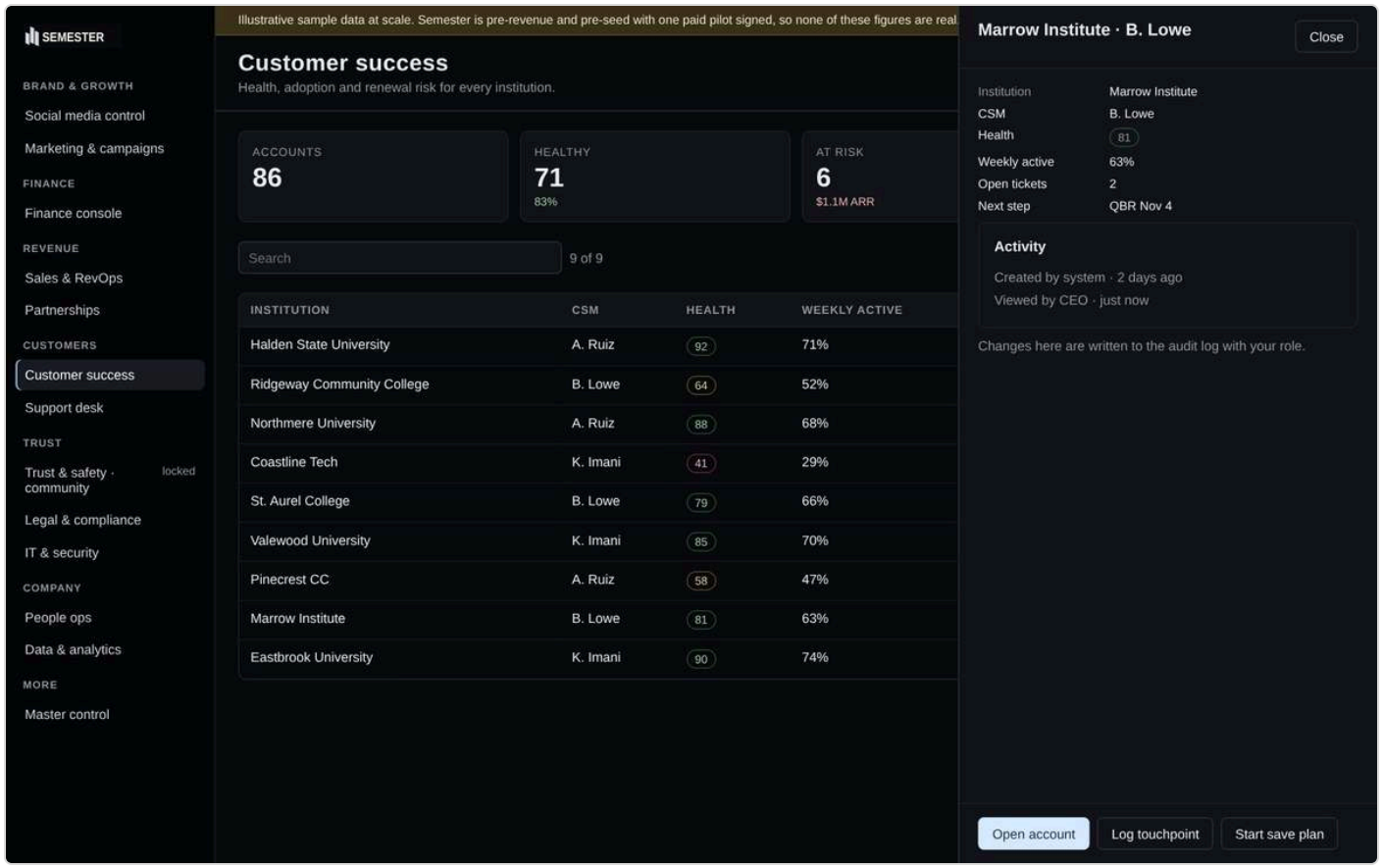
Customer success › St. Aurel College B. Lowe 79 66% 0 —



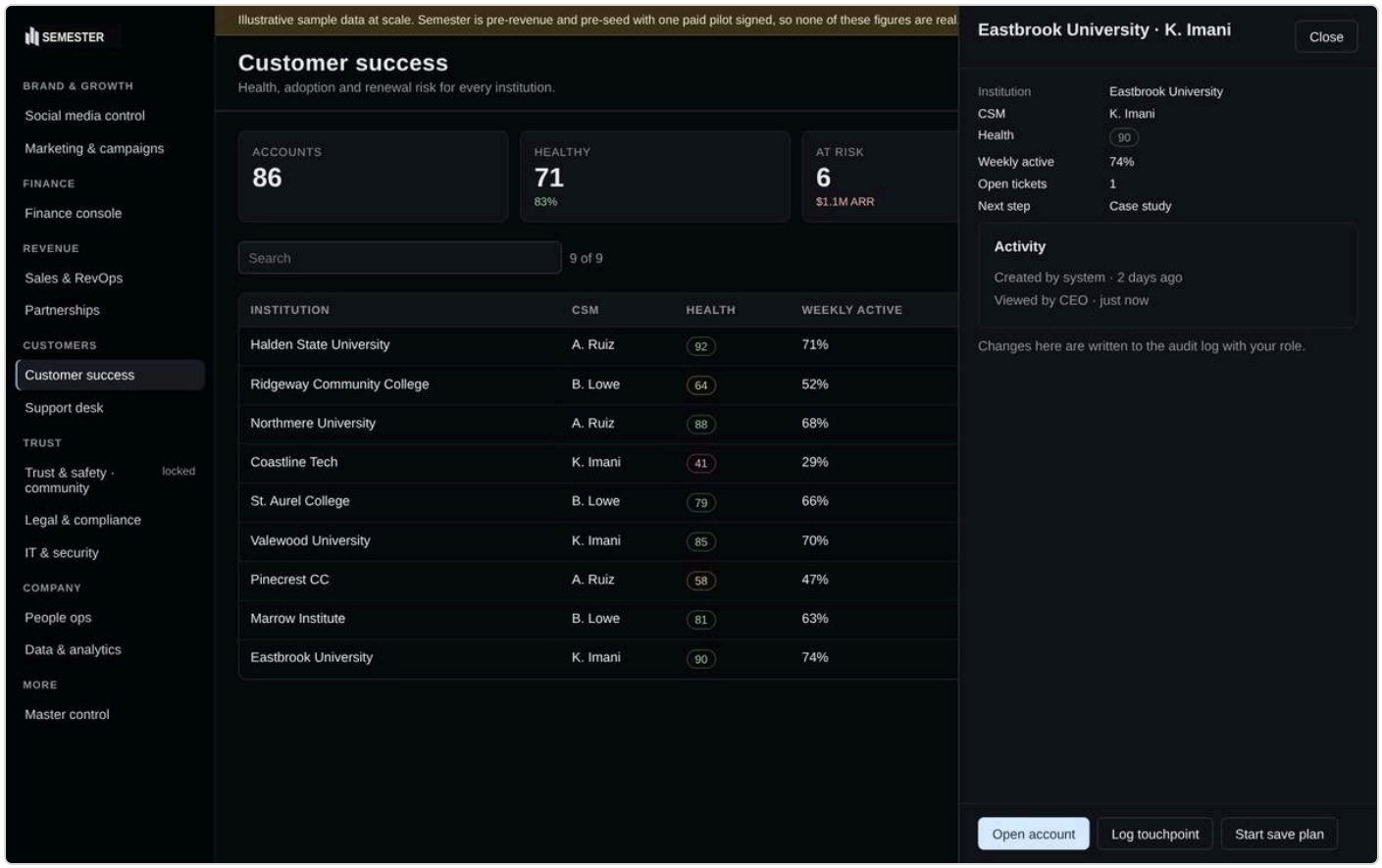
Customer success › Valewood University K. Imani 85 70% 3 Training



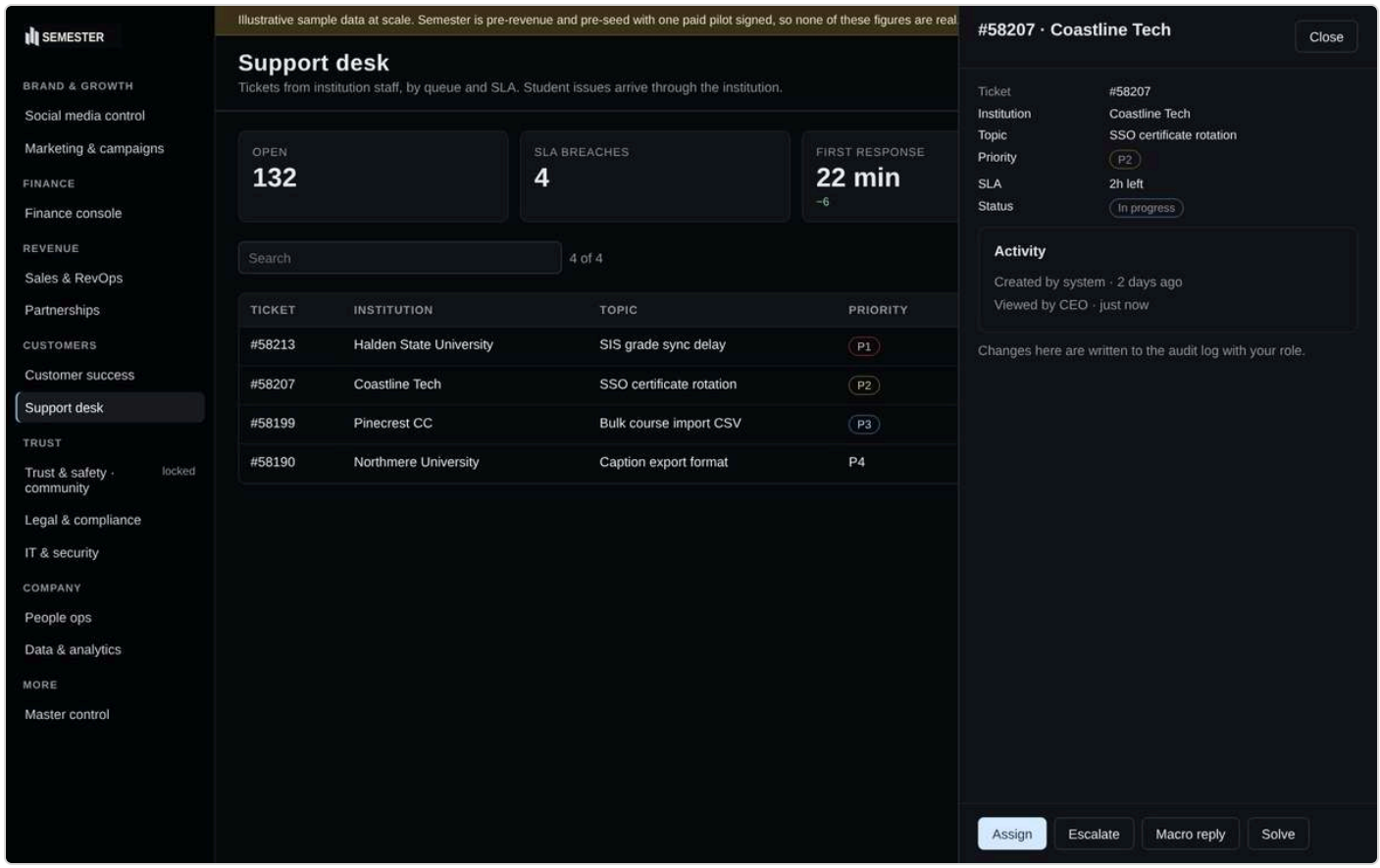
Customer success › Pinecrest CC A. Ruiz 58 47% 6 Champion left



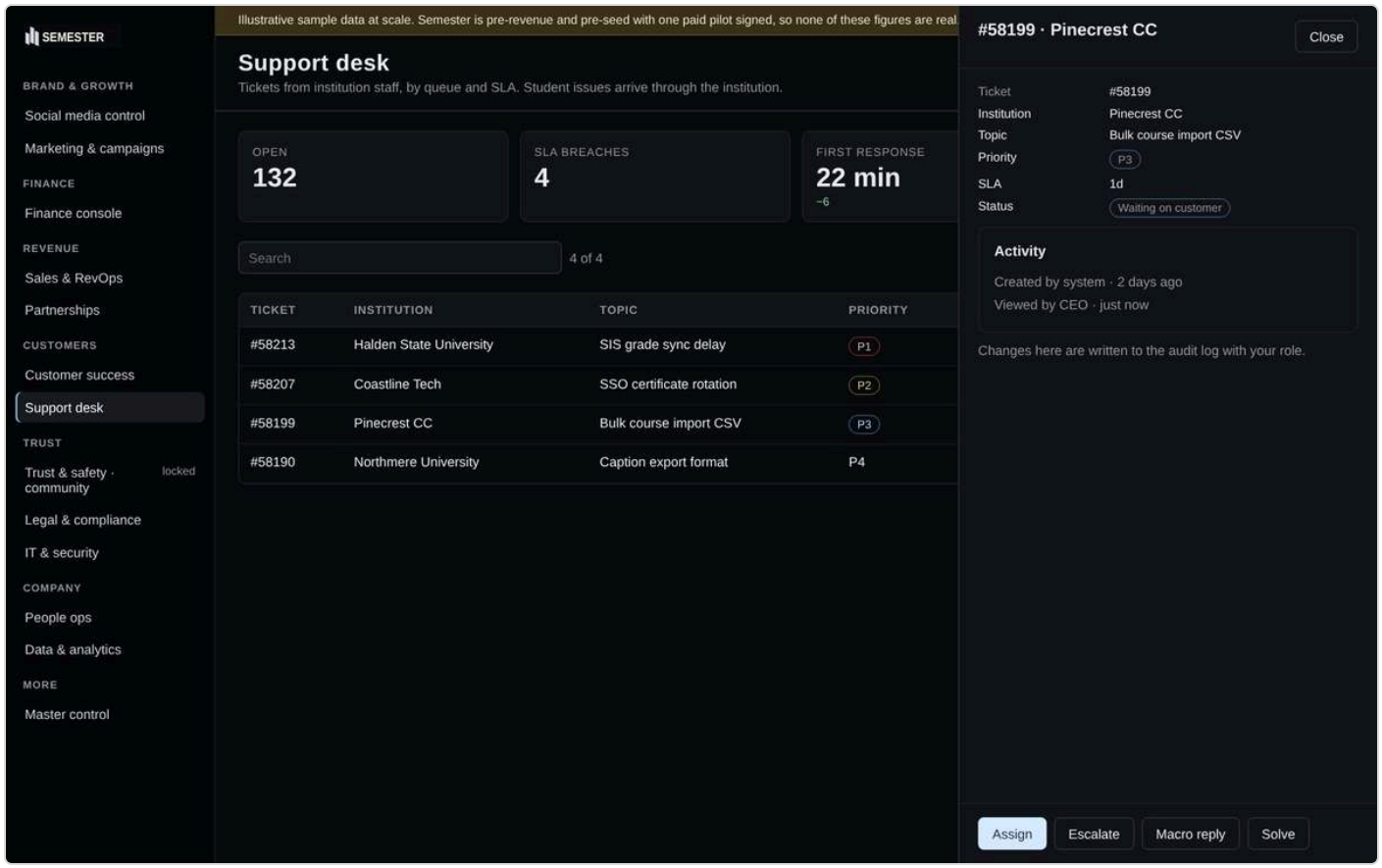
Customer success › Marrow Institute B. Lowe 81 63% 2 QBR Nov 4



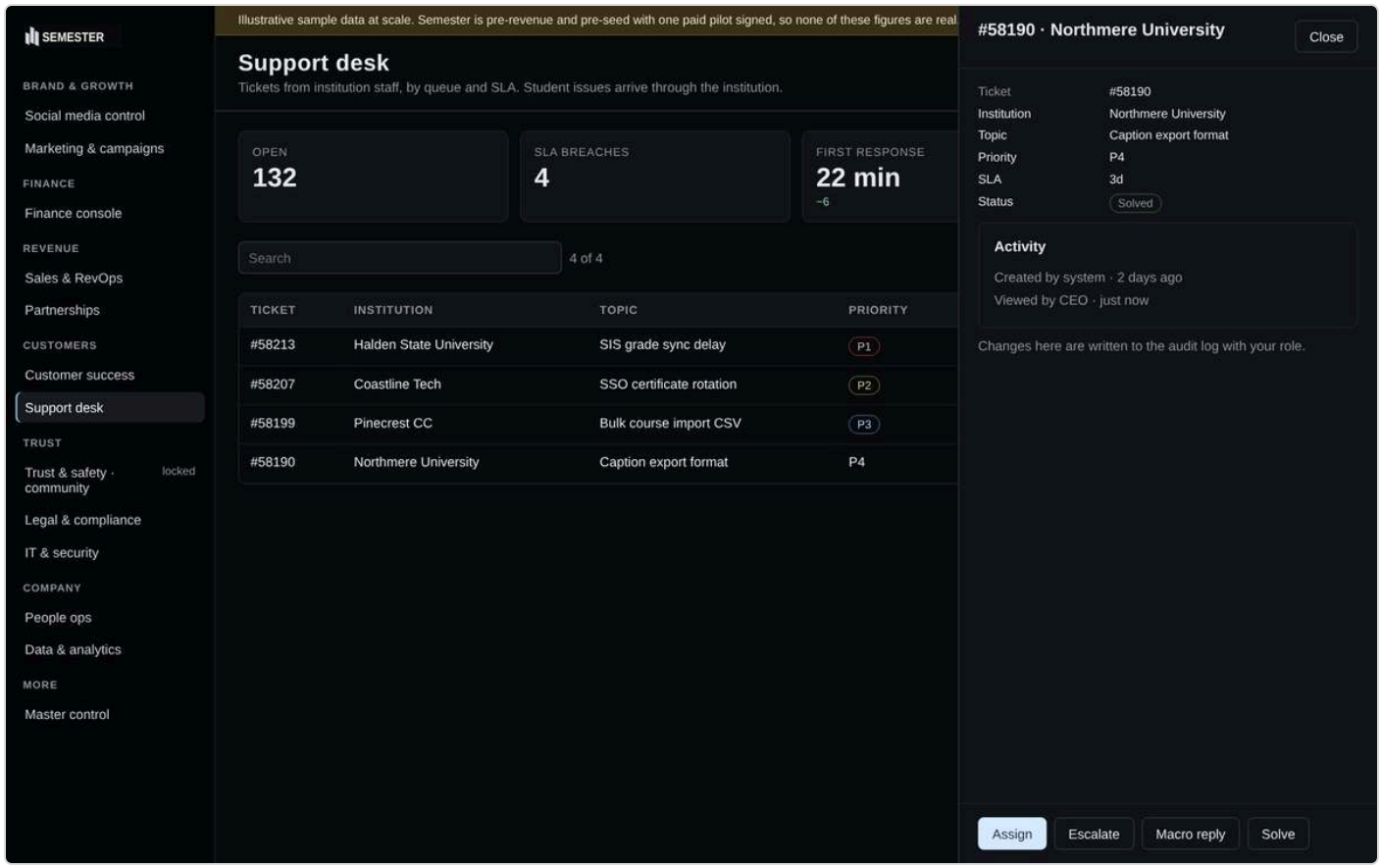
Customer success › Eastbrook University K. Imani 90 74% 1 Case study



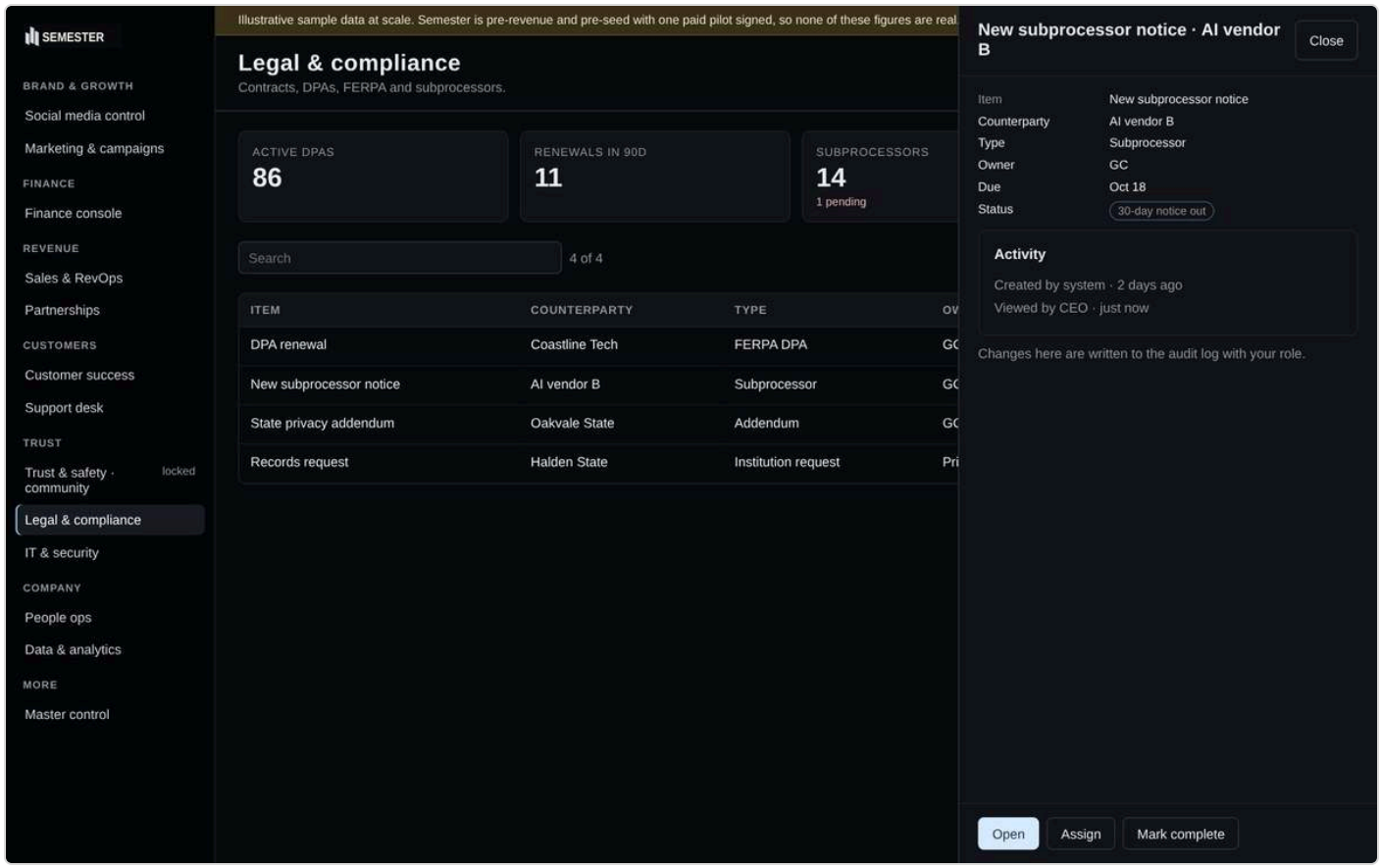
Support desk › #58207 Coastline Tech SSO certificate rotation P2 2h left In progress



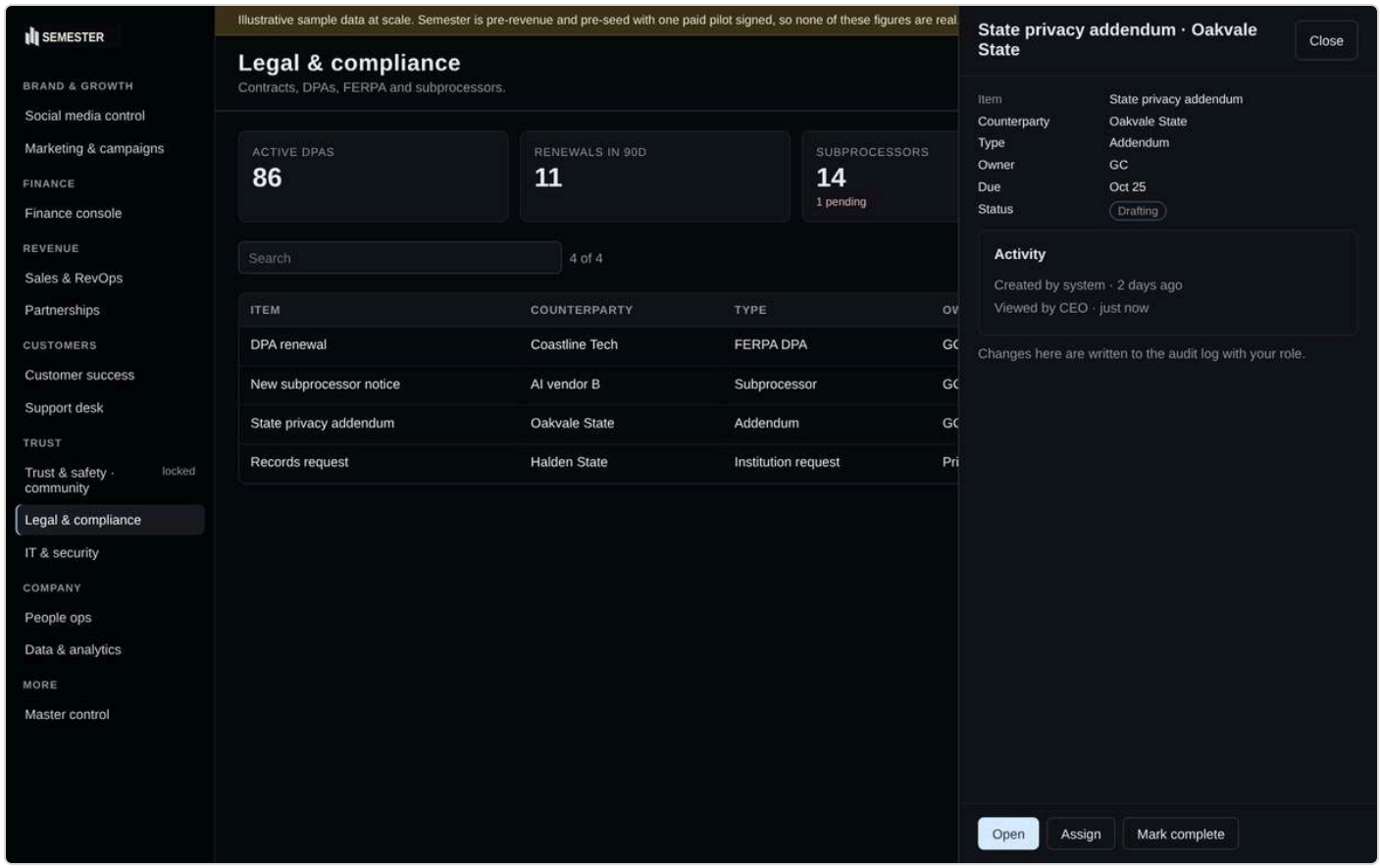
Support desk › #58199 Pinecrest CC Bulk course import CSV P3 1d Waiting on customer



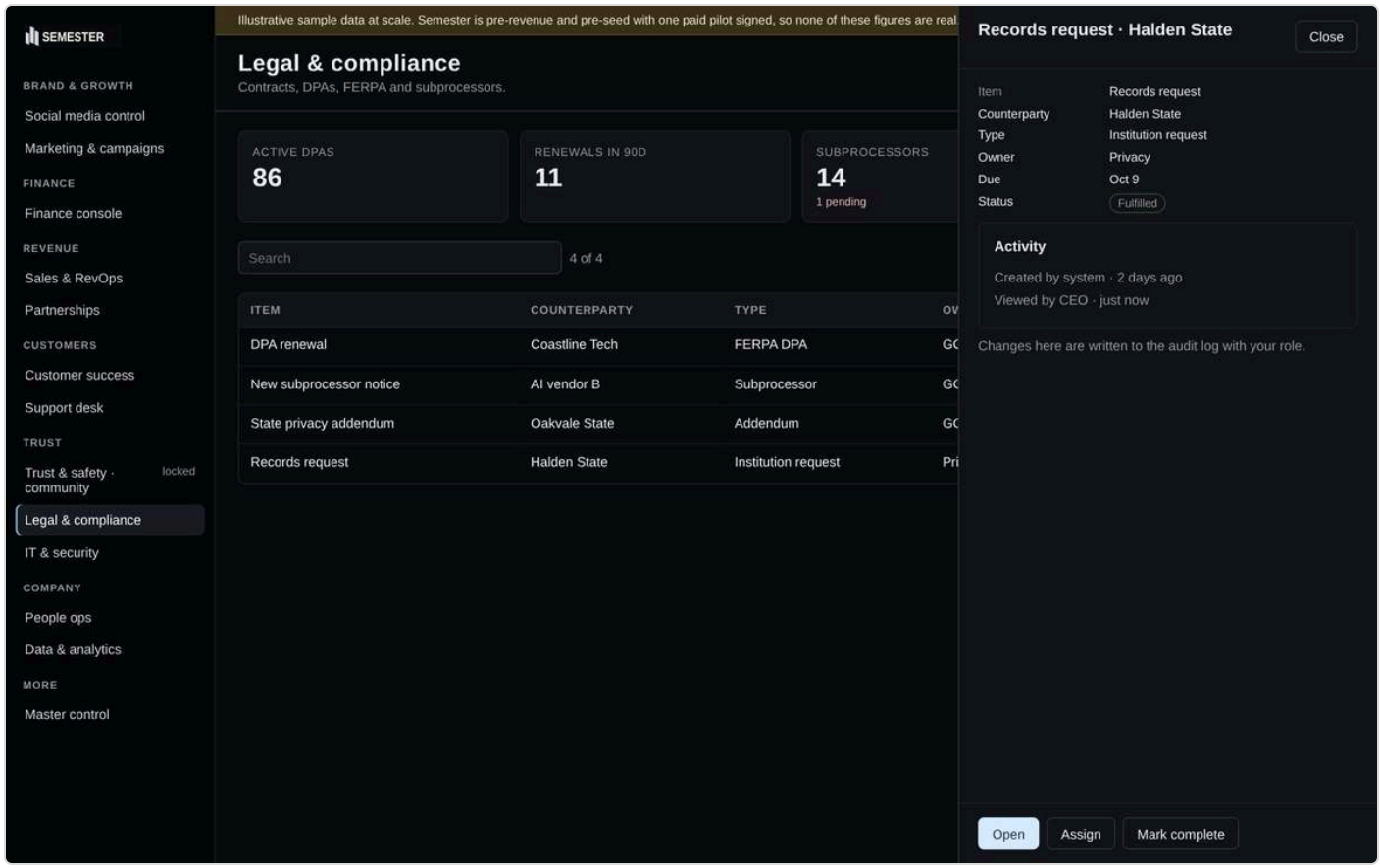
Support desk › #58190 Northmere University Caption export format P4 3d Solved



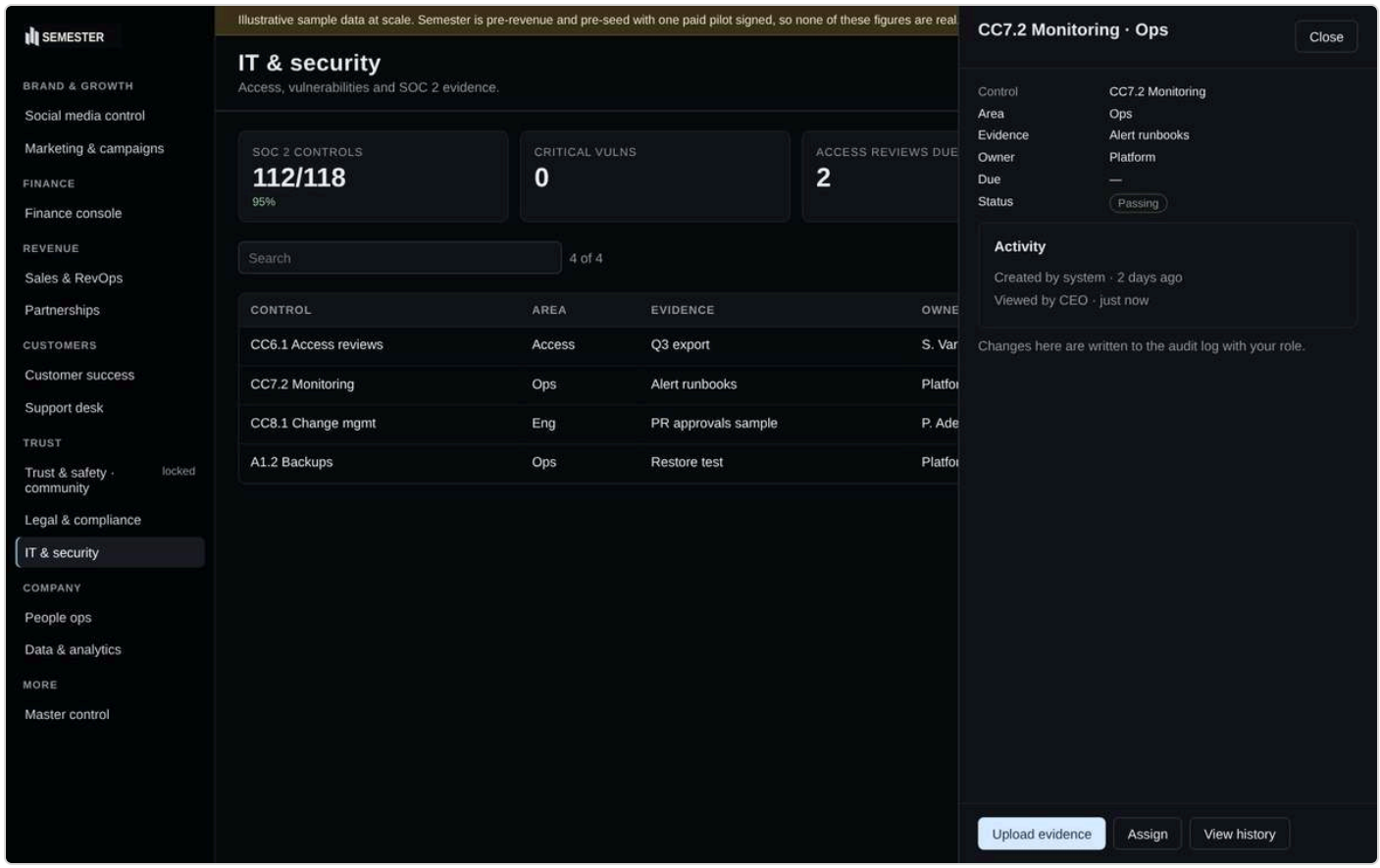
Legal & compliance › New subprocessor notice AI vendor B Subprocessor GC Oct 18 30-day notice out



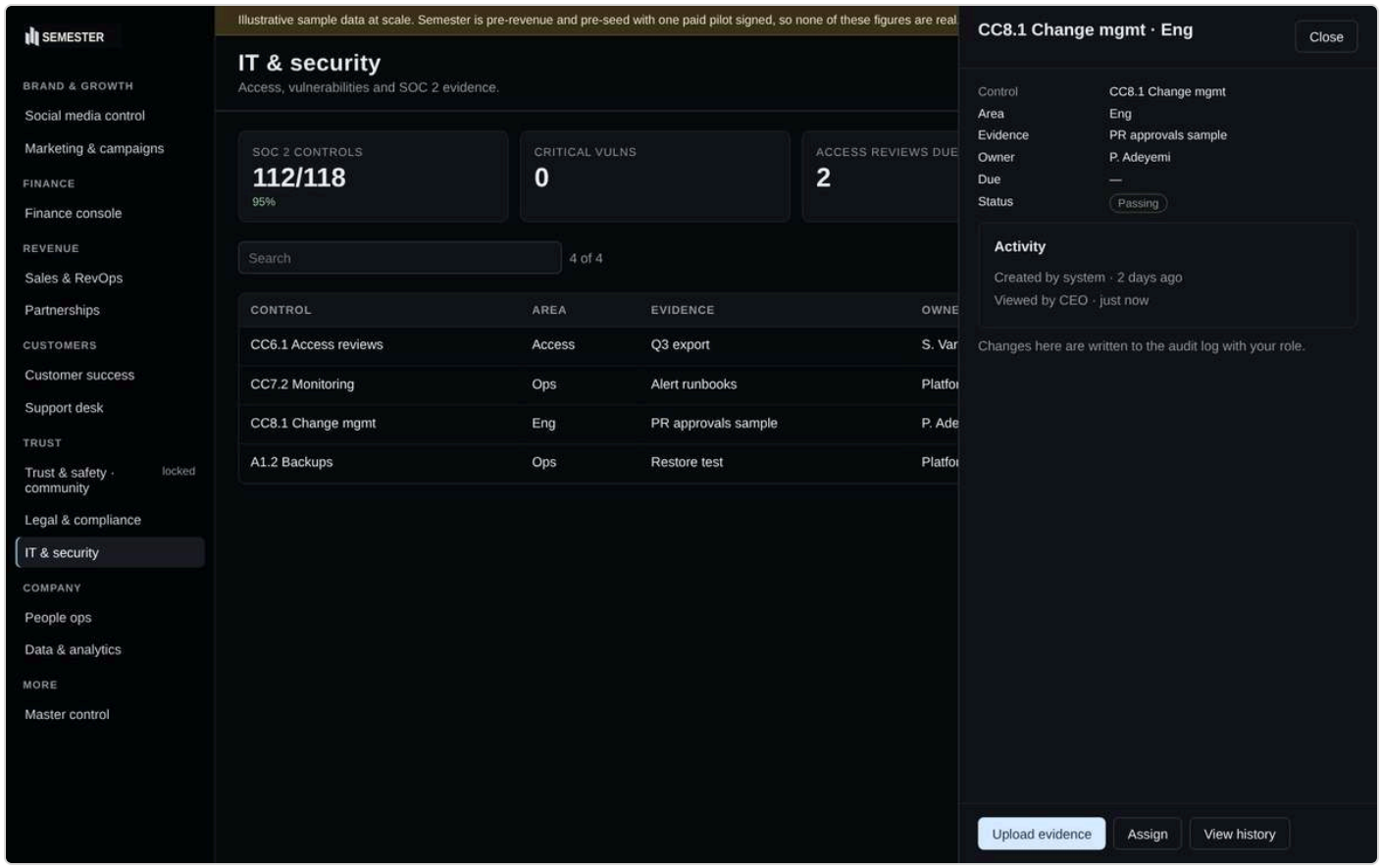
Legal & compliance › State privacy addendum Oakvale State Addendum GC Oct 25 Drafting



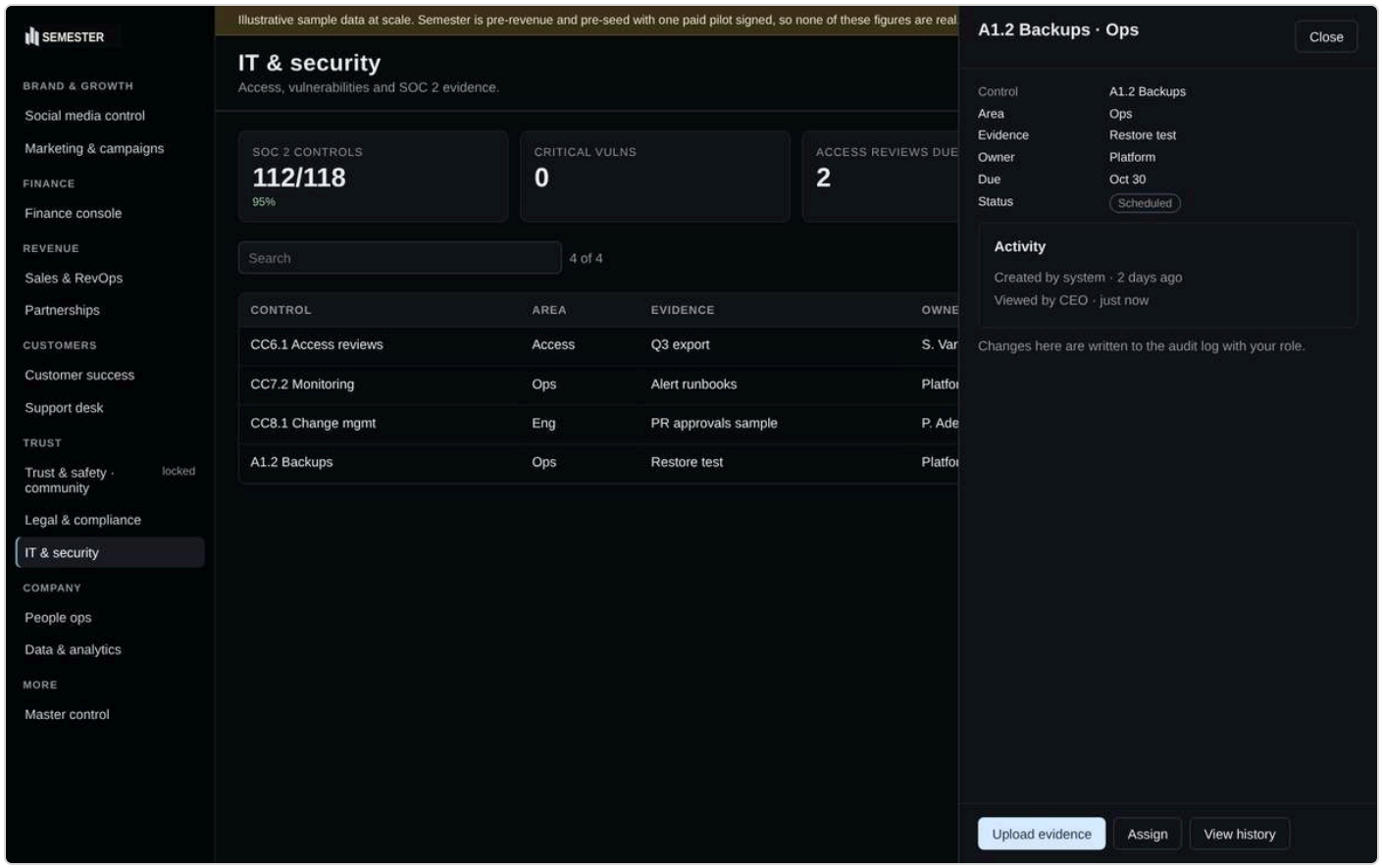
Legal & compliance › Records request Halden State Institution request Privacy Oct 9 Fulfilled



IT & security › CC7.2 Monitoring Ops Alert runbooks Platform — Passing



IT & security › CC8.1 Change mgmt Eng PR approvals sample P. Adeyemi — Passing



IT & security › A1.2 Backups Ops Restore test Platform Oct 30 Scheduled

compliance

SEMESTER

Front-end compliance

WCAG 2.2 · FTC

Front-end compliance auditProduct + company site

Search or ask… ⌘K

On this device only

Compliance

WCAG 2.2 and FTC proof rules

WCAG 2.2

Area	Required checks	Semester implementation	Status
Keyboard	Tab, Shift+Tab, Enter, Space, Escape, arrows reach everything	taps.test.ts, focus clear-top/bottom, skip link	✓In place
Focus visible	2.4.7 / 2.4.11 not obscured	--focus-color ring; scroll margins 96/84px	✓In place
Text alternatives	Images, icons, charts, video	labels.mjs lint; chart tables	◷Partial
Colour + contrast	States never colour-only; 4.5:1 / 3:1	contrast.test.ts (143 pairings); glyph + word + tone	✓In place
Forms	Visible labels, describedby, error text	fields.test.ts; TextField pattern	✓In place
Reflow + zoom	320px, 200%/400% zoom	breakpoints.test.ts; sweep:spacing	◷Partial — needs manual pass
Target size	2.5.8 ≥ 24px; 44px ordinary	taps.test.ts	✓In place
Dialogs	Focus in, trapped, returns; Escape closes	ConfirmDialog	✓In place
Motion	Reduced motion honoured	motion.test.ts; data-calm	✓In place
Media	Captions, transcript, no autoplay	Not audited	!Gap
Consistent help	3.2.6 same place on every page	ScreenGuide · Help	◷Partial
Accessible auth	3.3.8 no cognitive test	SAML SSO; magic link	✓In place
Redundant entry	3.3.7 don't ask twice	Not audited	!Gap

FTC proof hierarchy

Proof

Proof type	Can publish?	Required evidence
Product screenshot	Yes, if current	Product owner review + "demo data" label
Customer logo	Only with permission	Written logo-use approval
Testimonial / quote	Only with consent	Signed approval record; real customer; no edits to meaning
Outcome statistic	Not yet	Measured baseline, method, sample, authority (CLM-014)
"Compliant / certified"	No	Only with a qualified audit
Paid/partner endorsement	Only disclosed	Clear "sponsored" or "partner" label

Claims rule Say "Semester is working toward an accessible experience and maintains an accessibility conformance report." Never "fully accessible" or "WCAG compliant" without a qualified audit.

- ✓ Manual test protocolKeyboard-only, screen reader, 320px, 200% zoom, forced colours
- Testimonial approval recordWho, what, consent date, expiry

Release gate — public pages

Company site · 5 pages

Release gate

Category	Requirement	Test	Site status
Structure	One h1, ordered headings, header/nav/main/footer	Semantic outline	✓In place
Keyboard	Nav, forms, tabs, pricing reachable	Tab / Shift+Tab / Enter / Escape	✓In place
Focus	Visible, not under sticky header	Manual tab-through	✓In place
Contrast	Text, buttons, states 4.5:1 / 3:1	Automated + manual	◷Partial
Colour reliance	Status never colour-only	Greyscale review	✓In place
Forms	Visible labels, required marks, field errors	Submit invalid + valid	◷Partial
Errors	Name field, say how to fix, focus first error	Screen reader	✓In place
Mobile	320px, landscape, 200% zoom	Emulator + manual	◷Partial — needs manual pass
Motion	prefers-reduced-motion honoured	OS setting	✓In place
Tables	Caption, scoped headers, sort buttons	Inspect	✓In place
Timing	No short form timeout	Wait test	✓In place
Language	lang set; acronyms explained once	Content review	◷Partial
Third-party	Calendar/chat/video have accessible fallback	Block and test	!Gap

Form validation states

Work email (required)We reply within two business days.

Work email (required)maya@ !Enter a full email address, like name@university.edu.

✓Request sent

Check your inbox for a confirmation.

Testimonial component rules

Render only if
: Signed approval, real person, current, meaning unedited

Disclose
: Beside the quote: "Pilot participant, Fall 2026" · paid/partner if any

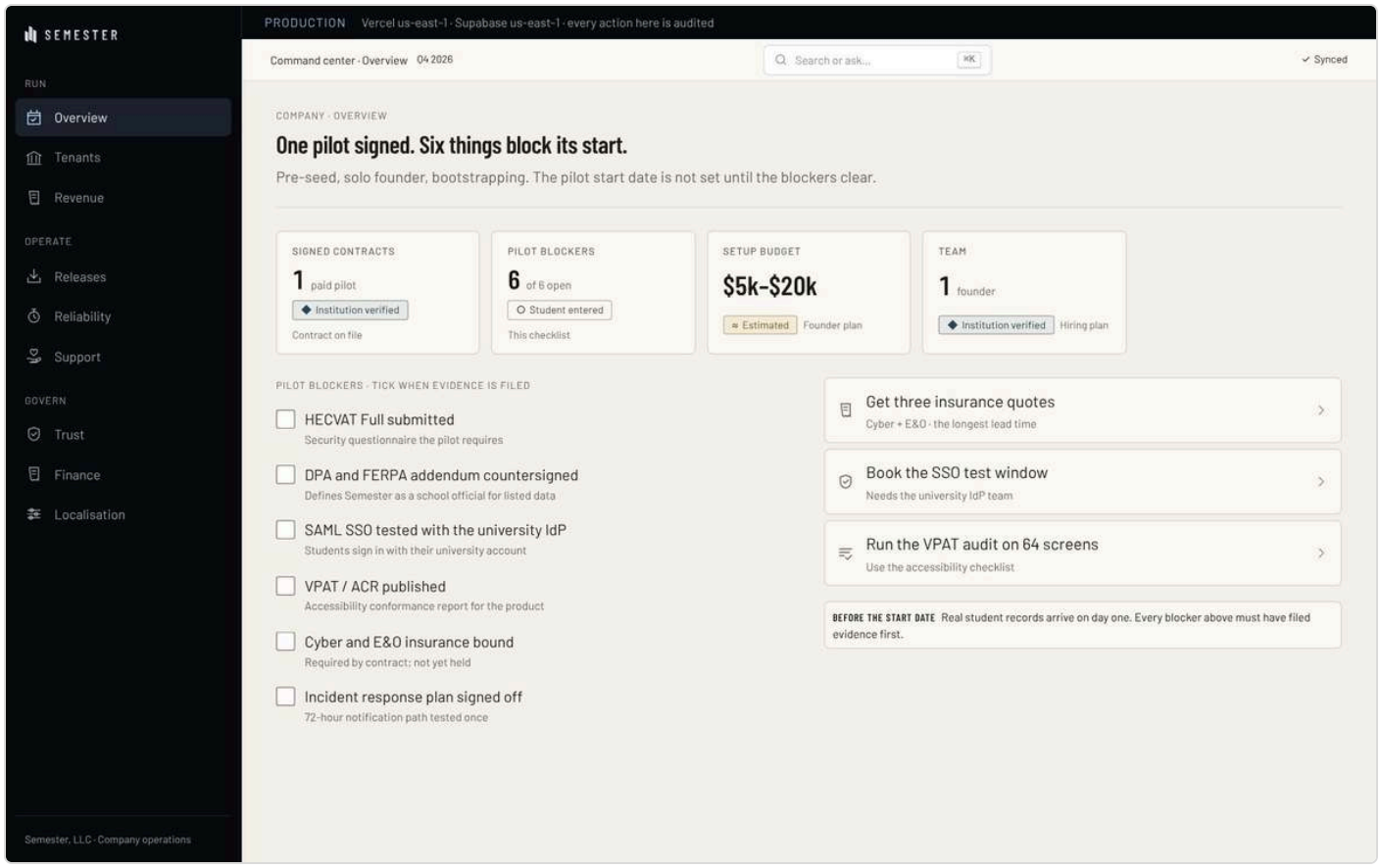
Before customers exist
: No testimonials; screenshots labelled "illustrative product view"

Publish gate
: No unresolved critical a11y issue, unsupported claim or missing disclosure

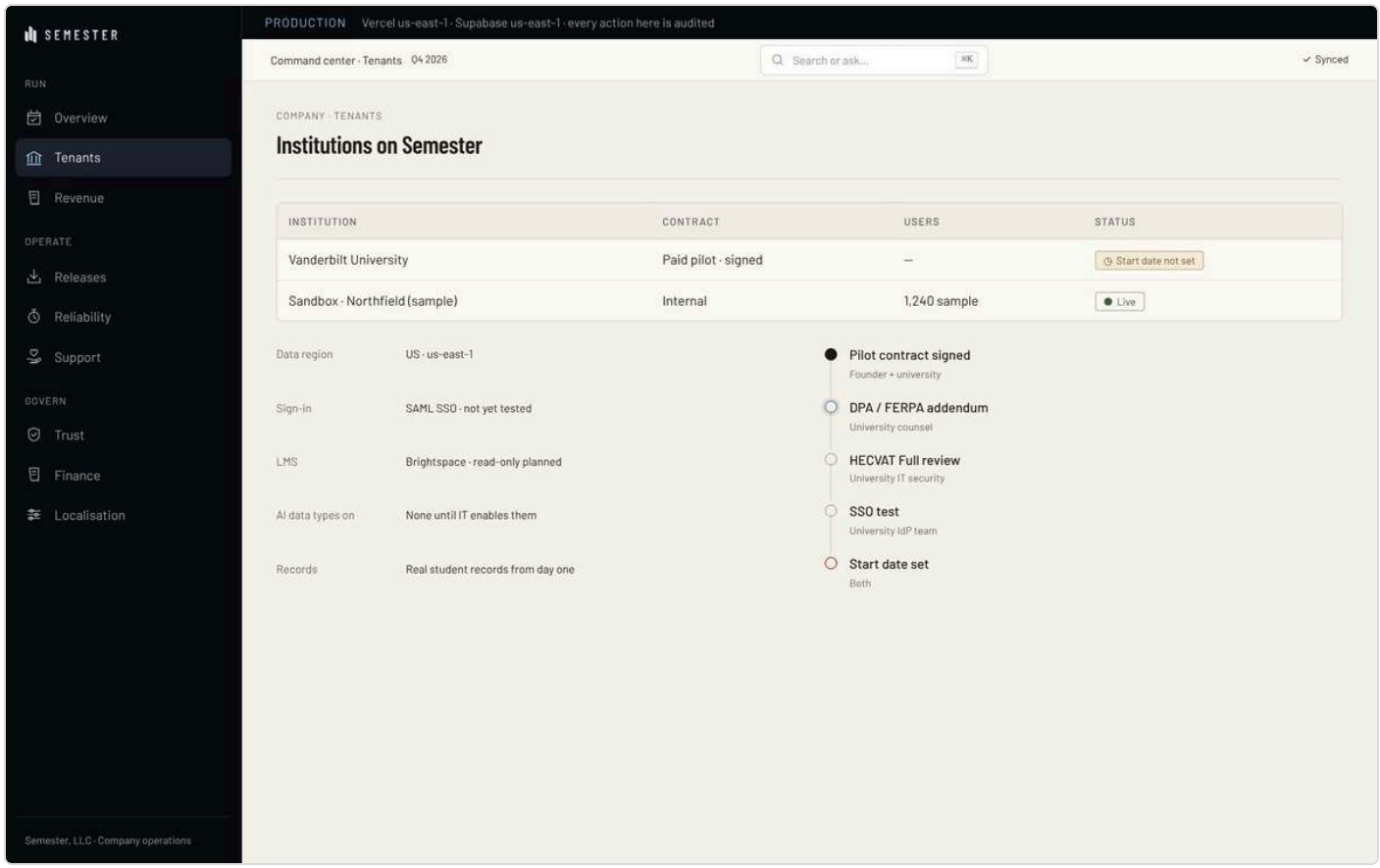
Opening view

Company command center

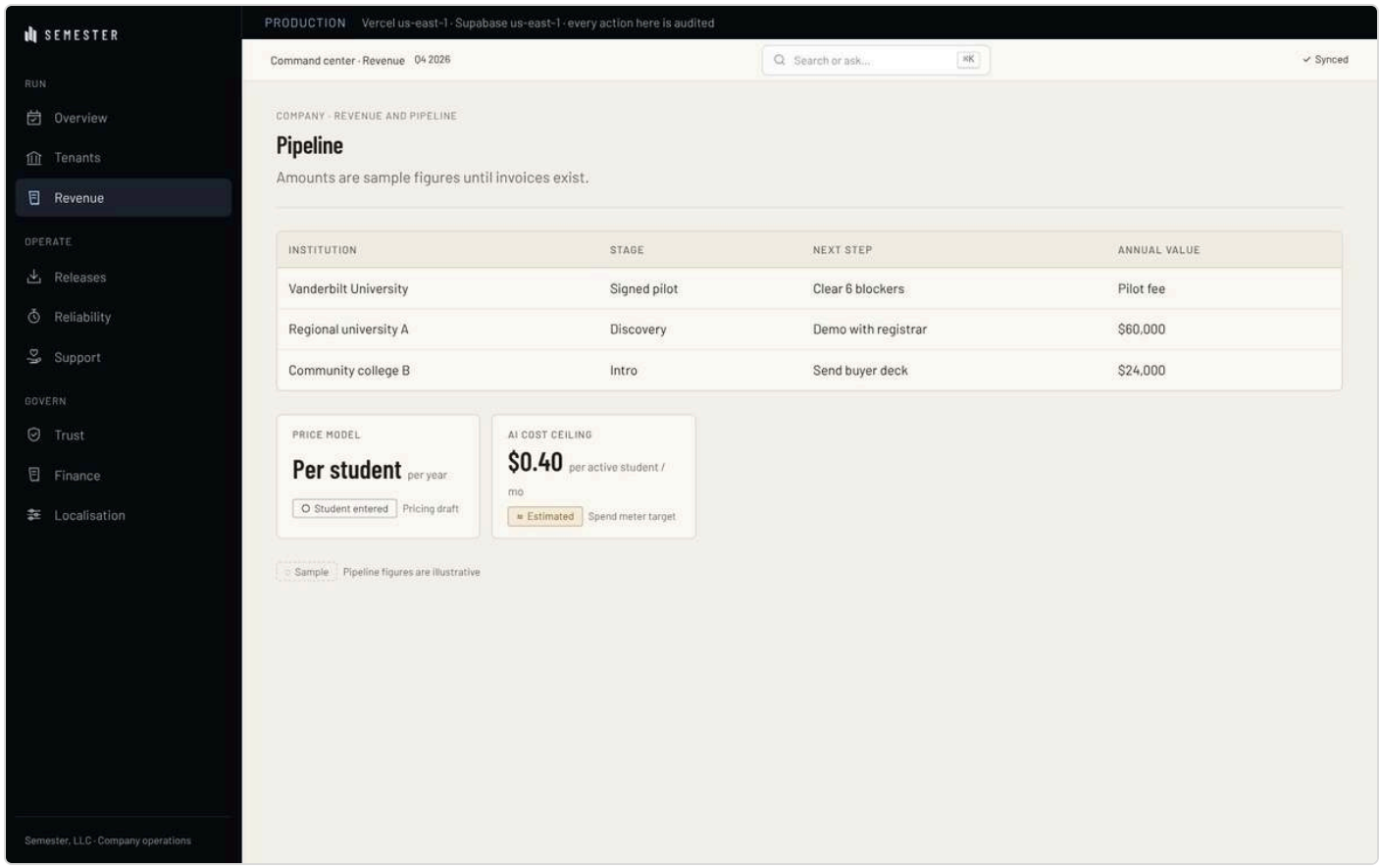
9 screens.



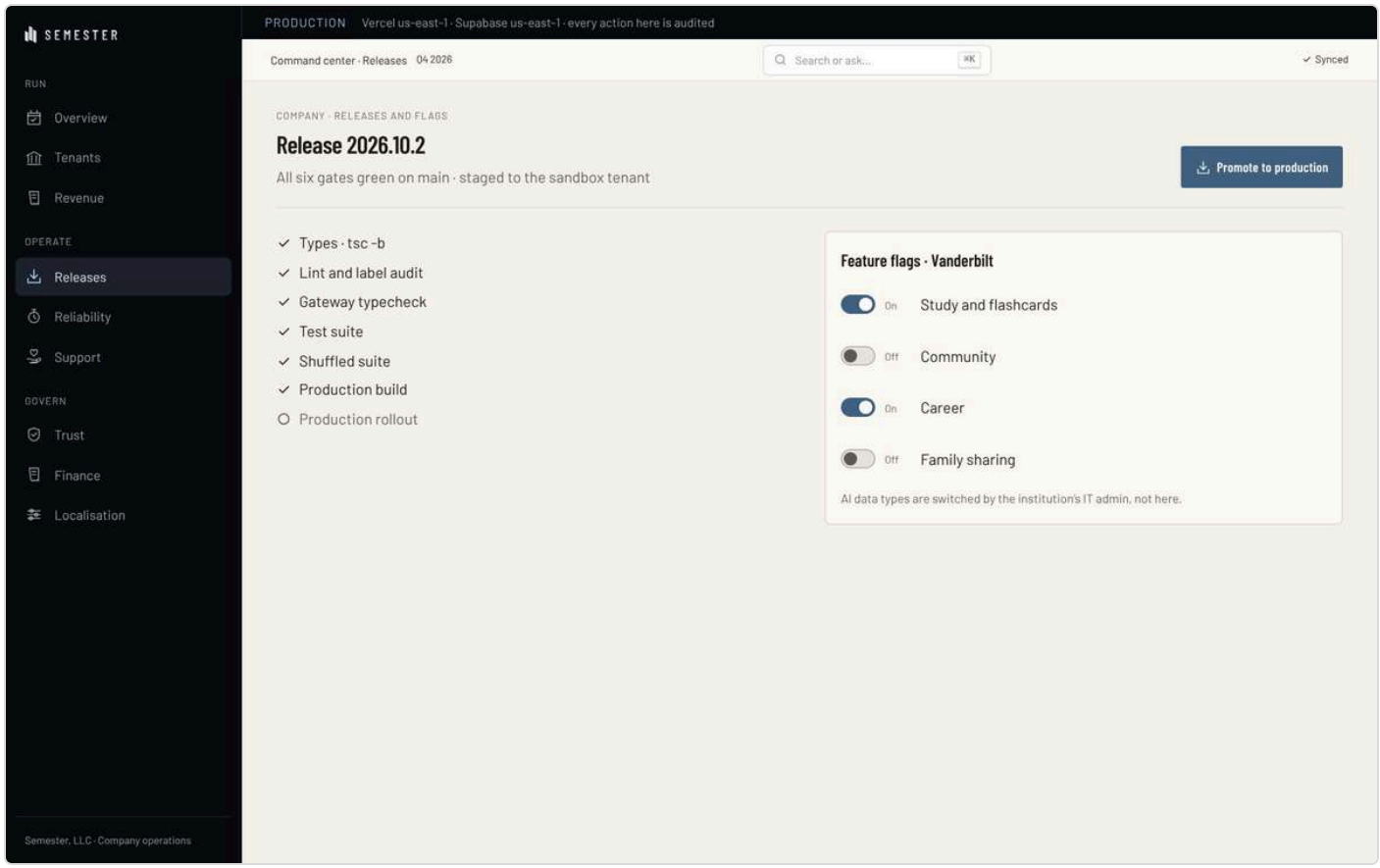
Opening view


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PRODUCTION
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Command center · Tenants
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Start date not set
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Data region
US · us-east-1
Sign-in
SAML SSO · not yet tested
LMS
Brightspace · read-only planned
AI data types on
None until IT enables them
Records
Real student records from day one
Pilot contract signed
Founder + university
DPA / FERPA addendum
University counsel
HECVAT Full review
University IT security
SSO test
University IdP team
Start date set
Both

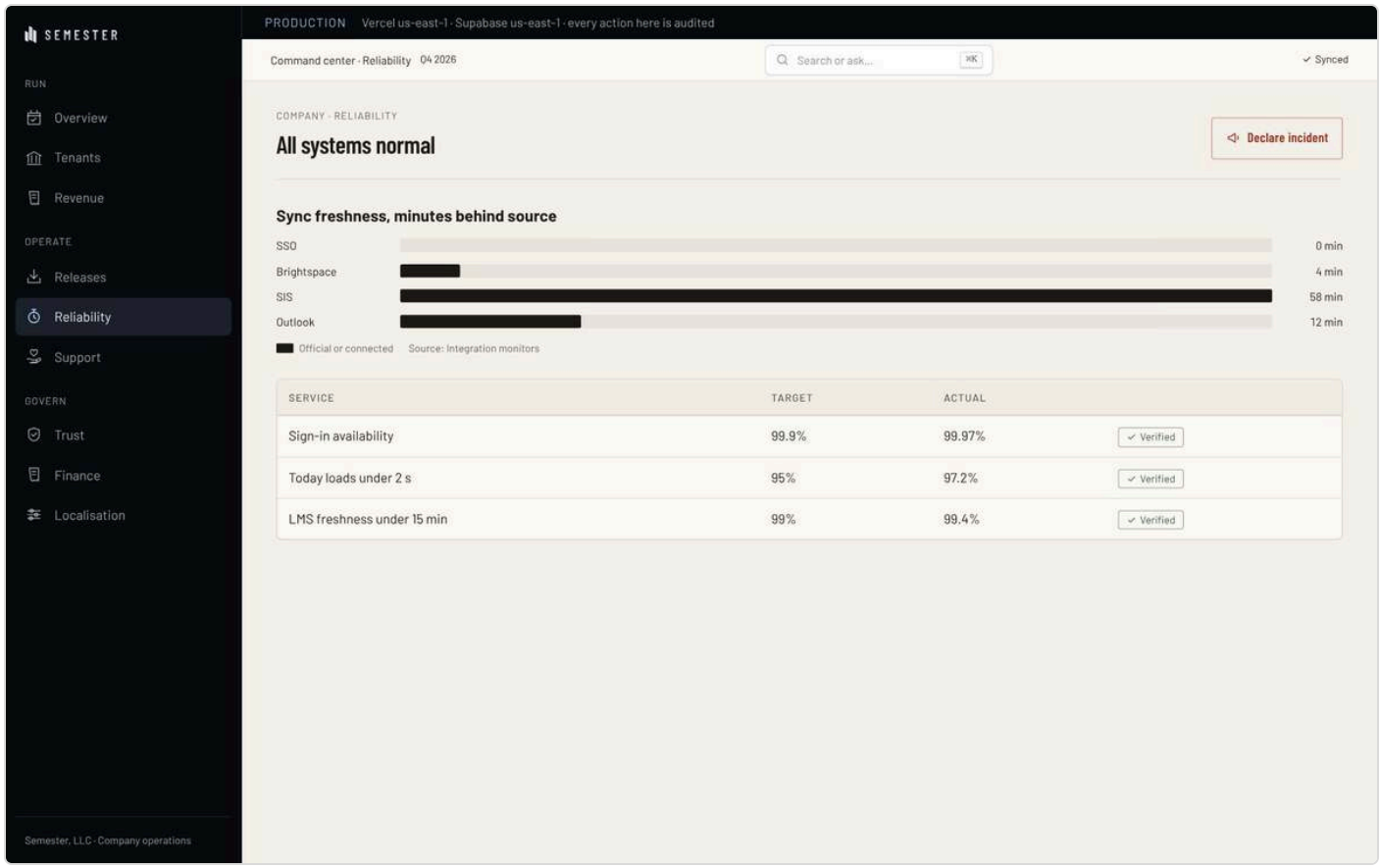
Tenants


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Command center · Revenue 04 2026
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COMPANY · REVENUE AND PIPELINE
Pipeline
Amounts are sample figures until invoices exist.
INSTITUTION
STAGE
NEXT STEP
ANNUAL VALUE
Vanderbilt University
Signed pilot
Clear 6 blockers
Pilot fee
Regional university A
Discovery
Demo with registrar
$60,000
Community college B
Intro
Send buyer deck
$24,000
PRICE MODEL
Per student per year
Student entered
Pricing draft
AI COST CEILING
$0.40 per active student / mo
≈ Estimated
Spend meter target
Sample
Pipeline figures are illustrative

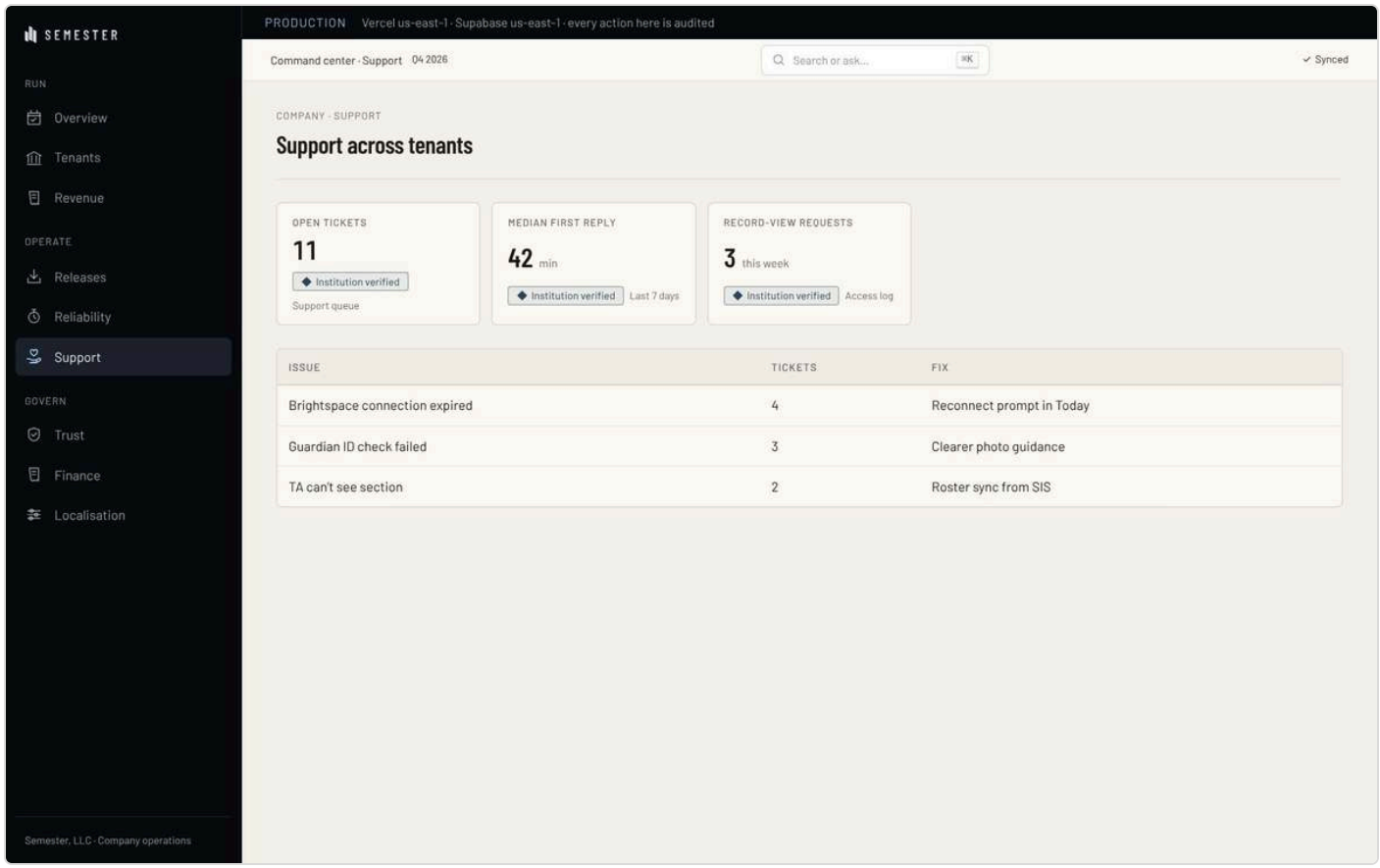
Revenue


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Command center · Releases 04 2026
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Synced
COMPANY · RELEASES AND FLAGS
Release 2026.10.2
All six gates green on main · staged to the sandbox tenant
Promote to production
Types · tsc -b
Lint and label audit
Gateway typecheck
Test suite
Shuffled suite
Production build
Production rollout
Feature flags · Vanderbilt
On Study and flashcards
Off Community
On Career
Off Family sharing
AI data types are switched by the institution's IT admin, not here.

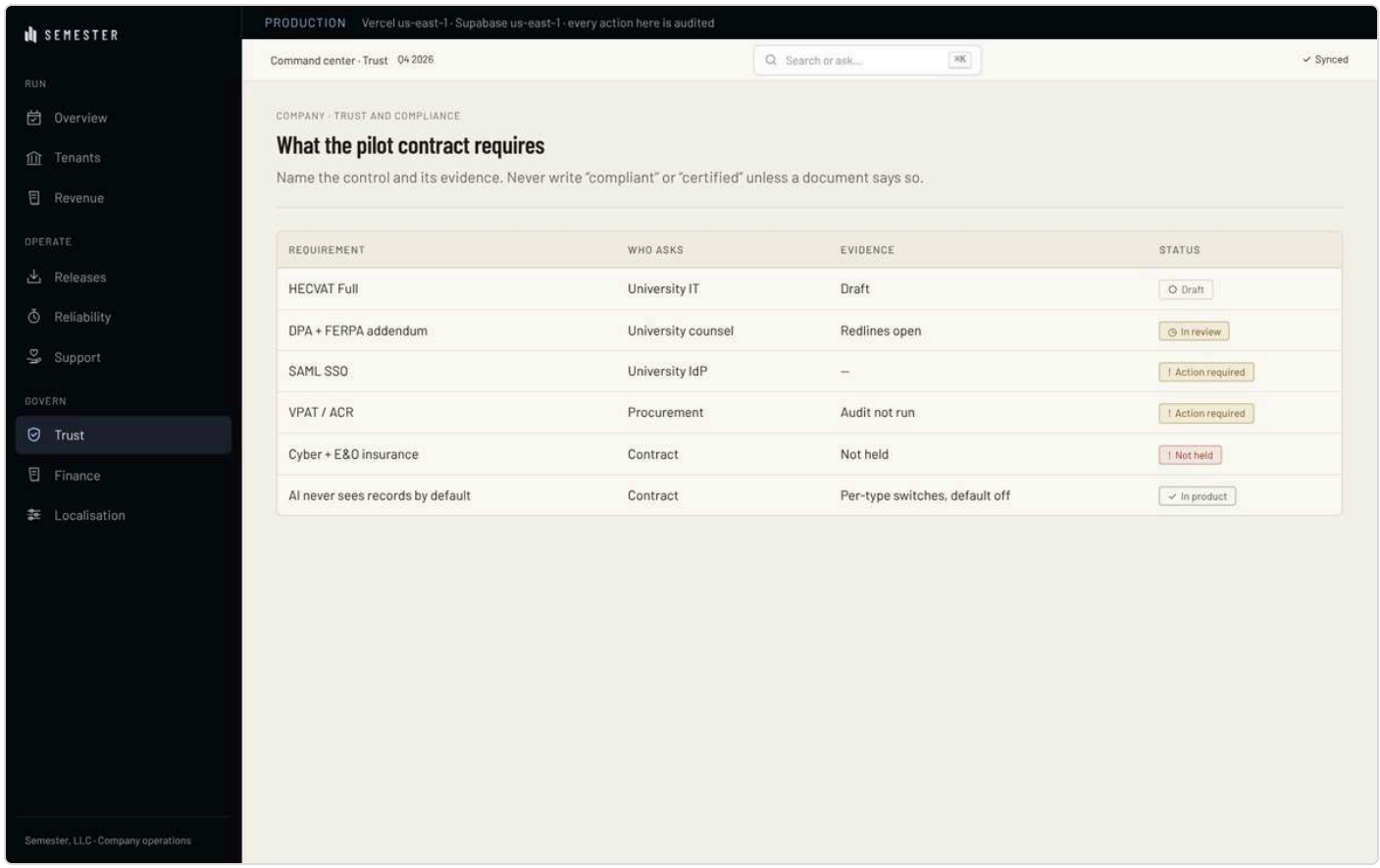
Releases



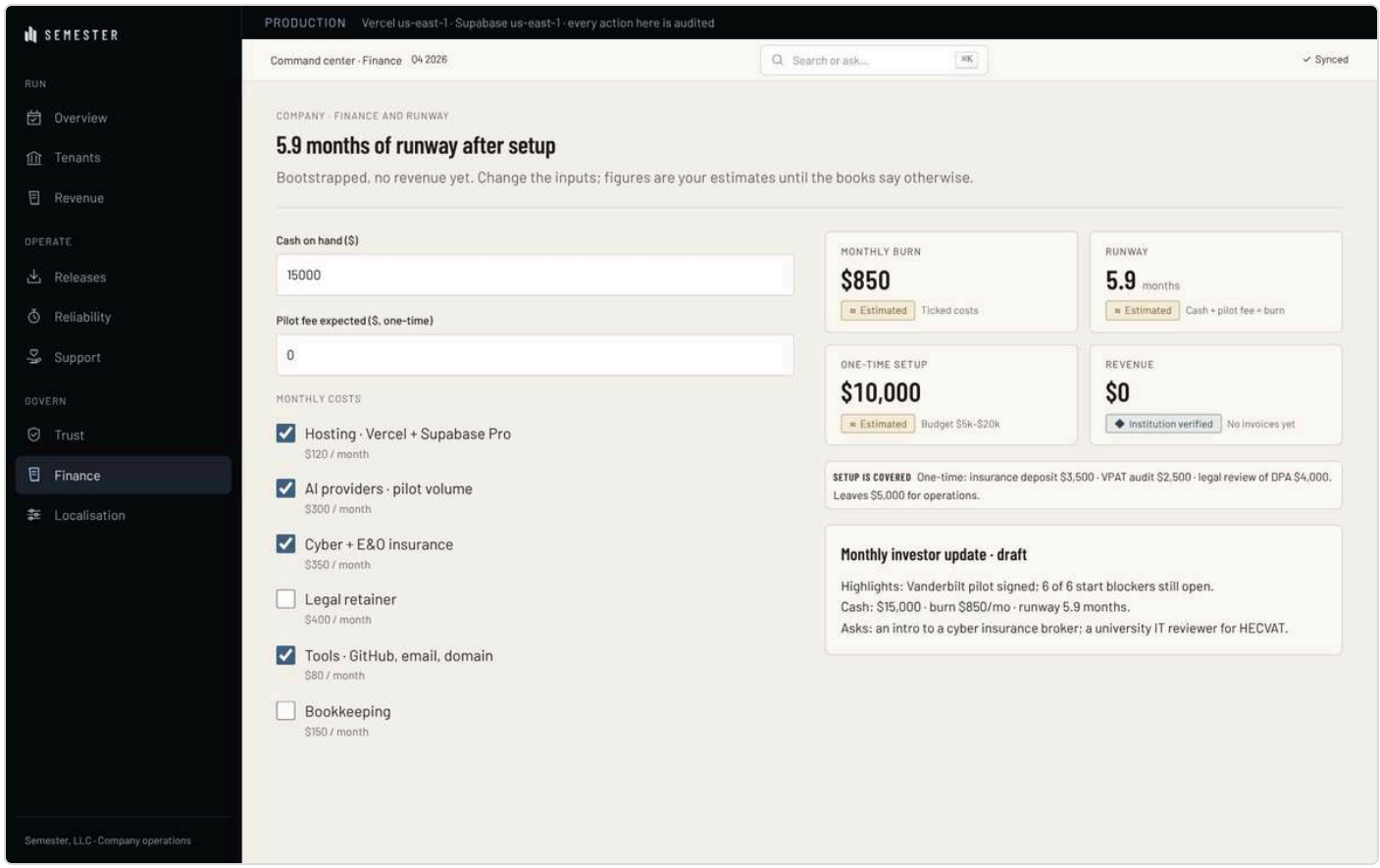
Reliability


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Institution verified
Support queue
MEDIAN FIRST REPLY
42 min
Institution verified Last 7 days
RECORD-VIEW REQUESTS
3 this week
Institution verified Access log
ISSUE
TICKETS
FIX
Brightspace connection expired
4
Reconnect prompt in Today
Guardian ID check failed
3
Clearer photo guidance
TA can't see section
2
Roster sync from SIS

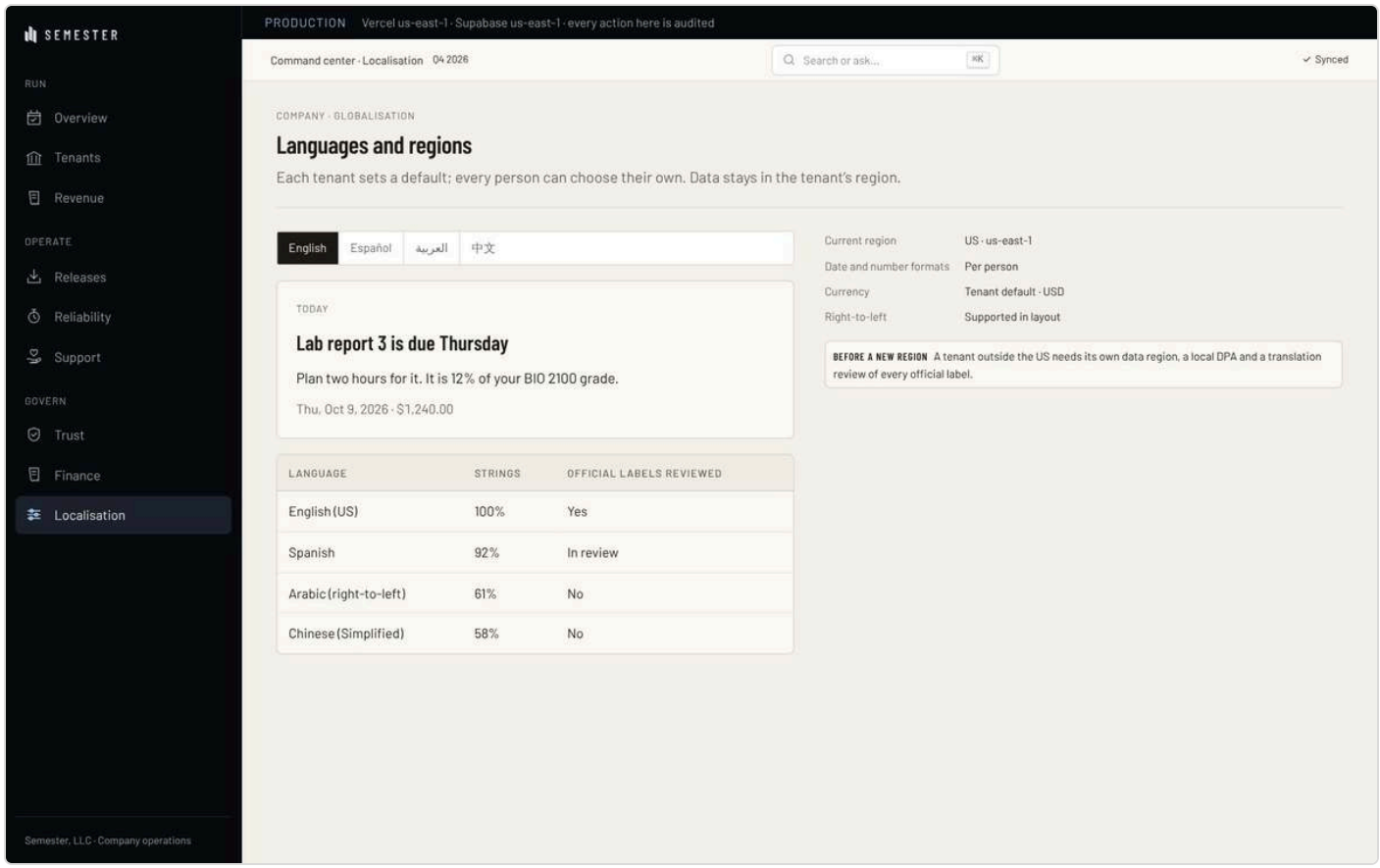
Support


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PRODUCTION Vercel us-east-1 · Supabase us-east-1 · every action here is audited
Command center · Trust 04 2026
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Synced
COMPANY · TRUST AND COMPLIANCE
What the pilot contract requires
Name the control and its evidence. Never write "compliant" or "certified" unless a document says so.
REQUIREMENT
WHO ASKS
EVIDENCE
STATUS
HECVAT Full
University IT
Draft
Draft
DPA + FERPA addendum
University counsel
Redlines open
In review
SAML SSO
University IdP
–
! Action required
VPAT / ACR
Procurement
Audit not run
! Action required
Cyber + E&O insurance
Contract
Not held
! Not held
AI never sees records by default
Contract
Per-type switches, default off
In product

Trust


SEMESTER
RUN
Overview
Tenants
Revenue
OPERATE
Releases
Reliability
Support
GOVERN
Trust
Finance
Localisation
Semester, LLC · Company operations
PRODUCTION Vercel us-east-1 · Supabase us-east-1 · every action here is audited
Command center · Finance 04 2026
Search or ask... ⌘K
✓ Synced
COMPANY · FINANCE AND RUNWAY
5.9 months of runway after setup
Bootstrapped, no revenue yet. Change the inputs; figures are your estimates until the books say otherwise.
Cash on hand ($)
15000
Pilot fee expected ($, one-time)
0
MONTHLY COSTS
Hosting · Vercel + Supabase Pro
$120 / month
AI providers · pilot volume
$300 / month
Cyber + E&O insurance
$350 / month
Legal retainer
$400 / month
Tools · GitHub, email, domain
$80 / month
Bookkeeping
$150 / month
MONTHLY BURN
$850
≈ Estimated Ticked costs
RUNWAY
5.9 months
≈ Estimated Cash + pilot fee ÷ burn
ONE-TIME SETUP
$10,000
≈ Estimated Budget $5k–$20k
REVENUE
$0
Institution verified No invoices yet
SETUP IS COVERED One-time: insurance deposit $3,500 · VPAT audit $2,500 · legal review of DPA $4,000. Leaves $5,000 for operations.
Monthly investor update · draft
Highlights: Vanderbilt pilot signed; 6 of 6 start blockers still open.
Cash: $15,000 · burn $850/mo · runway 5.9 months.
Asks: an intro to a cyber insurance broker; a university IT reviewer for HECVAT.

Finance



Localisation

Operations console data

Every console, role and institution configuration modelled in the operations prototype.

Operations consoles — ui_kits/ops/consoles-data.js

ROLES

CEO, CFO, Finance Analyst, Comms Lead, Social Manager, Head of Sales, RevOps, CS Manager, Support Lead, T&S Lead, General Counsel, People Ops, Security Lead, Data Lead, Partnerships Lead

ALL

CEO, CFO, Finance Analyst, Comms Lead, Social Manager, Head of Sales, RevOps, CS Manager, Support Lead, T&S Lead, General Counsel, People Ops, Security Lead, Data Lead, Partnerships Lead

Inst

Halden State University, Ridgeway Community College, Northmere University, Coastline Tech, St. Aurel College, Valewood University, Pinecrest CC, Marrow Institute, Eastbrook University, Lakeshore College, Oakvale State, Brightwater CC

CONSOLES

Social media control

Id: social

Group: Brand & growth

Name: Social media control

Sub: Every Semester channel in one place: replies, scheduling, approvals and brand safety.

Roles: CEO, Comms Lead, Social Manager

Actions:

- **L:** Compose post
  K: p
  A: compose
- **L:** Crisis mode
  K: r
  A: crisis

Tabs:

- **Id:** inbox
  Name: Unified inbox
  Kpis:
  - Open threads, 47, +12 today, dn
  - Median first reply, 38 min, −9 min, up
  - Sentiment, +0.41, +0.06 wk, up
  - Escalated, 3, 2 to Support, dn

  Filter:
  Field: Channel
  Opts: All, LinkedIn, X, Instagram, TikTok, YouTube, Threads
  Search: True
  Cols: Channel, From, Message, Sentiment, Status, Age
  Rows:
  - LinkedIn, Dean of Students, Halden State, Can Semester integrate with our Banner SIS before spring term?, ~ok:Positive, ~info:Routed · Sales, 12m
  - X, @campus_it_ops, Login loop on the mobile app since this morning?, ~bad:Negative, ~warn:Escalated · Support, 24m
  - Instagram, @ridgewaycc, Love the new study planner! Can we repost?, ~ok:Positive, ~info:Needs reply, 41m
  - TikTok, @studytok_sam, Is the AI tutor allowed to write my essay?, ~warn:Neutral, ~info:Needs reply · policy macro, 1h
  - YouTube, EdTech Weekly, Interview request for your accessibility work, ~ok:Positive, ~info:Routed · Comms, 2h
  - X, @privacy_watch_ed, What data does Semester share with AI vendors?, ~warn:Neutral, ~warn:Needs Legal-approved reply, 2h
  - Threads, @northmere_u, Co-post for orientation week confirmed for Tue, ~ok:Positive, ~ok:Resolved, 3h
  - LinkedIn, Registrar, Coastline Tech, Who do we contact about FERPA DPA renewal?, ~warn:Neutral, ~info:Routed · Legal, 4h

  Row Actions: Reply, Assign, Route to Support, Mark resolved
- **Id:** cal
  Name: Calendar
  Type: calendar
- **Id:** appr
  Name: Approval queue
  Kpis:
  - Waiting, 9, 3 due today, dn
  - Avg approval time, 2.1 h, −0.4 h, up
  - Rejected this week, 2, ,
  - Legal review, 3, ,

  Cols: Post, Channels, Author, Scheduled, Checks, Status
  Rows:

- Spring term planner launch, LinkedIn · X · IG, Maya R., Tue 09:00, ~ok:Brand ✓ Access ✓, ~warn:Needs Comms Lead
- Halden State case study, LinkedIn, Jon P., Wed 11:00, ~warn:Partner logo approval, ~warn:Waiting on partner
- AI tutor: what it will and won't do, X · Threads · TikTok, Maya R., Thu 15:00, ~ai:Policy claim, ~warn:Needs Legal
- Accessibility month reel, IG · TikTok · YT, Dee K., Fri 12:00, ~ok:Captions ✓ Alt text ✓, ~info:Ready
- Finals week reminder, All, Auto, Mon 08:00, ~bad:Tone check failed, ~bad:Returned

Row Actions: Approve, Request changes, Reject, Preview

- **Id:** safety

  Name: Brand safety

  Type: panels

  Panels:

  - Keyword watchlist, data breach FERPA lawsuit outage cheating AI wrote refund
  - Crisis playbook, <ol style="margin:0;padding-left:18px;line-height:1.7">
Pause every scheduled post (one click)
Page Comms Lead, General Counsel and Security Lead
Post the holding statement from the approved library
Route all mentions to Comms Lead for triage
Hourly update until status page is green
  - Approved statements, Outagev4 · Legal ✓Data incidentv2 · Legal ✓ · Security ✓AI misusev3 · Legal ✓Price changeDraft
  - Who can post, Comms LeadPublish · approve · crisis modeSocial ManagerDraft · schedule · replyPartnersCo-post requests onlyEveryone elseRead only

- **Id:** ana

  Name: Analytics

  Type: charts

  Kpis:

  - Followers, 184.2k, +3.1% mo, up
  - Engagement rate, 4.8%, +0.6 pt, up
  - Site clicks, 12.9k, +18%, up
  - Demo requests from social, 64, +11, up

  Bars:

  - LinkedIn, 92
  - Instagram, 71
  - TikTok, 64
  - X, 38
  - YouTube, 29
  - Threads, 17

  Spark: 22, 30, 28, 35, 40, 38, 46, 52, 49, 58, 61, 70

- **Id:** co

  Name: Partner co-posts

  Cols: Institution, Campaign, Their approver, Assets, Status

  Rows:

  - Northmere University, Orientation week, Marketing Director, 4/4, ~ok:Live
  - Halden State University, Case study, VP Communications, 2/3, ~warn:Logo pending
  - Ridgeway Community College, Planner launch, Social Coordinator, 3/3, ~info:Scheduled
  - Valewood University, Accessibility month, Disability Services, 0/2, ~warn:Brief sent

  Row Actions: Open brief, Send reminder

Finance console

Id: finance

Group: Finance

Name: Finance console

Sub: Revenue, billing, collections, costs and month-end close.

Roles: CEO, CFO, Finance Analyst

Actions:

- **L:** Export for audit
  K:
  A: toast:Audit pack queued · ready in about 2 min
- **L:** New invoice
  K: p
  A: toast:Invoice draft created

Tabs:

- **Id:** ov
  Name: Overview
  Type: charts
  Kpis:
  - ARR, $14.2M, +38% YoY, up
  - MRR, $1.18M, +2.9% MoM, up
  - Net revenue retention, 124%, +3 pt, up
  - Gross margin, 78.4%, −0.8 pt (AI cost), dn
  - Cash runway, 31 mo, ,
  - DSO, 46 days, +4, dn

  Bars:
  - Platform, 62
  - Seats, 21
  - AI usage, 11
  - Services, 6

  Bar Unit: %
  Spark: 49.199999999999996, 51.6, 53.4, 54.6, 57, 58.8, 60.6, 62.400000000000006, 64.2, 66, 69, 70.8
- **Id:** inv
  Name: Invoices & AR
  Kpis:
  - Outstanding, $2.41M, ,
  - Over 60 days, $318k, 4 accounts, dn
  - Collected (mo), $1.06M, ,
  - Disputed, $42k, 1 account, dn

  Filter:
  Field: Aging
  Opts: All, Current, 1–30, 31–60, 61–90, 90+
  Search: True
  Cols: Invoice, Institution, Amount, Due, Aging, Status
  Rows:
  - INV-26410, Halden State University, $184,100, Oct 3, Current, ~ok:Paid
  - INV-26411, Ridgeway Community College, $92,137, Oct 5, 1–30, ~info:Sent
  - INV-26412, Northmere University, $240,174, Oct 7, 31–60, ~warn:Reminder 2
  - INV-26413, Coastline Tech, $61,211, Oct 9, Current, ~info:Sent
  - INV-26414, St. Aurel College, $38,248, Oct 11, 61–90, ~bad:Escalated
  - INV-26415, Valewood University, $155,285, Oct 13, Current, ~ok:Paid
  - INV-26416, Pinecrest CC, $44,322, Oct 15, 90+, ~bad:Disputed

- INV-26417, Marrow Institute, $72,359, Oct 17, 1–30, ~info:Sent
- INV-26418, Eastbrook University, $128,396, Oct 19, Current, ~info:Sent
- INV-26419, Lakeshore College, $51,433, Oct 21, 31–60, ~warn:Reminder 1
- INV-26420, Oakvale State, $96,470, Oct 23, Current, ~ok:Paid
- INV-26421, Brightwater CC, $33,507, Oct 25, 1–30, ~info:Sent

Row Actions: Send reminder, Record payment, Open contract, Escalate to CS

- **Id:** ren

  Name: Contracts & renewals

  Cols: Institution, ACV, Term ends, Health, Expansion, Status

  Rows:

  - Halden State University, $420k, Dec 2026, ~ok:Healthy, +AI tier, ~info:Proposal sent
  - Ridgeway Community College, $180k, Jan 2027, ~warn:Watch, —, ~warn:Procurement
  - Northmere University, $610k, Mar 2027, ~ok:Healthy, +2 campuses, ~info:Early talks
  - Coastline Tech, $95k, Nov 2026, ~bad:At risk, —, ~bad:Exec save plan
  - St. Aurel College, $70k, Feb 2027, ~ok:Healthy, +Seats, ~info:Not started
  - Valewood University, $330k, Jun 2027, ~ok:Healthy, +AI tier, ~ok:Signed
  - Pinecrest CC, $88k, Oct 2026, ~warn:Watch, —, ~warn:Board vote
  - Marrow Institute, $140k, Aug 2027, ~ok:Healthy, —, ~info:Not started

  Row Actions: Open contract, Draft renewal, Flag to CS

- **Id:** use

  Name: Usage billing

  Cols: Institution, Active seats, Seat cap, AI tutor minutes, AI overage, Bill preview

  Rows:

  - Halden State University, 18,240, 20,000, 412k, ~ok:Within plan, $38.0k
  - Ridgeway Community College, 6,120, 6,000, 88k, ~warn:Over cap, $14.7k
  - Northmere University, 24,800, 25,000, 530k, ~ok:Within plan, $51.4k
  - Coastline Tech, 3,900, 5,000, 61k, ~ok:Within plan, $8.1k
  - St. Aurel College, 2,100, 2,500, 22k, ~ok:Within plan, $4.8k
  - Valewood University, 11,400, 12,000, 240k, ~ok:Within plan, $26.5k
  - Pinecrest CC, 2,800, 3,000, 40k, ~ok:Within plan, $6.2k
  - Marrow Institute, 5,300, 5,000, 96k, ~warn:Over cap, $13.9k

  Row Actions: Preview invoice, Notify institution

- **Id:** ai

  Name: AI cost

  Type: charts

  Kpis:

  - AI spend (mo), $96.4k, +14%, dn
  - Cost per active student, $0.61, −$0.05, up
  - Cache hit rate, 42%, +6 pt, up
  - Budget used, 71%, Ahead of pace, dn

  Bars:

  - Tutor, 54
  - Study plans, 18
  - Summaries, 14
  - Moderation, 9
  - Search, 5

  Bar Unit: %

  Spark: 40, 44, 47, 52, 55, 58, 63, 66, 70, 74, 79, 84

- **Id:** close

  Name: Month-end close

  Type: checklist

Items:

- Revenue recognition run, Finance Analyst, 1
- AR aging reviewed, Finance Analyst, 1
- AI vendor invoices matched, Finance Analyst, 1
- Payroll accrual booked, People Ops, 0
- Deferred revenue roll-forward, CFO, 0
- Bank reconciliations (3 accounts), Finance Analyst, 0
- Flux review >10%, CFO, 0
- Board pack draft, CFO, 0

- **Id:** pay
  Name: Payroll summary
  Role Only: CEO, CFO
  Kpis:
  - Headcount, 142, +6 qtr, up
  - Monthly payroll, $2.05M, ,
  - Contractors, 11, ,
  - Next run, Oct 15, ,

  Cols: Department, Headcount, Monthly cost, vs budget
  Rows:
  - Engineering, 61, $1.01M, ~ok:−2%
  - Go-to-market, 38, $0.52M, ~warn:+4%
  - Customer success, 19, $0.21M, ~ok:0%
  - G&A, 14, $0.19M, ~ok:−1%
  - Product & design, 10, $0.12M, ~ok:0%

Marketing & campaigns

Id: mkt

Group: Brand & growth

Name: Marketing & campaigns

Sub: Campaigns, budget and pipeline they produce.

Roles: CEO, Comms Lead, Head of Sales

Actions:

- **L:** Export
  K:
  A: toast:Export queued

Tabs:

- **Id:** main
  Name: Queue
  Kpis:
  - Active campaigns, 7, ,
  - Spend (qtr), $412k, 68% of budget,
  - MQLs, 1,284, +22%, up
  - Pipeline sourced, $3.9M, +$0.6M, up

  Cols: Campaign, Channel, Spend, MQLs, CAC, Status
  Rows:
  - Spring term readiness, Paid search, $84k, 312, $269, ~ok:Live
  - Registrar roundtable, Events, $61k, 88, $693, ~info:Planning
  - Accessibility month, Social · PR, $22k, 140, $157, ~ok:Live
  - CIO webinar series, Webinar, $18k, 206, $87, ~ok:Live
  - Community college tour, Field, $96k, 74, $1,297, ~warn:Over budget

  Row Actions: Pause, Edit budget, View attribution
  Search: True

Sales & RevOps

Id: sales

Group: Revenue

Name: Sales & RevOps

Sub: Pipeline, forecast and deal desk.

Roles: CEO, CFO, Head of Sales, RevOps

Actions:

- **L:** Export
  K:
  A: toast:Export queued

Tabs:

- **Id:** main
  Name: Queue
  Kpis:
  - Pipeline, $18.6M, ,
  - Commit (qtr), $2.4M, 92% of target, up
  - Win rate, 31%, +3 pt, up
  - Avg cycle, 118 days, −9, up

  Cols: Deal, Institution, Stage, Amount, Close, Owner
  Rows:
  - Systemwide AI tier, Oakvale State, Negotiation, $640k, Nov 14, R. Osei
  - Pilot → full, Lakeshore College, Proposal, $210k, Dec 2, L. Brandt
  - 3 campuses, Eastbrook University, Procurement, $880k, Jan 20, R. Osei
  - New logo, Brightwater CC, Discovery, $95k, Feb 28, M. Chen
  - Expansion seats, Valewood University, Verbal, ~ok:$140k, Oct 30, L. Brandt

  Row Actions: Open deal, Deal desk review, Update forecast
  Search: True

Customer success

Id: cs

Group: Customers

Name: Customer success

Sub: Health, adoption and renewal risk for every institution.

Roles: CEO, CS Manager, Head of Sales

Actions:

- **L:** Export
  K:
  A: toast:Export queued

Tabs:

- **Id:** main
  Name: Queue
  Kpis:
  - Accounts, 86, ,
  - Healthy, 71, 83%, up
  - At risk, 6, $1.1M ARR, dn
  - Avg weekly active, 64%, +5 pt, up

  Cols: Institution, CSM, Health, Weekly active, Open tickets, Next step
  Rows:
  - Halden State University, A. Ruiz, ~ok:92, 71%, 2, QBR Oct 22
  - Ridgeway Community College, B. Lowe, ~warn:64, 52%, 5, Adoption plan
  - Northmere University, A. Ruiz, ~ok:88, 68%, 1, Expansion call
  - Coastline Tech, K. Imani, ~bad:41, 29%, 9, Exec save plan
  - St. Aurel College, B. Lowe, ~ok:79, 66%, 0, —
  - Valewood University, K. Imani, ~ok:85, 70%, 3, Training
  - Pinecrest CC, A. Ruiz, ~warn:58, 47%, 6, Champion left
  - Marrow Institute, B. Lowe, ~ok:81, 63%, 2, QBR Nov 4
  - Eastbrook University, K. Imani, ~ok:90, 74%, 1, Case study

  Row Actions: Open account, Log touchpoint, Start save plan
  Search: True

Support desk

Id: support

Group: Customers

Name: Support desk

Sub: Tickets from institution staff, by queue and SLA. Student issues arrive through the institution.

Roles: Support Lead, CS Manager, CEO

Actions:

- **L:** Export
  K:
  A: toast:Export queued

Tabs:

- **Id:** main
  Name: Queue
  Kpis:
  - Open, 132, ,
  - SLA breaches, 4, , dn
  - First response, 22 min, −6, up
  - CSAT, 4.7, +0.1, up

  Cols: Ticket, Institution, Topic, Priority, SLA, Status
  Rows:
  - #58213, Halden State University, SIS grade sync delay, ~bad:P1, ~bad:Breached 12m, ~warn:Engineering
  - #58207, Coastline Tech, SSO certificate rotation, ~warn:P2, 2h left, ~info:In progress
  - #58199, Pinecrest CC, Bulk course import CSV, ~info:P3, 1d, ~info:Waiting on customer
  - #58190, Northmere University, Caption export format, P4, 3d, ~ok:Solved

  Row Actions: Assign, Escalate, Macro reply, Solve
  Search: True

Trust & safety · community

Id: tns

Group: Trust

Name: Trust & safety · community

Sub: Reports, community health and marketplace operations. People are shown as pseudonyms.

Roles: T&S Lead, General Counsel, CS Manager

Actions:

- **L:** Export
  K:
  A: toast:Export queued

Tabs:

- **Id:** main
  Name: Queue
  Kpis:
  - Reports open, 58, ,
  - Median action, 3.4 h, −0.8, up
  - Appeals, 6, ,
  - AI pre-screen precision, 93%, +1 pt, up

  Cols: Case, Type, Surface, AI flag, Reviewer, Status
  Rows:
  - TS-9921, Harassment, Course discussion, ~ai:0.91, J. Moss, ~warn:In review
  - TS-9918, Academic integrity, Shared notes, ~ai:0.74, —, ~info:Queued
  - TS-9913, Spam, Group chat, ~ai:0.98, Auto, ~ok:Removed
  - TS-9902, Self-harm signal, Tutor chat, ~bad:Urgent, L. Park, ~bad:Escalated to institution

  Row Actions: Take action, Escalate, Dismiss, Open appeal
  Search: True
- **Id:** health
  Name: Community health
  Type: charts
  Kpis:
  - Weekly active posters, 2,140, +9%, up
  - Report rate, 0.6%, −0.1 pt, up
  - Groups, 318, +12,
  - Median time to remove, 41 min, −12, up

  Bars:
  - Course groups, 46
  - Clubs, 28
  - Campus feed, 14
  - Q&A, 8
  - Events, 4

  Bar Unit: %
  Spark: 30, 34, 33, 38, 41, 45, 44, 49, 53, 55, 58, 62
- **Id:** mkt
  Name: Marketplace ops
  Kpis:
  - Live listings, 1,206, ,
  - On hold, 14, integrity / safety, dn
  - Disputes open, 5, ,
  - GMV (mo, sample), $48.2k, +16%, up

  Filter:
  Field: Status

Opts: All, On hold, Disputed, Live

Search: True

Cols: Listing, Category, Seller, Flag, Price, Status

Rows:

- Intro Psych notes, Textbooks, User-4821, ~ai:Integrity 0.62, $10, On hold
- Spring sublet 1BR, Housing, User-1177, ~warn:Off-platform payment ask, $780/mo, On hold
- TI-84 calculator, Gear, User-3390, ~warn:Buyer: not as described, $60, Disputed
- Exam 2 answer key, Textbooks, User-0952, ~bad:Prohibited, $15, Removed
- Homecoming tickets ×2, Tickets, User-2204, ~ok:Face value ✓, $30, Live
- Live drop: lab coats, Gear, Campus Bookstore, ~ok:Official seller, $42, Live

Row Actions: Approve, Keep on hold, Remove, Refund buyer, Message seller

- **Id:** drops

  Name: Live drops

  Cols: Drop, Seller, Starts, Watchers, Reserve, Status

  Rows:

  - Lab coat surplus, Campus Bookstore, Live now, 9, $30, ~bad:LIVE
  - Club merch, Robotics Society, Oct 8 18:00, 44, —, ~info:Scheduled
  - Furniture swap, Housing Office, Oct 20 10:00, 120, —, ~warn:Needs approval

  Row Actions: Approve, Pause, End early

- **Id:** cfg

  Name: Institution settings

  Type: panels

  Panels:

  - Features on (Vanderbilt pilot), Campus feedOnGroups & eventsOnQ&AOnMarketplaceOn · campus verifiedLive dropsOfficial sellers onlyDMsMessage requests required
  - Policy, <ul style="margin:0;padding-left:18px;line-height:1.7">
No sale of graded work, exams or answer keys
No off-platform payments
Housing listings need an address check
Users under 18 can’t use the marketplace
Payments run through a licensed processor

Legal & compliance

Id: legal

Group: Trust

Name: Legal & compliance

Sub: Contracts, DPAs, FERPA and subprocessors.

Roles: General Counsel, CEO, Security Lead

Actions:

- **L:** Export
  K:
  A: toast:Export queued

Tabs:

- **Id:** main
  Name: Queue
  Kpis:
  - Active DPAs, 86, ,
  - Renewals in 90d, 11, ,
  - Subprocessors, 14, 1 pending, dn
  - Open data requests, 3, ,

  Cols: Item, Counterparty, Type, Owner, Due, Status
  Rows:
  - DPA renewal, Coastline Tech, FERPA DPA, GC, Nov 1, ~warn:Redlines
  - New subprocessor notice, AI vendor B, Subprocessor, GC, Oct 18, ~info:30-day notice out
  - State privacy addendum, Oakvale State, Addendum, GC, Oct 25, ~info:Drafting
  - Records request, Halden State, Institution request, Privacy, Oct 9, ~ok:Fulfilled

  Row Actions: Open, Assign, Mark complete
  Search: True

People ops

Id: people

Group: Company

Name: People ops

Sub: Hiring, onboarding and team health.

Roles: People Ops, CEO, CFO

Actions:

- **L:** Export
  K:
  A: toast:Export queued

Tabs:

- **Id:** main
  Name: Queue
  Kpis:
  - Open roles, 14, ,
  - Offers out, 3, ,
  - Time to hire, 34 days, −4, up
  - eNPS, +41, +6, up

  Cols: Role, Team, Stage, Candidates, Hiring manager, Status
  Rows:
  - Staff engineer, SIS, Engineering, Onsite, 4, P. Adeyemi, ~ok:On track
  - CSM, community colleges, Customer success, Screen, 11, A. Ruiz, ~ok:On track
  - Accessibility lead, Design, Offer, 1, D. Kaur, ~info:Offer out
  - Security engineer, Security, Sourcing, 2, S. Varga, ~warn:Slow

  Row Actions: Open pipeline, Schedule, Close role
  Search: True

IT & security

Id: sec

Group: Trust

Name: IT & security

Sub: Access, vulnerabilities and SOC 2 evidence.

Roles: Security Lead, CEO

Actions:

- **L:** Export
  K:
  A: toast:Export queued

Tabs:

- **Id:** main
  Name: Queue
  Kpis:
  - SOC 2 controls, 112/118, 95%, up
  - Critical vulns, 0, ,
  - Access reviews due, 2, ,
  - Devices compliant, 98%, ,

  Cols: Control, Area, Evidence, Owner, Due, Status
  Rows:
  - CC6.1 Access reviews, Access, Q3 export, S. Varga, Oct 15, ~warn:Due
  - CC7.2 Monitoring, Ops, Alert runbooks, Platform, —, ~ok:Passing
  - CC8.1 Change mgmt, Eng, PR approvals sample, P. Adeyemi, —, ~ok:Passing
  - A1.2 Backups, Ops, Restore test, Platform, Oct 30, ~info:Scheduled

  Row Actions: Upload evidence, Assign, View history
  Search: True

Data & analytics

Id: data

Group: Company

Name: Data & analytics

Sub: Company metrics, data requests and warehouse health. Aggregates only.

Roles: Data Lead, CEO, CFO

Actions:

- **L:** Export
  K:
  A: toast:Export queued

Tabs:

- **Id:** main
  Name: Queue
  Kpis:
  - Dashboards, 48, ,
  - Pipelines healthy, 31/32, , dn
  - Requests open, 9, ,
  - Freshness, 12 min, ,

  Cols: Request, Requester, Dataset, Privacy check, ETA, Status
  Rows:
  - Renewal risk model refresh, CS Manager, Account health, ~ok:Aggregate, Oct 10, ~info:In progress
  - AI cost by feature, CFO, Gateway logs, ~ok:No PII, Oct 8, ~ok:Delivered
  - Campaign attribution, Comms Lead, Web + CRM, ~ok:Aggregate, Oct 14, ~info:Queued
  - Per-student export, Unknown, Student records, ~bad:Blocked: needs institution, —, ~bad:Rejected

  Row Actions: Open, Assign, Run privacy check
  Search: True

Partnerships

Id: partners

Group: Revenue

Name: Partnerships

Sub: SIS, LMS and reseller partners.

Roles: Partnerships Lead, Head of Sales, CEO

Actions:

- **L:** Export
  K:
  A: toast:Export queued

Tabs:

- **Id:** main
  Name: Queue
  Kpis:
  - Active partners, 23, ,
  - Partner-sourced pipeline, $4.2M, +31%, up
  - Integrations certified, 17, ,
  - Co-sell deals, 12, ,

  Cols: Partner, Type, Tier, Integration, Pipeline, Status
  Rows:
  - SIS vendor A, SIS, Strategic, ~ok:Certified, $1.6M, ~ok:Active
  - LMS vendor B, LMS, Strategic, ~ok:Certified, $1.1M, ~ok:Active
  - Regional reseller C, Reseller, Select, —, $0.7M, ~info:Onboarding
  - Accessibility vendor D, Tech, Select, ~warn:In review, $0.2M, ~info:Pilot

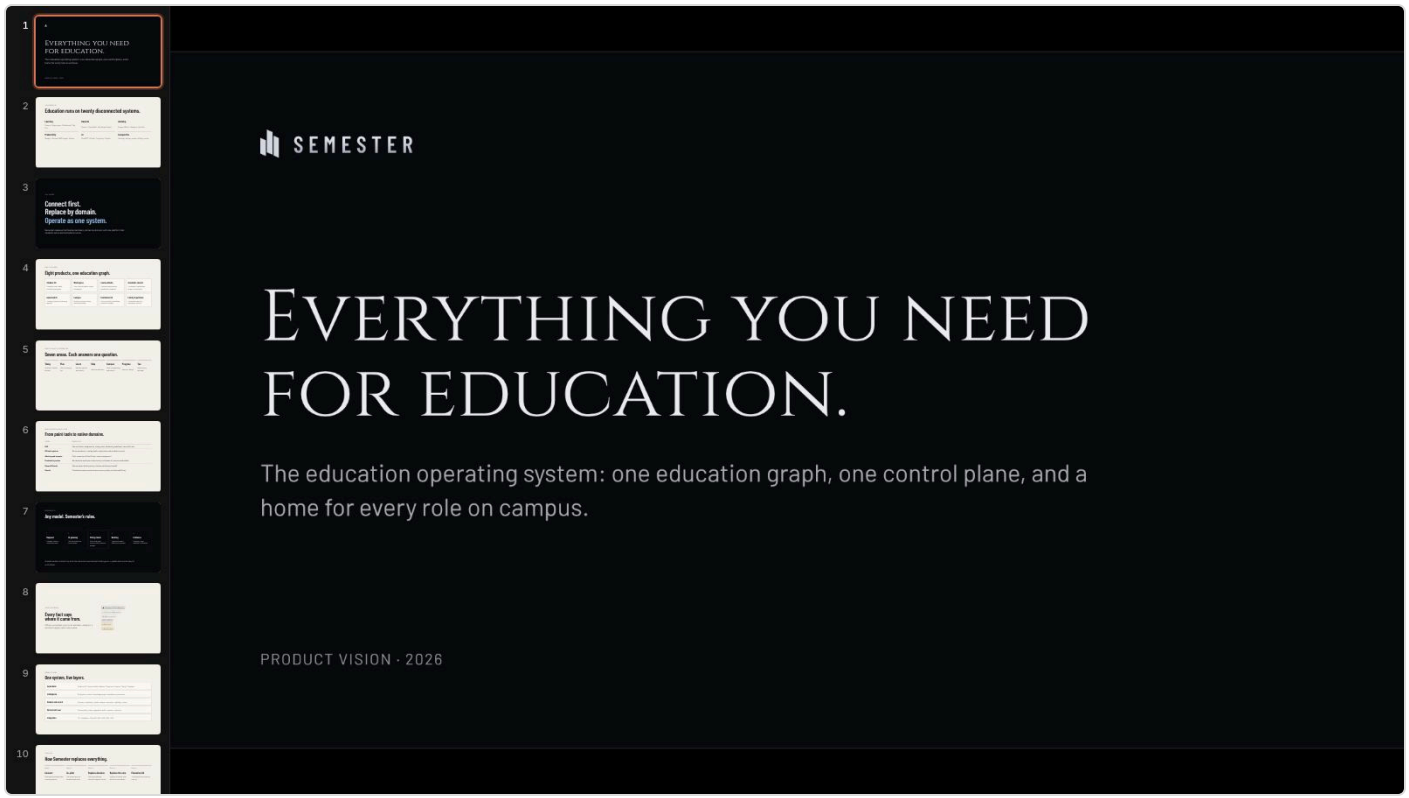
  Row Actions: Open partner, Register deal, Review certification
  Search: True

APPENDIX

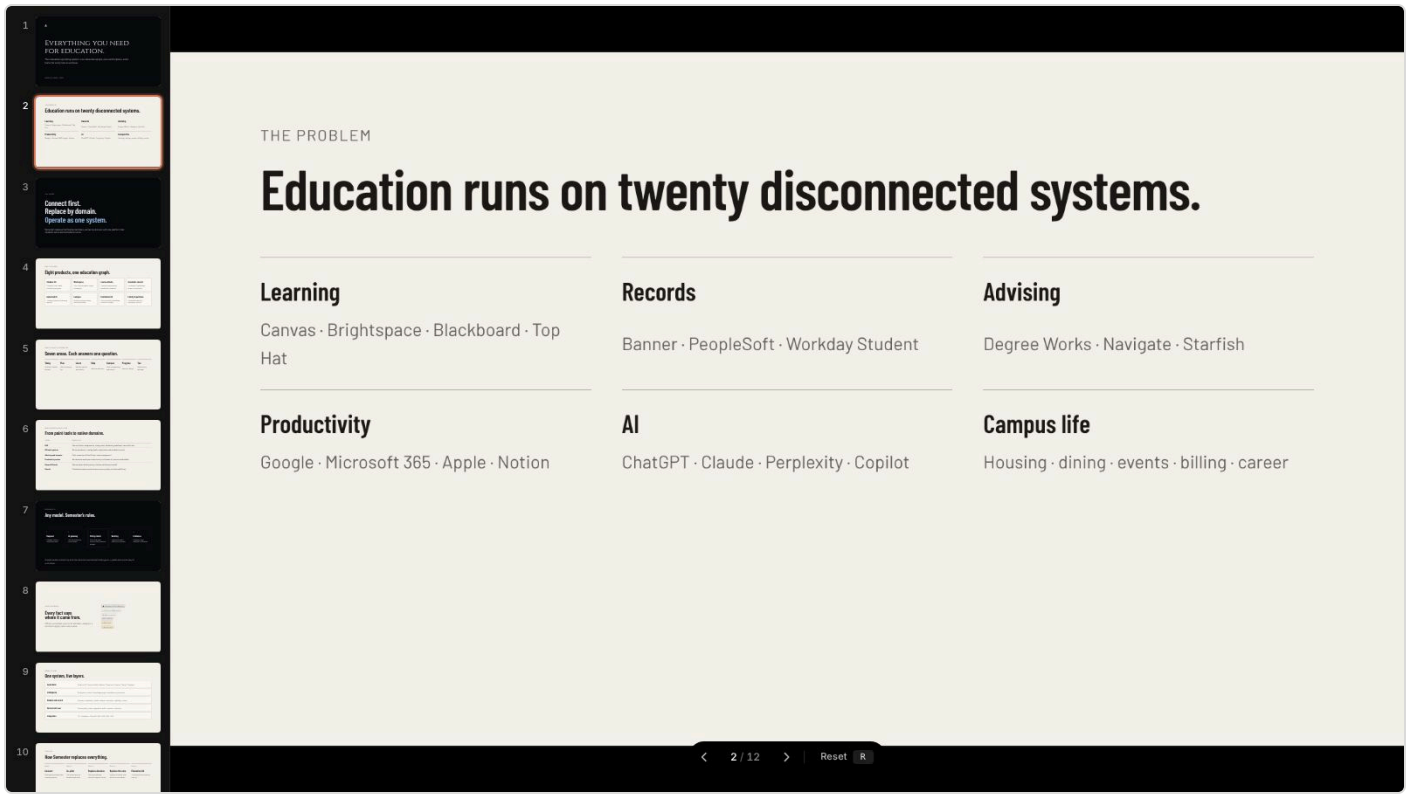
Source research

The research reports and planning documents the founder gathered while building Semester, reproduced in full.

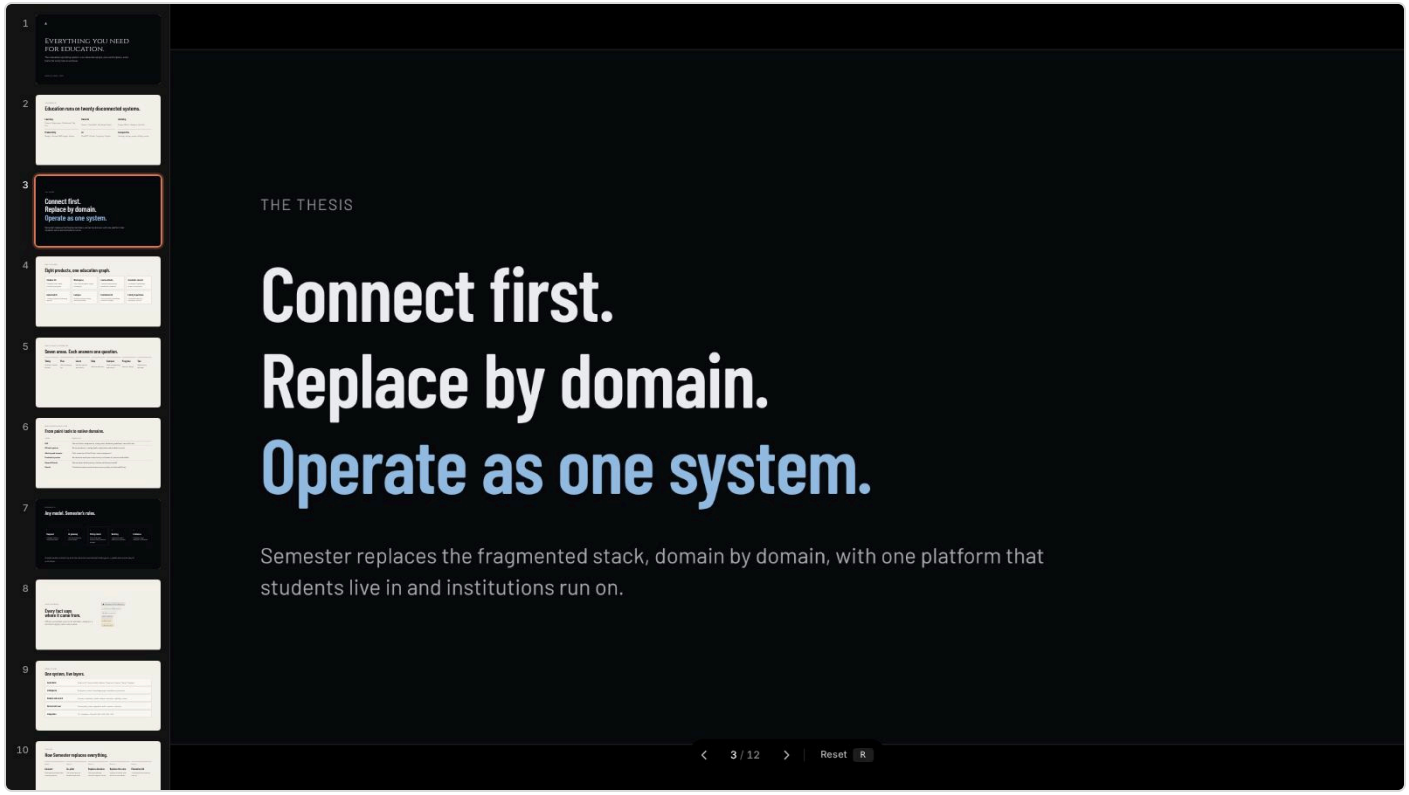
Semester Vision Deck (offline edition)



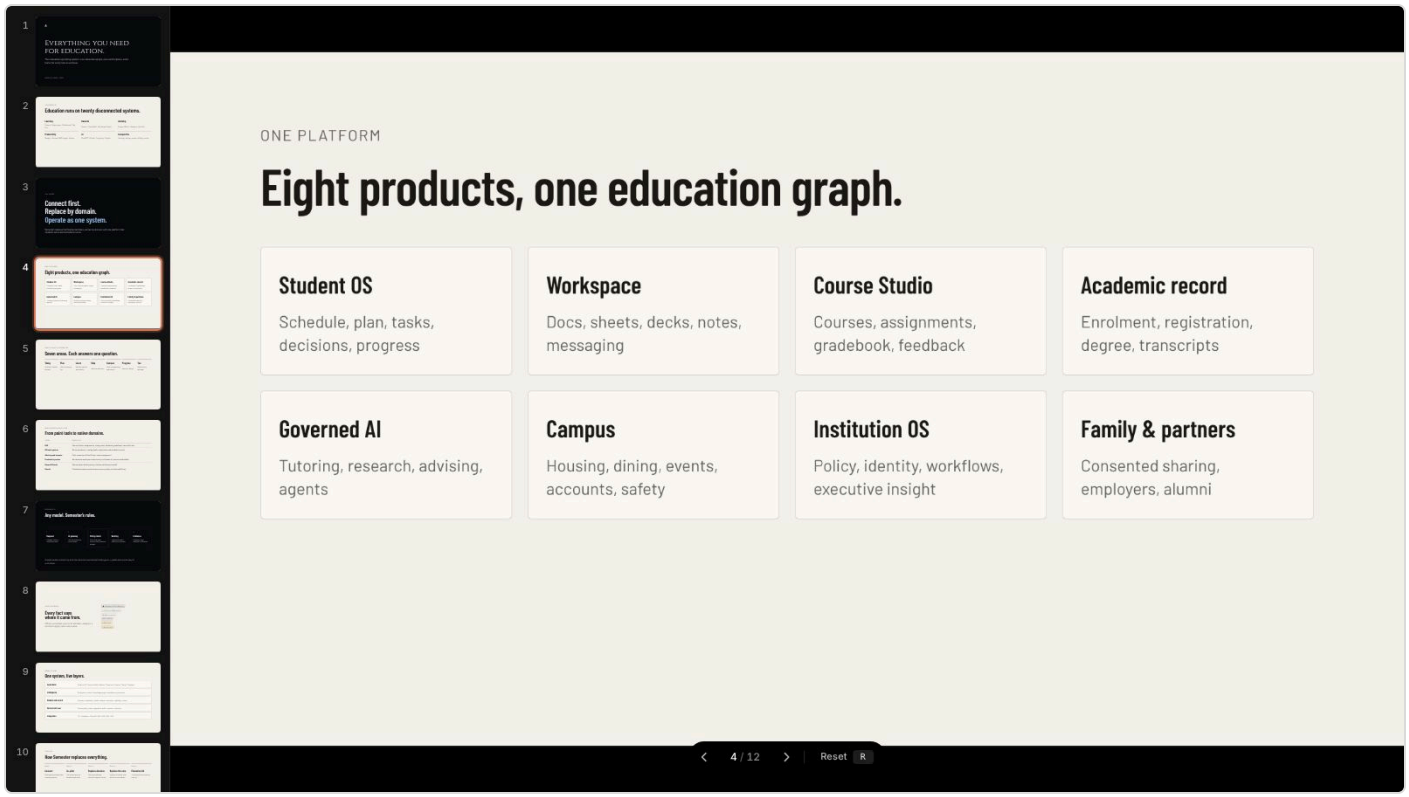
Slide 1



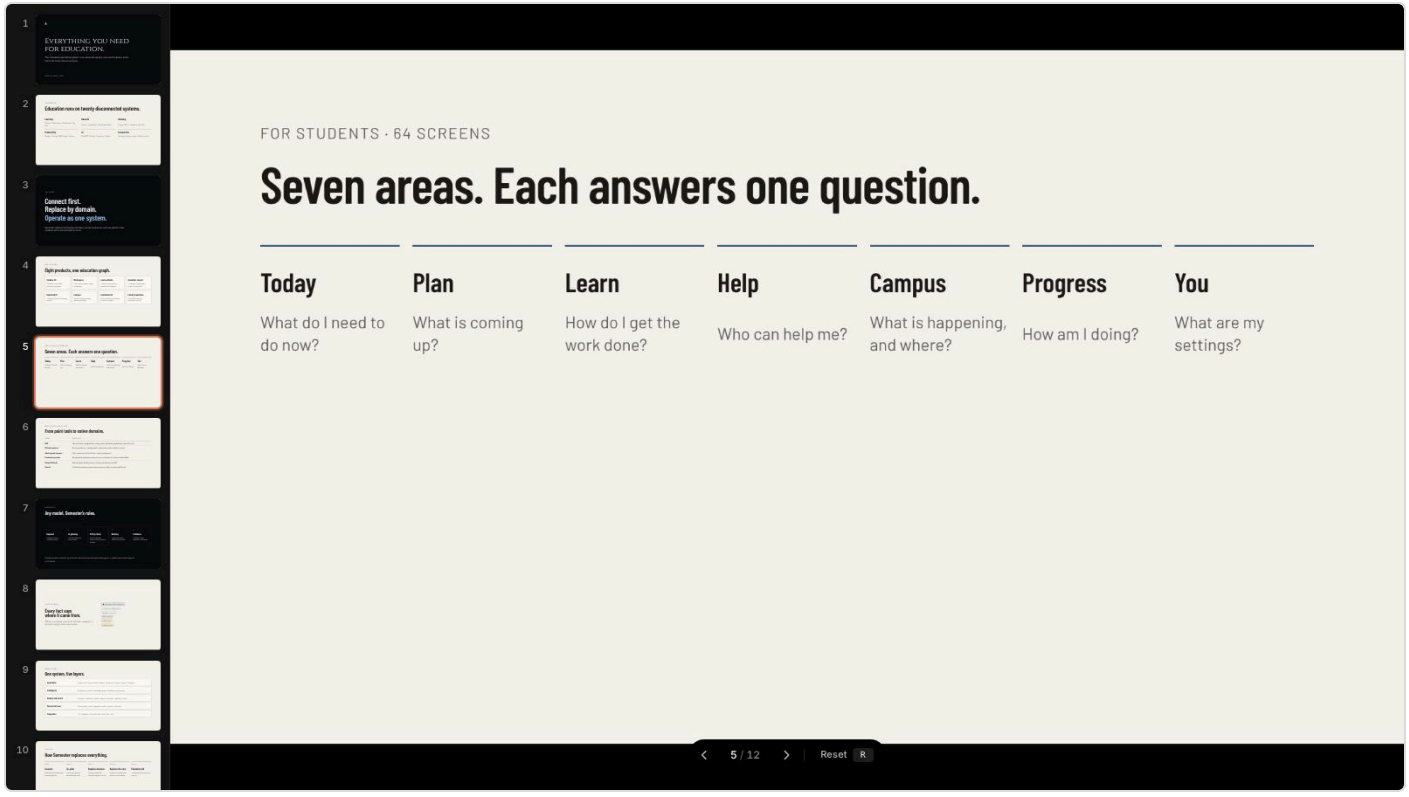
Slide 2



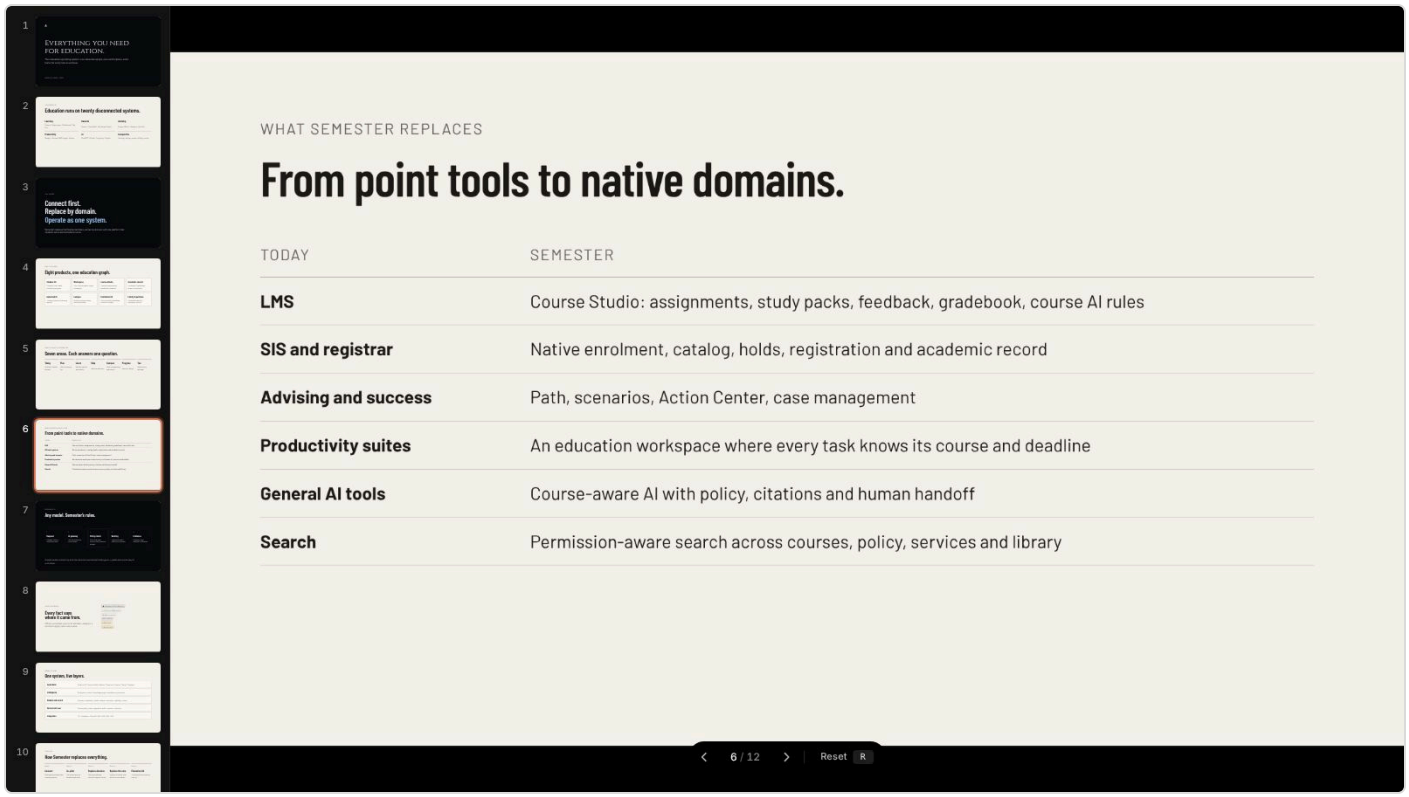
Slide 3



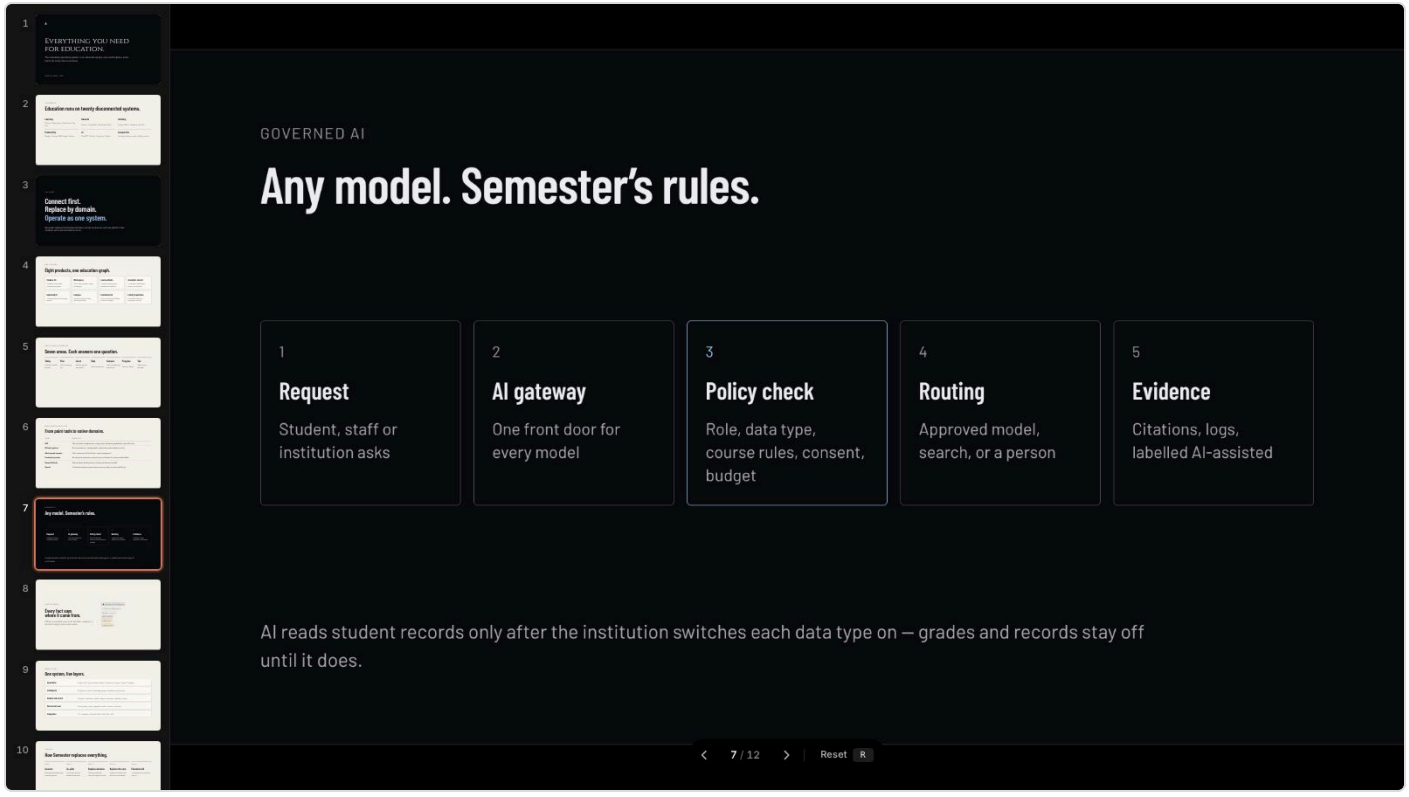
Slide 4



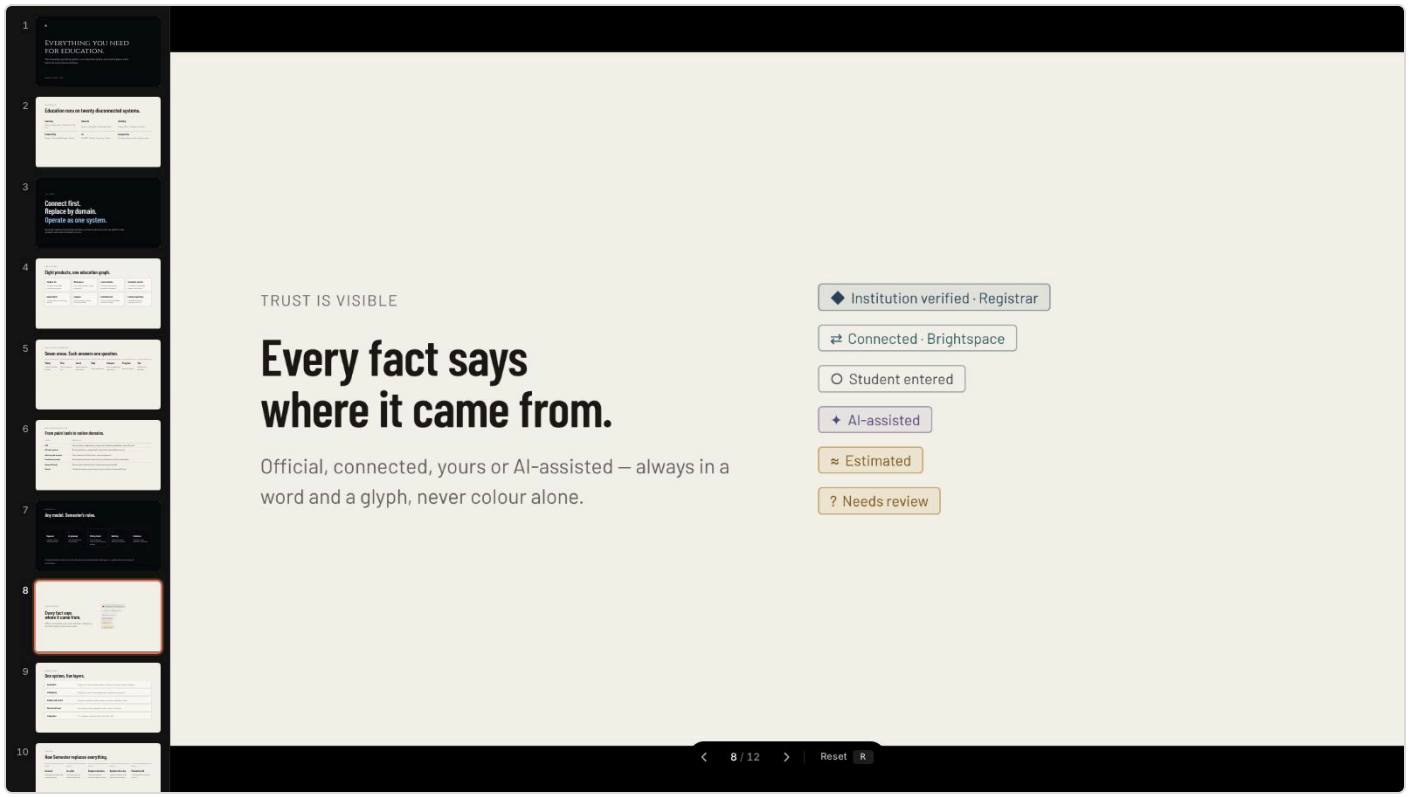
Slide 5



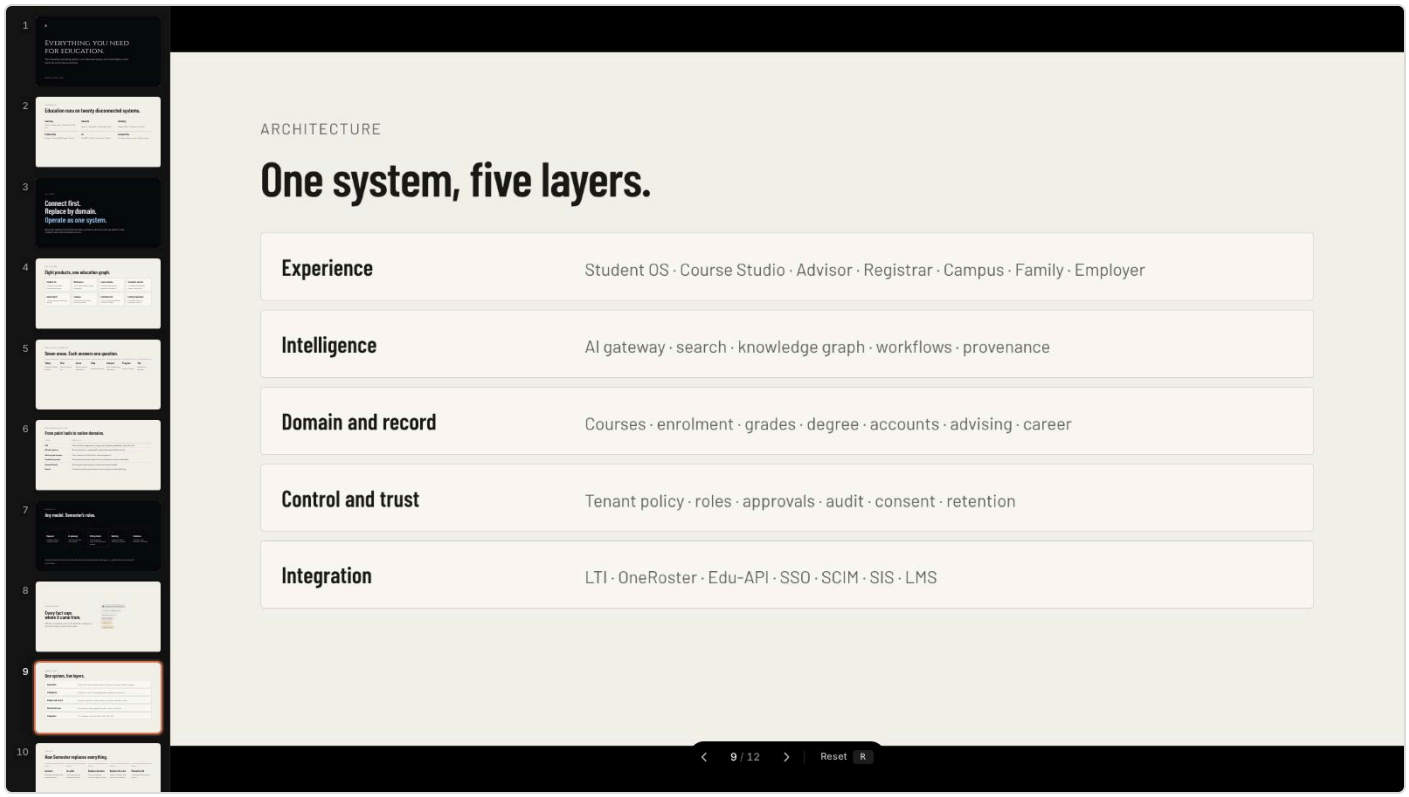
Slide 6



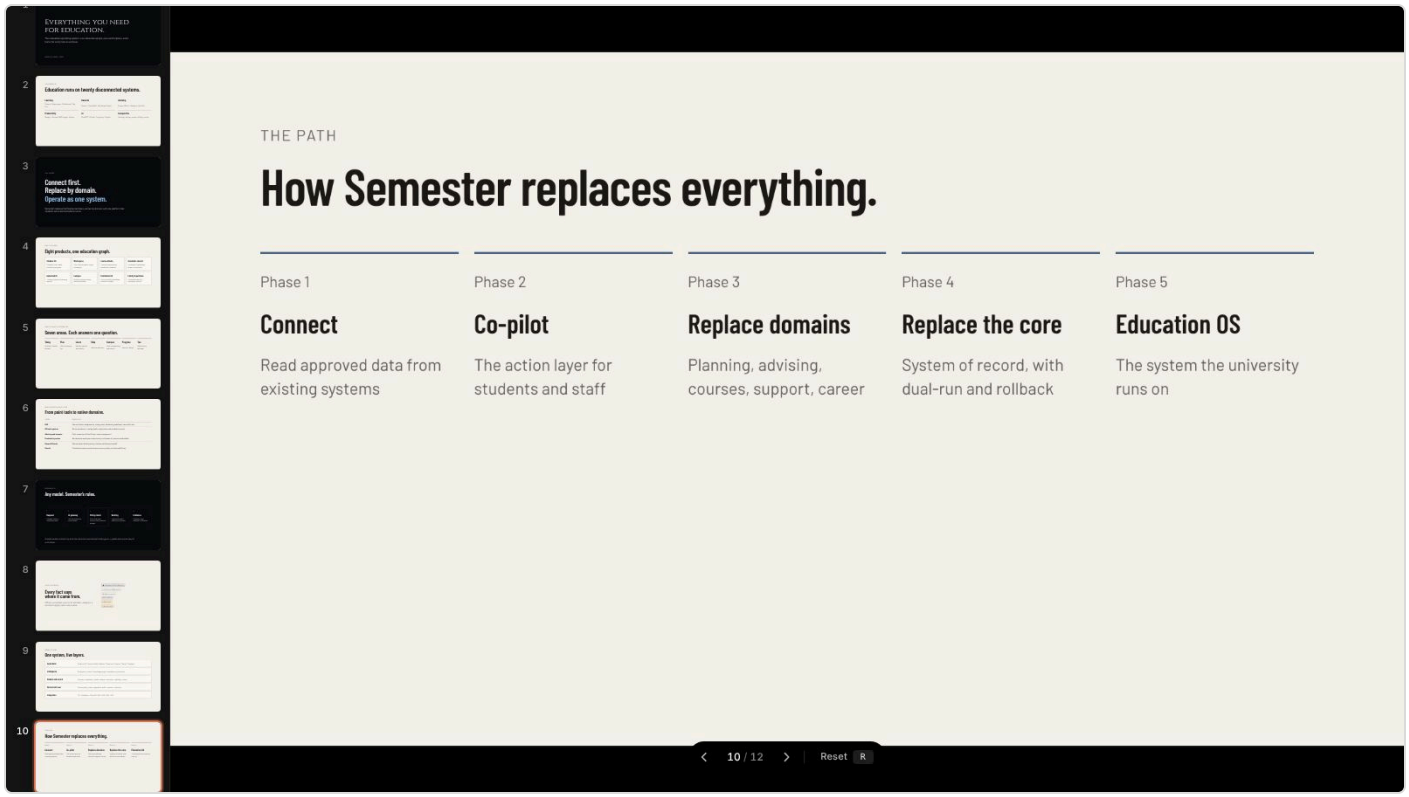
Slide 7



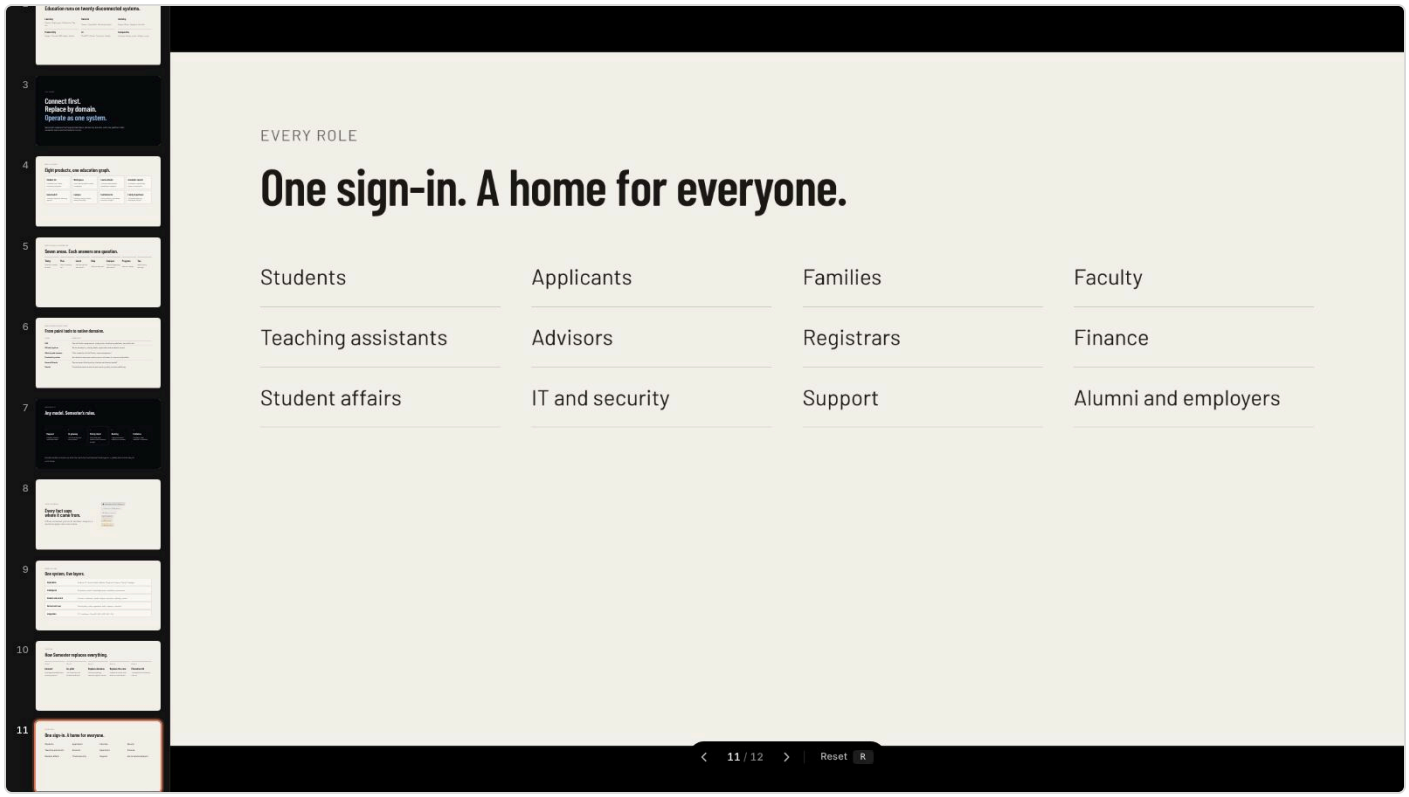
Slide 8



Slide 9



Slide 10



Slide 11


Connect first.
Replace by domain.
Operate as one system.
4
Eight products, one education graph.
5
Seven areas. Each answers one question.
6
From paint nail to entire domains.
7
Any model. Semester's rules.
8
Every fact says
where it came from.
9
One system, five layers.
10
How Semester replaces everything.
11
One sign-in. A home for everyone.
12
ONE SYSTEM. EVERY ROLE.
EVERY YEAR OF EDUCATION.
ONE SYSTEM. EVERY ROLE.
EVERY YEAR OF EDUCATION.
semester · the education operating system
12 / 12
Reset
R

Slide 12

SOURCE RESEARCH · IMAGE

The original lit silver mark



uploads/download-1.png

Apple vs Google vs Microsoft in EdTech: build a strategic expansion matrix for hardware, cloud infrastructure, and enterprise licensing

Computer
Semester OS roadmap: translate Apple, Google, and Microsoft enterprise playbooks into a 3-tier architecture and deployment plan
Computer
Break down the infrastructure layer into APIs
Outline the institutional sales and trust strategy
Detail the student identity and data graph

Semester should borrow the **operating principles** of Apple, Google, and Microsoft—not attempt to copy their entire business models. The winning education-platform architecture has three layers: an exceptional user experience, trusted institutional infrastructure, and an open ecosystem. The goal is to become the education-native control plane connecting identity, learning, records, productivity, AI, services, and outcomes.

Strategic expansion matrix

Strategic model	What to borrow	Semester equivalent	What not to copy
Apple	Integrated experience, design discipline, privacy posture, device-quality standards, premium support	Calm student OS, cohesive navigation, accessibility, offline-safe workflows, student-controlled data sharing, high-quality mobile experience	Closed hardware ecosystem, forced lock-in, opaque platform rules
Google	Search, cloud infrastructure, identity, AI, data systems, developer distribution	Education search, education graph, identity/membership layer, AI gateway, institutional data platform, APIs, partner ecosystem	Ad-tech incentives based on sensitive student data, uncontrolled data aggregation
Microsoft	Enterprise identity, productivity, administration, procurement readiness, long-term contracts, developer platform	Institutional tenant admin, SSO/SCIM, productivity workspace, compliance controls, implementation, annual licensing, APIs and marketplace	Complex enterprise UX, configuration overload, fragmented product surfaces
Canvas/Brightspace	Course workflow and institutional deployment	Course Studio connected to planning, actions, support, AI, and career	Course experience isolated from broader education journey

Strategic model	What to borrow	Semester equivalent	What not to copy
SIS/ERP vendors	Record authority, policy, transaction integrity	Canonical academic domains, deterministic rules, audit, migrations, reconciliation, rollback	Legacy UX and closed integration patterns
ChatGPT/Claude/Perplexity	High-quality conversational intelligence and research	Governed education copilot, policy-aware model routing, evidence/citations, academic context, human escalation	Treating model output as official academic/institutional truth

Three-tier Semester architecture

```
TIER 1 — EXPERIENCE PLATFORM
Student OS · Faculty Course Studio · Advisor workspace
Registrar tools · Campus services · Family portal
Career/alumni · Company site · Operations Console

TIER 2 — EDUCATION INTELLIGENCE PLATFORM
Identity graph · Education graph · Search · AI Gateway
Policy engine · Workflow engine · Evidence/provenance
Analytics · Recommendations · Outcome models

TIER 3 — INSTITUTIONAL INFRASTRUCTURE PLATFORM
Tenant control plane · RLS · SSO/SCIM · Audit
Integrations · Migration factory · APIs · Webhooks
Billing · Trust/compliance · SLOs · Backups · Operations
```

Tier 1: Experience platform

This is the Apple-like layer: students and staff should prefer it daily because it is calm, clear, fast, accessible, and coherent.

```
Student:
Today → Actions → Path → Plan → Courses → Copilot → Support → Career

Faculty:
Course Studio → Resources → Assignments → Feedback → Gradebook → Course policy

Advisor:
Caseload → Student path → Check-ins → Referrals → Success plans → Outcomes

Institution:
Tenant config → Roles → Policies → Integrations → Rollout → Analytics

Semester:
GTM → Pilots → Support → Billing → Trust → Security → Operations
```

Tier 2: Education intelligence platform

This is the Google-like layer: it makes data, search, AI, source authority, and recommendations work together.

```
Education Intelligence
├── Student identity and membership context
├── Academic path graph
├── Course and learning graph
├── Skills and evidence graph
├── Institutional policy graph
├── Search index
├── AI model router
├── Retrieval and source authority
├── Recommendation engine
├── Workflow orchestration
├── Analytics/outcomes
├── AI evaluation
└── Human escalation
```

Tier 3: Institutional infrastructure platform

This is the Microsoft-like layer: it makes Semester safe to buy, configure, deploy, govern, integrate, and operate for years.

```
Institutional Infrastructure
├── Multi-tenant data model
├── SSO / SCIM / membership
├── Role/capability system
├── Tenant policy and configuration
├── RLS and authorization
├── Approval workflows
├── Audit and evidence
├── Integration gateway
├── LTI / OneRoster / Edu-API
├── Migration and reconciliation
├── Feature flags and rollout
├── Billing/commercial
├── Security/privacy/compliance
├── Monitoring/SLO/incident response
├── Backup/restore/offboarding
└── Developer ecosystem
```

Infrastructure API layer

Semester needs APIs organized by **authority and risk**, not merely by frontend page.

```
API Gateway
├── Identity API
├── Tenant and Policy API
├── Academic API
```

```
├── Learning API
├── Student Workspace API
├── AI Gateway API
├── Student Success API
├── Campus Services API
├── Career API
├── Family Consent API
├── Integration API
├── Commercial API
├── Trust and Compliance API
├── Operations API
└── Developer Platform API
```

API domains

API	Primary resources	Write-control model
Identity	Accounts, sessions, memberships, SSO, SCIM, roles	Server-authorized; auditable
Tenant	Institutions, campuses, policies, configurations, feature state	Tenant admin + approval path
Academic	Terms, catalog, sections, enrollment, holds, records, grades	Deterministic policy + registrar authority
Learning	Courses, objectives, resources, assignments, assessments, study packs	Faculty/course-scoped capabilities
Workspace	Tasks, notes, files, calendar, plans, projects	Student ownership and sharing grants
AI	Requests, policy, providers, sources, usage, evaluations	Gateway-enforced, tenant/course policy
Student Success	Caseload, check-ins, referrals, success plans, support	Purpose-limited, consent/role-scoped
Campus	Dining, housing, events, organizations, spaces	Service-owner policy and tenant scope
Career	Skills, evidence, credentials, opportunities, mentors	Student consent + verified claim rules
Family	Grants, invitations, scoped shares, revocation	Student-controlled, time-limited
Integrations	Connections, scopes, mappings, syncs, webhooks	Approval-gated and server-only credentials
Commercial	Quotes, contracts, subscriptions, invoices, entitlements	Finance/revenue capability + approvals
Trust	Controls, evidence, claims, artifacts, trust-room grants	Security/legal/compliance scoped
Operations	Approvals, incidents, SLOs, audits, rollouts, risks	Internal capabilities, evidence, two-person controls
Platform	Apps, API keys, OAuth clients, webhooks, marketplace	Tenant install approval + developer governance

API contract standard

Every Semester API should follow:

```
Identity:
  Who is calling?

Scope:
  Which tenant/customer/course/person may be accessed?

Purpose:
  Why is this data/action needed?

Authority:
  Is this official, derived, AI-generated, user-owned, or external?

Policy:
  Which rules constrain it?

Validation:
  Are inputs structurally and semantically valid?

Idempotency:
  Can a retry create duplicate harm?

Audit:
  What event must be recorded?

Freshness:
  Is data live, delayed, stale, or unavailable?

Error:
  What safe recovery or human handoff is available?
```

Example API resource structure

```
/v1/identity/me
/v1/tenants/{tenantId}
/v1/tenants/{tenantId}/policy
/v1/academic/terms
/v1/academic/catalog
/v1/academic/sections
/v1/academic/enrollments
/v1/academic/registration-requests
/v1/learning/courses/{courseId}
/v1/learning/assignments
/v1/learning/gradebook
/v1/workspace/tasks
/v1/workspace/notes
/v1/workspace/calendar
/v1/ai/requests
/v1/ai/sources
/v1/support/requests
/v1/advising/caseload
```

```
/v1/career/opportunities
/v1/family/grants
/v1/integrations/connections
/v1/integrations/sync-runs
/v1/commercial/quotes
/v1/commercial/subscriptions
/v1/trust/artifacts
/v1/ops/tenants
/v1/ops/approvals
/v1/ops/incidents
/v1/platform/apps
/v1/platform/webhooks
```

High-impact write APIs should not directly mutate raw tables from the browser. They should use capability-checked server/RPC commands:

```
POST /v1/academic/registration-requests
POST /v1/academic/registration-requests/{id}/decision
POST /v1/ops/approval-requests
POST /v1/ops/approval-requests/{id}/decision
POST /v1/integrations/{id}/scope-approval
POST /v1/commercial/quotes/{id}/send
POST /v1/privacy/data-subject-requests/{id}/complete
```

Institutional sales strategy

Semester should sell the **full platform vision** but contract and deploy a narrow, measurable workflow first.

Positioning

```
Semester is the unified education operating system:
one connected platform for student action, learning, planning,
institutional workflows, governed AI, and operational intelligence.
```

Initial institutional wedge

```
Semester Registration Readiness Pilot

Target buyer:
Student Success, Advising, Registrar, or a defined academic department.

Scope:
One student cohort, one workflow, one academic term or 8–12 weeks.

Outcome:
Help students understand registration requirements, complete next actions,
and reduce avoidable support friction.

Evidence:
```

```
Activation, first meaningful action, readiness completion, support load,
student confidence, advisor/staff feedback, pilot-to-annual conversion.
```

Buyer map

Stakeholder	Need	Semester message
President/provost	Student outcomes, institutional coherence, risk	One connected operating layer with phased modernization
CIO	Integration, security, maintainability, vendor consolidation	Tenant controls, APIs, migration factory, standards, audit
CISO/privacy	Data minimization, controls, evidence, incident readiness	Policy engine, RLS, evidence register, Trust Center, HECVAT roadmap
Registrar	Record authority, accuracy, transaction integrity	Deterministic rules, reconciliation, audit, migration gates
Student success leader	Action completion, support coordination, retention	Student Action Center and measurable pilot outcomes
Advisor	Context, referral paths, student clarity	Path, plan, support workflow, consented sharing
Faculty	Course clarity, workload, AI policy	Course Studio with source-aware, policy-bounded AI
Procurement/legal	Contracts, DPA, insurance, SLA, vendor reliability	Controlled trust room, contract library, evidence lifecycle
Student leader	Usability, campus relevance, student value	Calm daily workspace and direct student benefits
CFO	Cost, ROI, delivery, vendor risk	Pilot scope, implementation plan, measurable impact, annual economics

Institutional sales motion

```
1. Named target account
2. Personalized outreach
3. Discovery
4. Qualification
5. Role-specific demo
6. Pilot design session
7. Security/procurement path
8. Pilot proposal
9. Mutual Action Plan
10. Signed pilot
11. Implementation
12. Adoption measurement
13. Midpoint review
14. Outcome report
15. Annual conversion
16. Expansion and reference
```

Trust strategy

The trust strategy must be a product, not a PDF folder.

```
Trust Center
  ↓
Security overview
Privacy overview
Accessibility statement
Responsible AI
Data practices
Subprocessors
Incident response summary
Business continuity summary
Status page
HECVAT readiness
DPA process
Security questionnaire request
Trust room
```

Institutional trust is earned through:

- Clear data authority.
- Explicit tenant isolation.
- Verified access controls.
- Controlled support access.
- Security evidence.
- Accessible UX.
- Measurable implementation.
- Transparent incidents.
- Data portability.
- Rollback/migration capability.
- Honest product and compliance claims.

Student identity and data graph

Semester's core defensibility is the **education graph**, which must balance connected context with privacy, authority, and student agency.

```
Person
├── Identity
├── Account
├── Institution membership
├── Roles
├── Program
├── Courses
├── Terms
```

```
├── Enrollment
├── Requirements
├── Plans
├── Tasks
├── Calendar
├── Learning objectives
├── Assignments
├── Grades
├── Skills
├── Evidence
├── Credentials
├── Support requests
├── Advisors
├── Appointments
├── Community memberships
├── Campus service usage
├── Student account
├── Opportunities
├── Mentors
├── Family grants
├── AI interactions
├── Consent decisions
├── Privacy preferences
└── Outcomes
```

Graph rules

Each node and relationship must carry:

```
Canonical ID
Tenant ID
Owner
Source authority
Source system
Source record ID
Freshness timestamp
Version
Data classification
Consent/grant requirement
Role/capability requirement
Retention policy
Audit history
Export rule
Deletion rule
Migration source
Confidence/verification status
```

Authority categories

Category	Example	Semester handling
Official institutional	Enrollment, grade, hold, term dates	Institution/registrar-authorized record
Instructor-published	Syllabus, course AI rules, study packs	Course/term scoped, versioned
Student-owned	Notes, tasks, private plan, AI preferences	Private by default, student controls sharing
Semester-derived	Workload estimate, action suggestion, health aggregate	Explainable, source-linked, not silently official
AI-generated	Summary, draft, recommendation	Policy-bound, cited, not authoritative by default
External source	Library source, partner opportunity, public policy	Labeled with source and freshness
Community-generated	Post, review, peer tip	Moderated and clearly non-official
Verified credential	Institution-approved skill/award	Evidence and authority required

Student-agency model

```
Default:
Student-owned workspace is private.

Sharing:
Student selects recipient, category, purpose, duration, and items.

Access:
Recipient sees only authorized scope.

Audit:
Every access is recorded.

Revocation:
Student can revoke unless an institutional policy/legal obligation applies.

Institution:
Official records remain governed by institutional authority.

AI:
Only policy-approved context is supplied to the model/provider.
```

Deployment model

```
Development
  ↓
Tenant-safe test environment
  ↓
Sandbox integration
  ↓
Preview deployment
```

```
  ↓
Internal beta
  ↓
Private beta tenant
  ↓
Pilot tenant
  ↓
Controlled production cohort
  ↓
Annual customer deployment
  ↓
Multi-campus expansion
```

Each step requires:

```
Configuration
Policy approval
Security review
Accessibility review
Data validation
Integration test
Rollback plan
Support readiness
Monitoring
Release evidence
Owner approval
```

Expansion strategy

```
Stage 1:
Daily student OS + registration readiness

Stage 2:
Course Studio + advising/support workflows

Stage 3:
Institution control plane + integrations + rollout factory

Stage 4:
Native registrar/academic domains where authorized

Stage 5:
Campus services + student account + career + family

Stage 6:
Developer platform + marketplace + global ecosystem

Stage 7:
Education infrastructure company:
identity, cloud, AI, operating layer, standards, partner ecosystem,
global deployments, and lifelong learner network
```

The key strategic conclusion is:

> Semester should be sold as the unified Education OS, deployed as a focused pilot, expanded as a trusted institutional platform, and matured into an open ecosystem where students, institutions, developers, employers, and partners all gain more value from the same connected graph.

Build a comprehensive go-to-market playbook and launch checklist covering legal incorporation, financial modeling, sales funnels, and compliance in one exportable PDF report

Computer
Interactive GTM financial model and sales-funnel calculator: model customer acquisition costs, lifetime value, pricing tiers, and break-even runway
Computer
Show me how to format the customer acquisition funnel
Draft an institutional pilot agreement template
Build a cloud security and compliance checklist

For Semester, the launch package should be built around a paid, narrowly scoped institutional pilot that proves a student outcome and converts to an annual platform agreement. Below is a practical legal/compliance checklist, a pilot sales playbook, a customer-success workflow, a CAC/LTV funnel format, and a master prompt for generating a complete GTM PDF/report and interactive financial model.

The critical rule: do not sell "everything Semester could eventually become." Sell one urgent workflow, to one clearly defined institutional buyer, with measurable success criteria, a defined pilot price, a conversion date, and a procurement-ready trust package.

Launch master checklist

Corporate and financial

Area	Create / complete	Launch evidence
Legal entity	Entity formation, governing documents, EIN, state registrations, registered agent	Entity is active and in good standing
Ownership	Founder agreements, IP assignment, vesting, cap table, advisor/contractor terms	Company—not individuals—owns code and IP
Banking	Business bank account, approval rules, accounting chart of accounts	Business funds are separated from personal funds
Accounting	Bookkeeping system, monthly close checklist, expense policy, tax calendar	Monthly P&L, balance sheet, cash-flow statement
Financial model	36-month driver-based model with conservative/base/ambitious/downside cases	Unit economics, runway, break-even, hiring plan

Area	Create / complete	Launch evidence
Pricing	Pilot, institutional, implementation, AI overage, support, and expansion pricing	Approved price book and discount policy
Insurance	Cyber, E&O/professional liability, general liability; evaluate D&O as needed	Coverage reviewed against contract requirements
Contract library	NDA, MSA, SaaS agreement, order form, pilot agreement, SOW, DPA, SLA	Versioned and counsel-reviewed templates
Payments	Invoice process, payment terms, collections policy, tax treatment	Quote-to-cash workflow tested
Board/governance	Decision log, consent process, investor update, board package	Clear authority and reporting cadence

The SBA's startup guidance includes choosing a legal structure, registering the business, getting federal/state tax IDs, opening a bank account, and obtaining appropriate insurance; the exact state and tax requirements depend on where and how you operate.[1]

Legal and privacy

- [ ] Founder, employee, contractor, and advisor **IP assignment** agreements.
- [ ] Confidentiality and invention-assignment provisions for all contributors.
- [ ] Mutual NDA and one-way NDA templates.
- [ ] SaaS agreement/MSA, order form, pilot agreement, and SOW.
- [ ] Data Processing Addendum.
- [ ] Privacy Policy, Terms of Service, Acceptable Use Policy, cookie notice.
- [ ] Subprocessor register and customer notification/update process.
- [ ] Data inventory: what data is collected, source, purpose, storage, access, retention, deletion, and vendors.
- [ ] Data classification: public, internal, confidential, restricted.
- [ ] Data-retention and verified deletion policy.
- [ ] Privacy rights/request intake and escalation workflow.
- [ ] Marketing consent, unsubscribe, suppression-list process.
- [ ] AI data-use policy: what data can be sent to model providers, approval controls, retention, and customer disclosure.
- [ ] Accessibility statement and accessibility remediation process.
- [ ] Claims register: every public product, security, accessibility, customer-outcome, and AI claim must have evidence and owner.
- [ ] Legal-review queue with status, contract type, customer risk, owner, reviewer, and renewal date.

The FTC recommends collecting only necessary sensitive information, safeguarding it, and disposing of it securely when no longer needed.[2]

Security and institutional compliance

Control area	Minimum launch requirement
Identity	MFA on admin, code, cloud, finance, CRM, support, and production accounts
Secrets	Secret manager; no credentials in repositories, browser bundles, screenshots, or docs
Access	Least privilege, role review, contractor offboarding, access log
Application security	Pull-request review, dependency scanning, vulnerability process, secure release checklist
Data	Encryption in transit, appropriate encryption at rest, backups, restoration test
Monitoring	Error monitoring, uptime monitoring, security alert triage, audit logging
Incident response	Severity model, response team, customer communications, tabletop exercise
Resilience	Business continuity plan, disaster-recovery runbook, tested recovery steps
Vendor risk	Review subprocessors and maintain a vendor register
Trust	Security overview, data-flow diagram, subprocessor list, status page, security contact
Procurement	HECVAT Lite roadmap, questionnaire response library, DPA/SLA path
Accessibility	Tested accessibility baseline, documented known gaps, remediation plan

For higher-ed buying, prepare HECVAT evidence early. EDUCAUSE describes HECVAT as a campus-preferred vendor-risk evaluation framework spanning information security, privacy, accessibility, and related technology controls; vendors complete the sections applicable to their solution.[3] [4] [5]

Required trust package

Create this before asking an institution to start security review:

```
trust/
├── Security-Overview.pdf
├── Privacy-Overview.pdf
├── Data-Flow-Diagram.pdf
├── Architecture-Diagram.pdf
├── Subprocessor-List.pdf
├── Data-Retention-and-Deletion.pdf
├── Incident-Response-Summary.pdf
├── Business-Continuity-Summary.pdf
├── Accessibility-Statement.pdf
├── HECVAT-Lite-Response.xlsx
├── Security-Questionnaire-Answer-Library.md
├── DPA-template.docx
├── SLA-template.docx
└── Trust-Center-Content.md
```

Initial commercial model

Use a **pilot-to-annual conversion** path:

Offer	Suggested commercial structure	Purpose
Discovery/design session	Free, tightly bounded	Qualify the problem and stakeholders
Paid pilot	Fixed fee for one workflow, one department/cohort, one term or 8–12 weeks	Prove outcomes with limited risk
Implementation	Separate fixed fee based on integration/configuration complexity	Cover real setup cost
Annual institutional platform	Per enrolled student/year with minimum annual commitment	Recurring platform revenue
Premium support	Percentage of annual fee or fixed minimum	Cover institutional success/support requirements
AI overage	Tenant-funded usage above included allocation	Protect gross margin

Your working pricing assumptions can be:

```
Student Premium:
$8.99/month or $69/year

Institutional platform:
$18 per enrolled student/year
$30,000 annual minimum

AI overage:
$30 per 1,000 governed AI requests

Implementation:
$35,000 to $150,000 one-time
based on integration, data, tenant configuration, and rollout complexity

Premium support:
15% of annual platform fee
$15,000 minimum

Marketplace/partner commission:
12%, where applicable
```

These are planning assumptions, not a universal price card. Validate willingness to pay through buyer interviews, pilot proposals, procurement feedback, competitive context, and delivery costs before publishing a final pricing page.

Pick one launch wedge

Your first pilot should be focused. A strong first offer could be:

```
Semester Registration Readiness Pilot

Buyer:
Student Success, Advising, Registrar, or a defined academic department.

Problem:
Students enter registration without a clear plan, miss actions, generate support loa
and struggle to understand requirements, deadlines, resources, and next steps.

Pilot:
Semester supports a defined student cohort through registration readiness and action

Scope:
One institution, one department/cohort, one academic term, limited integrations,
a named executive sponsor, and a defined student population.

Success:
- Student activation
- First meaningful action
- Registration-readiness workflow completion
- Reduced advisor/support friction
- Student confidence/satisfaction
- Measurable improvement against agreed baseline

Commercial:
Paid pilot with explicit implementation scope and annual conversion price.

Decision:
Named executive decision-maker and annual-conversion decision date.
```

Sales funnel format

Track the funnel by **institutional account**, not social impressions.

```
Target Accounts
  ↓
Researched Accounts
  ↓
Warm Introductions / Outbound Contacts
  ↓
Replies / Referrals
  ↓
Discovery Meetings
  ↓
Qualified Opportunities
  ↓
Role-Specific Demos
  ↓
Pilot Design Sessions
  ↓
```

```
Security / Privacy / Procurement Review
  ↓
Pilot Proposal Sent
  ↓
Pilot Signed
  ↓
Pilot Activated
  ↓
Pilot Success Achieved
  ↓
Annual Contract Converted
  ↓
Expansion / Reference / Renewal
```

Funnel spreadsheet columns

Stage	Required fields	Primary metric
Target account	Institution, size, segment, department, priority, trigger event	Target-account coverage
Contacted	Buyer/champion, channel, message, date, outcome	Reply rate
Discovery	Pain, current process, urgency, stakeholders, budget, timeline	Qualification rate
Demo	Use case, attendees, objections, next action	Demo-to-design rate
Pilot design	Scope, success metrics, data needs, implementation owner	Proposal readiness
Security/procurement	Security owner, legal owner, HECVAT/DPA status, blockers	Review progress
Proposal	Pilot fee, annual value, decision date, champion strength	Proposal-to-close rate
Pilot	Activation, weekly usage, success score, risks	Pilot attainment
Annual conversion	Value report, renewal owner, annual quote, close date	Pilot-to-annual conversion
Expansion	New departments/cohorts, upsell value, advocate/reference	Net revenue retention

Funnel math

Use these formulas:

$$\text{Stage Conversion Rate} = \frac{\text{Accounts entering next stage}}{\text{Accounts entering current stage}}$$

$$\text{Win Rate} = \frac{\text{Annual contracts won}}{\text{Qualified opportunities}}$$

$$\text{Pilot Conversion Rate} = \frac{\text{Annual contracts from pilots}}{\text{Pilots completed}}$$

$$\text{CAC} = \frac{\text{Sales and marketing spend for a period}}{\text{New customers acquired}}$$

$$\text{CAC Payback Months} = \frac{\text{CAC}}{\text{Monthly gross profit per new customer}}$$

$$\text{LTV} \approx \frac{\text{Annual recurring revenue} \times \text{Gross margin}}{\text{Annual logo churn rate}}$$

Use LTV cautiously at the beginning; early churn and retention data are too immature for a precise prediction. Treat it as a sensitivity range, not a fact.

Weekly sales scorecard

Metric	Weekly target	Why
New target accounts researched	10–20	Keeps top of funnel healthy
Personalized outreach attempts	25–50	Creates conversations
Buyer/champion conversations	3–8	Market learning and pipeline
Qualified opportunities	1–3	Tests real buying intent
Demos	2–5	Validates narrative/product
Pilot designs	1–2	Converts interest into scope
Security reviews started	Track	Indicates institutional seriousness
Pilot proposals sent	1+	Creates commercial decisions
Pilots signed	Monthly target	Creates proof and revenue
Pilot activation	80%+ of agreed cohort	Validates implementation
Pilot KPI attainment	Defined per pilot	Determines annual conversion
Annual conversions	Track	Proves repeatability

Pilot sales command

```
You are the Head of Institutional Sales for Semester.

Build a complete pilot-to-annual sales engine for an education-technology SaaS compar

The sales motion must begin with one narrow, measurable workflow. Do not sell Semeste

Create:

1. Ideal Customer Profile
2. Target account scoring model
3. 100-account list template
4. Buyer and stakeholder map:
   - economic buyer
   - champion
   - technical buyer
   - security/privacy reviewer
   - procurement
   - legal
   - end-user sponsor
5. Discovery-call script
6. Qualification scorecard
```

```
7. Demo script
8. Demo environment checklist
9. Pilot design-session agenda
10. Paid pilot proposal template
11. Mutual Action Plan
12. Security/procurement response checklist
13. Objection-handling library
14. Pricing and discount approval policy
15. ROI calculator specification
16. CRM stages, definitions, required fields, and exit criteria
17. Weekly pipeline review format
18. Forecasting model
19. Pilot-to-annual conversion playbook
20. Expansion and reference-customer playbook

Use the following commercial baseline:
- Student Premium: $8.99/month or $69/year
- Institution platform: $18/enrolled student/year, $30,000 annual minimum
- Implementation: $35,000–$150,000
- AI overage: $30 per 1,000 governed requests
- Premium support: 15% of annual platform fee, $15,000 minimum

For every sales artifact, define:
- Objective
- Owner
- Trigger
- Inputs
- Steps
- Exit criteria
- KPI
- System of record
- Risks
- Approval requirements

Return a 90-day sales plan that targets 100 named accounts, generates 15–25 qualifie
```

Customer success and onboarding workflow

Customer lifecycle

```
Contract signed
  ↓
Sales-to-CS handoff
  ↓
Welcome and kickoff
  ↓
Configuration / data / integration readiness
  ↓
Admin training
  ↓
Student and staff launch
  ↓
Activation support
  ↓
```

```
Weekly pilot review
  ↓
Midpoint executive review
  ↓
Outcome measurement
  ↓
Final value report
  ↓
Annual conversion / renewal
  ↓
Expansion / reference / advocacy
```

Sales-to-success handoff checklist

Sales must provide these before a customer kickoff:

- [ ] Signed contract/order form/pilot agreement
- [ ] Commercial scope and exclusions
- [ ] Pilot duration
- [ ] Annual conversion date
- [ ] Executive sponsor
- [ ] Economic buyer
- [ ] Operational champion
- [ ] Technical/IT contact
- [ ] Security/privacy/procurement contacts
- [ ] Target user population
- [ ] Workflow being solved
- [ ] Baseline metrics
- [ ] Desired success metrics
- [ ] Promised integrations
- [ ] Data categories
- [ ] Open risks
- [ ] Customer commitments
- [ ] Semester commitments
- [ ] Customer communication preferences
- [ ] Agreed next meeting

First 30 days of a pilot

Timing	Customer action	Semester action	Deliverable
Days 0–3	Confirm sponsor and working team	Send welcome and kickoff agenda	Welcome packet
Days 3–7	Attend kickoff, provide admin/data inputs	Align scope, RACI, risks, metrics	Pilot success plan
Week 1	Confirm user population and workflow	Configure tenant and roles	Configuration checklist
Weeks 1–2	Provide data/integration access if included	Validate data and security assumptions	Data readiness report
Week 2	Attend admin training	Train admins/champions	Training recording + admin guide
Weeks 2–3	Send launch communications	Support launch, office hours, help center	Launch kit
Weeks 3–4	Encourage user activation	Monitor activation and intervene	Activation dashboard
Weekly	Attend operating review	Report KPIs, risks, actions	Weekly pilot report
Midpoint	Executive check-in	Present progress and unblock risk	Midpoint executive deck
Final 2 weeks	Review results	Present value case and annual proposal	Results report + conversion plan

Customer health score

Use a 100-point score:

Signal	Weight	Risk signal
Admin engagement	15	No owner attendance or delayed actions
User activation	20	Cohort activation below target
First meaningful action	15	Users sign in but do not gain value
Core workflow completion	20	Low completion or abandoned tasks
Weekly active use	10	Engagement falls after launch
Support sentiment	5	High friction or repeated unresolved issues
Executive engagement	5	Sponsor disengages or does not attend reviews
Outcome trend	10	Success metrics do not improve

Customer success command

```
You are the Head of Customer Success and Implementation for Semester.

Build an institutional customer-success system that turns a paid pilot into an annual

Create:
```

```
1. Sales-to-CS handoff checklist
2. Customer welcome sequence
3. Kickoff deck and agenda
4. Implementation plan
5. RACI template
6. Data/integration readiness checklist
7. Admin configuration checklist
8. Training curriculum:
   - administrators
   - advisors/staff
   - champions
   - students
9. Student launch kit
10. Support policy and severity model
11. Escalation process
12. Knowledge-base structure
13. Customer health score
14. Weekly pilot operating review
15. Midpoint executive review
16. Pilot success-plan template
17. Final value/results report
18. QBR template
19. Renewal and expansion playbook
20. Churn-risk playbook
21. Customer feedback taxonomy
22. Reference and case-study process

Pilot metrics must prioritize:
- activation
- first meaningful action
- core workflow completion
- weekly active usage
- staff efficiency or time saved
- student satisfaction/confidence
- support-friction reduction
- pilot-to-annual conversion

Do not use downloads, impressions, or vanity engagement as the primary proof of value

For every artifact, include:
- owner
- trigger
- input
- output
- cadence
- escalation rule
- success metric
- system of record
```

GTM report and calculator master prompt

Use this to generate the complete **exportable PDF report** and a companion interactive calculator.

```
Create a comprehensive “Semester Go-to-Market, Financial Model, and Launch Readiness

Deliverables:
1. A polished, exportable PDF report.
2. A companion interactive web calculator.
3. A CSV-ready operating model with assumptions and scenarios.
4. A Markdown source document.

Company:
Semester is an education-technology SaaS platform serving institutions, departments,
- Institutional B2B sales and paid pilots
- Student adoption and retention
- Annual institutional platform licensing
- Implementation services
- Premium support
- Carefully governed AI usage/overage
- Optional marketplace/partner revenue

Use these baseline commercial assumptions:
- Student Premium: $8.99/month or $69/year
- Institution platform: $18 per enrolled student/year
- Institution annual minimum: $30,000
- Included institutional AI allocation: 2,400 governed requests per enrolled student/
- AI overage: $30 per 1,000 governed requests
- Implementation fee: $35,000–$150,000
- Premium support: 15% of annual platform fee, $15,000 minimum
- Marketplace/partner commission: 12%, optional and separately modeled

Required report sections:

A. Executive summary
- Company thesis
- Initial launch wedge
- Buyer and customer segments
- Why the pilot-to-annual model is the first revenue engine
- Major risks and mitigation

B. Legal and company formation checklist
- Entity, IP, ownership, banking, tax, insurance, contracts, privacy, terms, DPA, sec
- Mark every item requiring counsel, accountant, broker, or security review

C. Security and compliance roadmap
- Trust Center
- Data inventory
- Data flows
- retention/deletion
- incident response
- vendor management
- HECVAT Lite and Full roadmap
- accessibility evidence
```

```
- security questionnaire library

D. Go-to-market playbook
- ICP
- personas
- target-account scoring
- sales funnel
- CRM design
- discovery
- demo
- pilot offer
- procurement
- proposal
- conversion
- expansion
- student adoption
- content and channel strategy

E. Pricing and packaging
- Student, department, institution, enterprise/pilot, implementation, support, AI ove
- discount policy
- margin guardrails
- pricing sensitivity

F. Financial model
Create monthly models for 36 months, with:
- Conservative
- Base
- Ambitious
- Downside/delayed-sales
- High-growth/high-cost
- Low-adoption
- High-AI-usage
- Long-sales-cycle
- Pilot-heavy
- Annual-contract-heavy

Model:
- Leads
- meetings
- qualified opportunities
- demos
- pilot designs
- pilot proposals
- pilots signed
- pilot activation
- pilot success
- pilot-to-annual conversion
- annual contract value
- student subscription conversion
- implementation revenue
- AI overage
- gross margin
- cloud, AI, support, implementation, sales, marketing, legal, accounting, security,
- CAC
- CAC payback
```

```
- LTV
- gross retention
- net revenue retention
- monthly burn
- runway
- break-even month
- hiring capacity
- cash required

G. Customer-success system
- Onboarding
- implementation
- training
- support
- health score
- pilot success plan
- QBR
- renewal
- expansion
- churn prevention

H. KPI tree and operating cadence
- weekly revenue review
- weekly product/engineering review
- weekly customer success review
- monthly finance review
- monthly security/risk review
- quarterly strategy and OKR review

Interactive calculator requirements:
- Adjustable input cells/sliders
- Pricing-tier controls
- Funnel-conversion controls
- Headcount/cost controls
- CAC/LTV calculation
- Break-even/runway chart
- Scenario selector
- Monthly revenue and expense tables
- Sensitivity charts
- Export current scenario to CSV and Markdown
- Clearly label assumptions versus validated data

Do not present forecasts as facts. Show formulas, assumptions, risks, ranges, and sen
```

Immediate actions

1. Choose the first pilot wedge and target buyer.
2. Finalize the pilot offer, success metrics, and conversion date.
3. Complete the basic contract/trust package with qualified review.
4. Set up CRM and load 100 target accounts.
5. Build the sales deck, demo, proposal, and Mutual Action Plan.
6. Build the onboarding, support, and customer-health process before signing pilots.

7. Start weekly funnel, product, customer success, finance, and security reviews.
8. Use the financial calculator to decide whether each pilot price and implementation scope produces acceptable gross margin and runway.

⁂

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